

Love and Service

THE FIFTY-FIRST ANNUAL MEETING OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS

2001 Final Report

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



51st GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

Love and Service

"Our Twelve Steps, when simmered down to the last, resolve themselves into the words 'love' and 'service.'" So said co-founder Dr. Bob in his final talk, July 3, 1950. Fifty-one years later, at the opening dinner of the 51st A.A. General Service Conference, Dr. Bob's last message was read by his son, Bob Smith Jr.

Under the theme "Love and Service," the 133 Conference members (delegates from the 93 areas in the U.S. and Canada, trustees of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members) met at the Crowne Plaza Manhattan, April 22-28. This year's Conference was chaired by Gary Glynn (nonalcoholic), chairman of the board; Greg Muth, G.S.O.'s general manager; Elaine McDowell, Ph.D., Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; and Al Perez, delegate chairperson, California, Mid-Southern. Susan Ulseth, G.S.O. staff, was Conference coordinator.

At the open A.A. meeting, following the Sunday evening dinner, Darwin Haines (South Carolina) chaired. The meeting was

led by Jim Hall (Kansas); speakers were: Jean Dudley (Saskatchewan), Stella Jenison (Southern New Jersey), Bill Archer (G.S.O. staff), David Every (Grapevine director), and Jim Clough (Pacific regional trustee).

What is it like, this yearly closed meeting, often referred to as A.A.'s "annual business meeting"? Early in April a letter arrived at the General Service Office — "An open letter to members of the 51st General Service Conference from the Ghosts of Conferences Past." The letter, signed "One of the Ghosts," read in part: "We salute you as you enter the second half-century of serving the Fellowship. It is fitting that the Conference theme is 'Love and Service,' Dr. Bob's simple description of our actions in the program. It is a solid but delicate responsibility you are handed as you ride the escalator in the Crowne Plaza into the excitement of this great Conference assembly. It is now given to you as to how your Conference will be remembered—either of Love and Service or Anger and Control. . . . Good luck and God bless your discussions and actions."

The Conference officially opened Sunday afternoon with a welcome from Gary Glynn; roll call by Greg Muth, G.S.O.'s general manager; greetings from the delegate chairperson, Al Perez; and the keynote address, given by Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.

The week's many activities included presentations and reports, question and discussion periods; a workshop; and area service highlights. There were two "What's On Your Mind?" sharing sessions during the week. Sharing sessions are designed to discuss issues and concerns of the delegates and areas which do not appear on the agendas. Among the topics addressed were: Laws regarding border crossings between U.S. and Canada at 2005 International Convention in Toronto; questions pertaining to Conference-approved literature, Spanish translations and the A.A. Grapevine; copyright violations; Conference background material; and pre-Conference unsolicited mail.

Wednesday afternoon the Conference elected two new regional trustees and a trustee-at-large/U.S. Dick Gallagher of Altamonte Springs, Florida will succeed Betty Stevens as Southeast regional trustee; Dorothy May, of Indianapolis, will follow Jack Ostrem, as East Central trustee. Charles Bartell, of New Orleans, will become trustee-at-large/U.S., replacing Dean Rinehart.

At their meeting, immediately following the Conference, the General Service Board approved John Koster, New York, and David Every, Hawaii, as general service trustees.

Allen Ault, of Spotsylvania, Virginia, will become the new Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee. Allen replaces Elaine McDowell who became the new General Service Board chairperson at the close of the 2001 Conference.

Tom Guest, North Florida, will be the delegate chairperson for the 2002 Conference; Christine Carvell, Southern Minnesota, will be the alternate chair.

Most important were the Conference committee meetings. Since day one of sobriety, every A.A. member has heard the suggestion that we must trust the process—the process of our recovery, a day at a time; the process of the group conscience as it emerges in our home groups. Likewise, the process works at the Conference, through the committee system. Committee members discuss items on their agendas, deliberate, and report their recommendations to the entire Conference body for a vote. Thus the group conscience of the Fellowship emerges in the form of Conference Advisory Actions.

Presentations often reflect the Conference theme, and the simplicity of Love and Service echoed throughout many of the presentations. Paul Jacob, South Dakota, when speaking on Sponsorship and the Home Group, related the story of his sponsor presenting him with a Second Edition Big Book when he became a Panel 50 delegate. Reaching across a span of 50 years, the book had belonged to Clyde G., of Utah, a Panel 1 delegate.

Another example of the continuity we often find in A.A. was expressed by Mark Koons, California, San Diego/Imperial, when speaking of the role of the G.S.R. "Throughout this week we have discussed at length items that could affect the future of Alcoholics Anonymous here and around the world. I want the G.S.R.s to know they are with us here, in our hearts and in our voices. We cannot forget our link to the group, which starts with the G.S.R. You are our eyes, ears and voice which completes the circle of Love and Service."

Also speaking on the simplicity of A.A., Jack Ostrem, East Central regional trustee, remembered that Dr. Bob had "also advised us to watch our erring tongues. I have used and distributed his last talk in problem areas such as treatment centers, service functions, i.e. workshops, district meetings, area meetings and A.A. groups. His talk seems to stem alcoholic anger and ego. Believe me, it works."

Vincent Cousineau, Southwest Quebec, asked Conference members to reflect on whether we serve with love. "What about the language of the heart? Is that the language we speak? . . . do we listen to it? Perhaps some day people will say about us — 'They are anonymous, but by their words and by their deeds you will recognize them: they speak the language of the heart, they listen and they serve with love.'"

Friday the Conference adjourned with the Serenity Prayer in English, French and Spanish.

Saturday morning Conference members came together for the final time at the closing brunch. Farewell talks were given by the rotating trustees: Gary Glynn, Tom Maguire, Jack Ostrem, Dean Rinehart and Betty Stevens. Rotating trustee Richard Roughton left the Conference early due to illness.

When reporting on the 16th World Service Meeting Wednesday morning, trustee-at-large/Canada Alex Palmer closed by saying: "Like so many A.A. events no amount of words on paper could ever capture the feelings, the emotions, or the Spiritual Power that permeates an event such as this — one simply must experience it. It was a fabulous meeting and an even more fabulous experience. It was truly an example of Love and Service in action. Thanks for allowing me to be a part of it."

He could just as well be speaking of the 51st General Service Conference.

Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

It is a privilege to welcome all of you to the 51st General Service Conference. Last year when I came here for the first time I was scared, over-prepared and overwhelmed. In other words, I was a member of the Conference with a lot of questions and a lot of doubts in my mind. These questions were answered quickly as I started to practice some of our basic principles, to listen and to take it "One day at a time." I could feel the love, caring, kindness and understanding that our environment was surrounding us with. I could see the trustees, Class B and Class A, and members of the G.S.O. and Grapevine staff — some of whom I had met before, since I started my general service journey as a G.S.R. from my home group.

Afterward, I realized that all of us together were ready to start a long week of doing the business of our Fellowship. I knew that we were here to work, united as a team, looking for the best for Alcoholics Anonymous. Even though there were a lot of emotions, I had to practice some principles that I learned from my sponsor, like "Rule Sixty-two," "Principles before Personalities," etc., etc. I immediately understood that I had to keep an open mind; that I was



only a part of the process, that our job here is to keep the doors of the Fellowship open for those alcoholics who are still stumbling in the darkness.

As I reflect on the spirituality of this year's theme, "Love and Service," I can see how the simplicity of the Twelve Steps was brought into my life by my sponsor when he invited me to make a Twelfth Step call (my first one). I could see the love and the caring that my sponsor showed for that individual. At that time I didn't know he was doing the basic service that has helped A.A. to grow and be what it is today. During this week we will be listening to presentations related to this theme, and if we listen with our hearts, I believe that it will help us as a team to accomplish our goals.

Welcome to the Panel 51 delegates. This will be an experience that you will never forget. A week full of emotions and maybe some long days of work, but when you get back home you will be ready to share the spirituality that you lived at this Conference. And better than that, the fact that "Love and Service" helped all of us to go through the week.

Welcome back to the Panel 50 delegates. I really don't have words to express my gratitude to all of you for your help. As we embark on another week of what we already know as the General Service Conference experience, I believe that this is the right place where all of us together can express our Love, our Gratitude, and our Service.

I would like to close by saying that coming together here is a beginning, staying together is progress, and working together will ensure the future of Alcoholics Anonymous. I believe that the simplicity of the program that Dr. Bob always wanted has been achieved, and we all benefit from it. May God bless you all.

Al Perez, California, Mid-Southern

Keynote Address

Good morning, I am Elaine McDowell, Class A trustee, and depending upon the outcome of this Conference, for the next several hours or the next several years I will be serving as your trusted servant. I pause at this supposition, but with absolute serenity, because I believe that God's will will be expressed in the group conscience reached in this Conference.

It is a joy and special honor for me to share for the next few minutes on the Conference theme: "Love and Service." They will be discussed separately and then together. I will begin with service. As we gather for the 51st General Service Conference, we realize, as did the members of the first General Service Conference in 1951, how perilous "faith without works" would be for our Fellowship. We also fully understand Bill's message to the individual A.A. member: "Faith alone does not save him. He has to act, do something. He must carry his message to others, practice A.A. principles in all his affairs. Else he slips, he withers, and he dies." "To serve is to live." The significance of the St. Louis International Convention in 1955 was that the Fellowship became the guardians of our three vital Legacies: Recovery, Unity and Service. The Convention dedicated the first evening to the Legacy of Recovery, the second evening to the Legacy of Unity. It was on the final day of the Convention that A.A. took "complete charge of those world services which are the means by which we function as an entire Fellowship, and from which radiate our principal lifelines to those millions all over the globe who still need A.A."

Our service work takes many forms, but essentially it is as Bill stated, "anything whatever that helps us to reach the fellow sufferer — ranging all the way from the Twelfth Step itself to a ten-cent phone call and a cup of coffee..." "Action to carry A.A.'s message is, therefore, the heart of our Third Legacy of Service."

Over the past nine years of my A.A. service I have been impressed by the efforts of the various levels of the service structure to carry the message to special groups through a variety of methods. For example, the development of public service announcements, pamphlets for hard to reach groups and the attention to an ever expanding group of professionals who come in frequent contact with alcoholics are commendable. I am even more impressed with past and present Conference delegates who have dedicated substantial time and effort to reach remote and isolated communities. The recent emergence of new technologies such as the Internet provides both opportunities and challenges for our service work. I believe that reflected in all of these efforts to carry the message is the realization that not only must the message remain authentic, but it also must be placed in a manner that it can reach the still-suffering alcoholic who needs it, no matter what his or her station in life might be.

The Conference that we are part of this week provides the structure that allows us to consult the group conscience of North America. And through our linkage to the World Service Conference we are able to share our experience, strength and hope worldwide. Our response to the suffering alcoholic around the globe is truly phenomenal because the A.A. message is universal and can be embraced by anyone with a desire to stop drinking. This vital Third Legacy "... is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence."

In giving attention to the subject of love, I turned to Bill's writing on Emotional Sobriety. Do you often feel as I do, that his words can grab you by the shoulders and literally shake some sense into you? In this particular section in *The Language of the Heart* Bill is discussing his basic flaw. That is, an "almost absolute dependence — on people or circumstances to supply me with prestige, security and the like." He goes on to state, "There wasn't a chance of making the outgoing love of St. Francis a workable and joyous way of life until these fatal and almost absolute dependencies were cut away."

In the early months of his sobriety, Bill worked very hard with many alcoholics without success. Nevertheless, he realized that this work kept him sober because it was not dependent upon the alcoholic's response. He found that his stability came out of trying to give, not out of demanding that something be returned. In other words it is offering love to that strange drunk on your doorstep who may tell you where you can go and how to get there! It occurs in your sponsorship, when helping some one find sobriety, and they in turn start to give love and attention to another drunk without even a backwards glance to you. Yet you feel happy about it anyway. "...happiness is a by-product — the extra dividend of giving without any demand for a return."

Bill writes, "Reinforced by what grace I could secure in prayer, I found I had to exert every ounce of will and action to cut off these faulty emotional dependencies upon people, upon A.A., indeed, upon any circumstances whatsoever. Then only could I be free to love as Francis had. Emotional and instinctual satisfactions, I saw, were really the extra dividends of having love, offering love, and expressing a love appropriate to each relation of life.

"Plainly, I could not avail myself of God's love until I was able to offer it back to him by loving others as he would have me. And I couldn't possibly do that so long as I was victimized by false dependencies."

Bill found this to be "the primary healing circuit: an outgoing love of his (God's) love for us. It is most clear that the real current can't flow until our paralyzing dependencies are broken, and broken at depth. Only then can we possibly have a glimmer of what adult love really is."

Also, we know that our history often serves as the prologue for our future. Recall those early years when "A.A. power-drivers ran

hog wild." This era has been characterized as one filled with a pre-occupation of A.A. members trying to save the Fellowship from each other, "resulting in anger, suspicion, and all sorts of frightening episodes." It was through those early struggles that the Twelve Steps and the Twelve Traditions were born. Bill informs us that these principles were designed for ego reduction, and therefore for the reduction of our fears. And he states that, "These were the principles which we hoped would hold us in unity and increasing love for each other and for our God." This means, my friends, that we have to accept the good and the not so good in each other. Remember Bill's words: "None of us are saints." "Let us always love the best in others — and never fear the worst."

When placed together, love and service give us a process by which we can become a harmonious whole and thus capable of meeting our primary purpose. Love and service exemplify the whole of our Fellowship working together for the good of the entire Fellowship. Love and service offer the opportunity to help alcoholics without bosses or rules. Love and service speak to mutually reinforcing clusters of trust and faith — trust and faith in each other and a loving God. Love and service then create an environment where we become witnesses of a loving God expressing himself through our group conscience.

Bill found inspiration in the prayer of St. Francis and we may also. Therefore, in the spirit of the theme of this Conference, I would like to end with it:

"Lord, make me a channel of thy peace, that where there is hatred, I may bring love; that where there is wrong, I may bring the spirit of forgiveness; that where there is error, I may bring truth; that where there is doubt, I may bring faith; that where there is despair, I may bring hope; that where there are shadows, I may bring light; that where there is sadness, I may bring joy. Lord, grant that I may seek rather to comfort than to be comforted; to understand than to be understood; to love than to be loved. For it is by giving that one receives. It is by self-forgetting that one finds. It is by forgiving that one is forgiven. And it is by dying that one awakens to eternal life."

In love and service, I remain your trusted servant.

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D., Class A trustee

Workshop — Love and Service

Wednesday morning Conference members divided into groups of 12 to 14 for workshop discussions based on the Conference theme. Following are questions and a summary of responses from these discussions.

As most A.A.s know, our co-founder, Dr. Bob, firmly believed that "love and service" were the cornerstones of Alcoholics Anonymous. In his last major talk, December 1948, Dr. Bob said, "I think the kind of service that really counts is giving of yourself, and that almost invariably requires effort and time." ("The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous," pp. 16-17).

1. Carrying the Message of Service

a) How is the message of service carried in your group, district and area?

The message of service is carried in the group by setting up meetings, making coffee, chairing meetings, raising "Service" as a topic at meetings, sharing service experience at meetings, informing group members about various service positions and what they entail, attracting and welcoming newcomers, sponsorship and the Seventh Tradition. Groups also carry the message of service by having regular business meetings, an active G.S.R. who reports to the group, making A.A. literature available and facili-

tating meetings at treatment and correctional facilities. It is important to share the enthusiasm of service.

The message of service is carried in the district by working on committees, having Service Manual study workshops and other district activities that encourage service. Growth in service is observed in the district. Regular meetings are important. It is also important to have fun while doing service in the district.

The message of service is carried in the area by working on committees, organizing workshops, distributing area G.S.R. handbooks, exhibiting good communication, and by practicing the Seventh Tradition. The area G.S.R. assembly is very important because it inspires groups to form their own service committees. One area provides transportation to area assemblies and conventions. Having a service sponsor is also helpful.

In summary, the message of service is carried by example through all levels of service — group, district and area. Communication and representation to and from all groups is vital. A.A. in action is demonstrated through love and enthusiasm, by being open, encouraging participation and in enjoying the experience. We need to include others in service activities by emphasizing the unity and spiritual aspect of A.A. service.

b) How do I demonstrate A.A. in action to others?

Delegates demonstrate A.A. in action by keeping their commitments to others and showing enthusiasm for their work. They express that service is not an option, but a responsibility. They take people to meetings, act as service sponsors, and take time to explain service positions and acronyms to members. They encourage all to participate and they emphasize the Fellowship of A.A. as a source of activity and the friendships they will develop. They encourage service at home groups and suggest that some members take other service jobs, such as hanging a banner. Demonstrations of A.A. in action include distributing literature and making people aware of *The A.A. Service Manual and Twelve Concepts for World Service*, building web sites, working at intergroup, taking food to area assemblies, taking meetings to treatment and correctional facilities. Delegates make service fun and interesting by helping others and living by example.

c) How can newcomers be attracted to service?

Newcomers can be attracted to service by the example of others, as well as helping A.A. members express what service is doing for their personal sobriety. They are also attracted to service by A.A.s who generate enthusiasm and make service activities enjoyable. It is also helpful when the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions are shared in the home group, when newcomers are encouraged by individual members to get involved, when they are invited to service functions, when A.A.s travel together to service events and assemblies, and when they attend different meetings to hear about service and attend meetings on a regular basis. Members might also include information about their service history and service sponsor in their stories. Service can be an incentive for newcomers when food and entertainment are available at events. Service should be kept simple, letting the committee system work.

d) What are your group, district and area doing to keep the A.A. message attractive and simple?

Everyone agreed that learning to serve begins in the home group, one alcoholic sharing experience with another. Members are attracted to service when they see people involved having fun, looking happy, sharing their gratitude and joy, and talking about the benefits of service to their own growth, sobriety and spirituality. Newcomers are encouraged to ask questions and participate in service events. Service includes keeping commitments

and showing up on time, bringing literature to meetings and taking meetings to hospitals and treatment and correctional facilities, talking to police officers, and reaching out to older adults. Sometimes the message needs to be carried to remote communities. Service includes practicing love, tolerance, patience and willingness, especially listening and keeping an open mind in all our affairs. We are required to give of ourselves in service to others without expecting any "payback" or recovering anything in return for A.A. service. Of course, we receive more than we could ever calculate or describe.

Districts may have combined service and A.A. meetings. One delegate reported that A.A. meetings were held following district meetings to illustrate the link between recovery, unity and service. Share-a-day activities, unity days, workshops and mini-conferences in the area often generate increased interest and participation in service.

2. Living the A.A. Principles in All Our Affairs

a) What are the basic A.A. Principles?

There are 36 A.A. principles that can be reduced to "Love and Service." They include the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts. These principles carry the message of A.A. by helping members to maintain sobriety and maintain our singleness of purpose. They include honesty, open-mindedness and willingness; recovery, unity and service; love and acceptance; unselfishness, humility, patience, and sacrifice; trusting in God, cleaning house and helping others. The basic A.A. principles are spiritual ideals. Taking newcomers to different groups helps them learn to experience the A.A. principles of recovery, unity and service.

b) How does your home group incorporate the A.A. Principles in its structure?

Home groups incorporate the A.A. Principles in their structure by implementing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts at least once a month and by conducting inventories. They read the Preamble and the singleness of purpose statements and strive to keep discussions focused. One district holds monthly secretary meetings and workshops. Home groups also study the Big Book. It is important to acquire group humility by focusing on A.A.'s primary purpose.

Home groups incorporate the A.A. Principles by having greeters at the door, serving food at meetings, loving people into sobriety and being honest, open-minded and willing. They maintain healthy relationships by making amends when necessary and sponsoring people on the A.A. Principles. They understand that by keeping God and the A.A. Principles before self they will become effective service workers. Groups practice the spirit of rotation. Active G.S.R.s offer this program to everyone and practice these principles in all of their affairs.

How do you incorporate the A.A. Principles in your family life, in your job and in sponsorship?

We first learn about the A.A. Principles in our home groups. They include love, honesty, purity, unity, trust, unselfishness, courtesy, kindness, acceptance of others and service. By practicing the Principles inside A.A. we are better able to implement them in our personal lives outside of A.A. These include working the Twelve Steps and keeping the primary purpose active throughout the day. We learn from our successes and mistakes by beginning each day with Step Three and taking daily inventories. We strive for progress not perfection. We keep a positive attitude.

The A.A. Principles are incorporated into one's family life by treating members with the same kindness, honesty, respect and love as one would treat a newcomer. Holding family meetings based on the Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts and asking family members if they observe you living the principles are

other methods of incorporating the A.A. Principles in our family life. Honesty and trust at home are the hardest qualities to bring back to the family, but if we apply the principles in all our affairs, the results can be beyond our wildest dreams.

Along with "Love and Service" it is important to remember "Love and Tolerance" in work and business. Maintaining rights of decision, participation and appeal at the office are pragmatic. When necessary we practice restraint of pen and tongue. We do something each day for someone and not tell anyone. God will give me tomorrow what I have given others today. However, it is not always easy to implement the A.A. Principles at work. One delegate reported, "as long as I focus on my primary purpose at work and not all the stuff going on around me, I am on the right track." Furthermore, this may be the only place where someone is exposed to the A.A. message. As a sponsor, the A.A. Principles are incorporated into our relationships by being living examples. We practice love, understanding, and tolerance.

3. Maintaining the Spirit of Anonymity

a) Discuss the difference between breaking one's anonymity and breaking the Eleventh Tradition of anonymity?

Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. It is based in humility by making us all equal. Every A.A. member has the right to as much anonymity as he or she desires. Anonymity is very important to personal recovery and the survival of our Fellowship as a whole. Maintaining the spirit of anonymity, especially as experienced in the Eleventh Tradition, requires continuous education.

With respect to the Fellowship, breaking our anonymity to express the benefits of sobriety and to carry the message to another is generally acceptable, but it is an individual decision and we need to be mindful of our motives. There are practical reasons for using one's full name within a home group or with sponsees but we should allow newcomers to be comfortable with and aware of their own anonymity.

In contrast, breaking one's anonymity at the public level is destructive to the primary purpose of our Fellowship. The Eleventh Tradition relates to the media (e.g. press, radio, film and internet) and anonymity at this level is important because it protects A.A. as a whole from the ego/self-centeredness of the alcoholic. One can inform others that they once were a drunk and are now recovering and leading a useful life, but one should not reveal their membership in A.A. The experience with the media at the International Convention was largely positive.

b) Discuss the spiritual significance of anonymity.

The spiritual significance of anonymity speaks to humility and growth by giving the true credit for our sobriety to our Higher Power. Humility is "not thinking less of ourselves, it is thinking of ourselves less." The spiritual significance of anonymity is also reflected in the statement "it is not important who is doing what — what is important is that the work gets done."

It is often against the alcoholic's nature to do something without receiving credit; therefore, it is an indication of growth to be able to live in the spirit of anonymity. The spiritual aspect of anonymity is being one among many. One delegate reported, "I feel that I set myself apart from others when I think I am special." Individual A.A. members try to achieve and demonstrate selfless acts and deeds. In service it is important to be willing to do the "unglamorous" work and not just the high profile, highly visible work that feeds the ego. Maintaining a true spirit of anonymity gets the self out of the way so that God has room to move in. The spiritual significance of anonymity is the desire to seek God's will.

Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2001 Conference.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

1 The theme for the 2002 General Service Conference be: "Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts."

2 The following be Presentation/Discussion topics for the 2002 General Service Conference:

a) Unity:

- 1) Spirit of Rotation — Letting Go!
- 2) Does Our Committee System Work?
- 3) The Internet — A Part of or Apart From?

b) Inventory:

- 1) A.A. Literature — Is It Being Utilized or Collecting Dust?
- 2) Seventh Tradition and Spirituality — Do They Really Mix?

3 The following be the Workshop Topic for the 2002 General Service Conference:

"Using the Steps, Traditions and Concepts in Our Daily Lives."

ARCHIVES¹

No recommendations.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

No recommendations.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

No recommendations.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

4 If the Reserve Fund exceeds the 12-month upper limit we allow a one-year period to review the Reserve Fund level, followed by a second year to formulate actions to adjust Reserve Fund below 12 months operating expenses.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

5 La Viña continue to be published by the A.A. Grapevine and supported by the General Service Board as a service to the Fellowship.

6 La Viña continue to be published utilizing A.A. Grapevine resources in order to achieve efficiencies in production and distribution.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

It was recommended that:

7 The undernoted three (3) cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be given equal consideration as a site for the International Convention in the Year 2010: Detroit, Indianapolis, San Antonio.

8 The bid process for city site-selection for International Conventions be moved forward from ten years to twelve years out from the event; site-selection taking place as follows: Site-selection to occur in 2003 for 2015, site-selection to occur in 2008 for 2020.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

9 The Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be approved keeping in mind the 1995 Conference Advisory Action which reads, "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Doctor Bob's Nightmare' and the Appendices remain as is" and keeping in mind the 1999 Conference Action which reads, "The Publications Department of the General Service Office maintain the following specific editorial responsibilities regarding the Fourth Edition Big Book Project:

- Editorial 'fine tuning' such as footnotes, punctuation, capitalization, spelling, updating, jacket materials, page numbers, etc. Thus, page numbers are likely to change for content after page 164.

- Coordinating the flow of work between the book designer, typesetters, proofreaders and the production people, who order the paper and schedule the printing with the book manufacturer.

- In the case of the proposed Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the G.S.O. editors would prepare or coordinate new material and changes such as:

New Material

Cover and jacket design
Jacket copy
Preface
Foreword to the
Fourth Edition

Changes

Title page
Contents page
Factual material that appears
in footnotes
Introductions to personal stories.

Note: In keeping with the 1997 Conference Action which requested the development of a publication of stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the committee asked that the trustees' Literature Committee bring a draft manuscript of these stories to the 2002 Conference Literature Committee.

10 Keeping in mind the 1995 Conference Advisory Action which reads, "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Doctor Bob's Nightmare' and the Appendices remain as is," the current Preface be updated for the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

11 The Publications Department of the General Service Office be responsible for the order of stories in the Fourth Edition of the Big

¹ Secondary committee.

Book following page 164 and "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" which will remain as the first story in the "Pioneers of A.A." section.

Note: The committee suggested that the Personal Stories Section Titles in the Fourth Edition of the Big Book remain "Pioneers of A.A.," "They Stopped In Time," and "They Lost Nearly All."

12 The Twelve Concepts (short form), with a brief introduction, be added to the Appendices Section in future printings of the Big Book.

13 G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site address be added to the Appendix "How to Get in Touch With A.A." in future printings of the Big Book.

14 The pamphlet "Can A.A. Help Me Too? — Black/African Americans Share Their Stories" be approved.

15 A pamphlet titled "A.A. For the Older Alcoholic — Never Too Late" to replace the pamphlet "Time to Start Living" be approved for publication after the current pamphlet inventory is depleted.

16 The pamphlet "A.A. For the Older Alcoholic — Never Too Late" be published in 14 point type, large-print format only, as this format would fit our current literature racks.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

17 Maureen Maguire, Panel 51 alternate delegate, British Columbia/Yukon Area 79, be admitted to the Conference because Bob Allen, Panel 51 area delegate, is unable to attend.

18 Günther Habedank, general manager of the G.S.O. for Germany, be admitted to the Conference as an observer; and that Maxi Kowalczyk, staff member in the German G.S.O., also be admitted to the Conference as an observer and translator for Günther.

19 An observer's attendance at Conference Committee meetings and Delegates Only Meetings would need individual committee approval.

20 The Fifty-Fourth General Service Conference be held April 18-24, 2004, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

21 The 2001 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 1998 A.A. Membership Survey.

22 A new television Public Service Announcement (approximate cost \$30,000) be developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee and be presented for review to the 2002 Conference Public Information Committee, because a more current P.S.A.

might increase media usage and better reach the still-suffering alcoholic.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

23 In the section titled "Third Legacy Procedure" in Chapter One on Page S21 referring to the fifth ballot, the sentence "At this point, balloting usually involves only the top two or three candidates" be removed from *The A.A. Service Manual* and replaced with the following:

"At this point, the top two candidates remain. In case there are ties for first place, all tied first place candidates remain. In case there are no ties for first place, the top candidate and any tied second-place candidates remain."

24 "Telephone A.A. meetings" that request to be listed in A.A. Directories be added to the section "International Correspondence Meetings" on Page V under a section to be titled "Telephone Meetings."

TREATMENT FACILITIES

No recommendations.

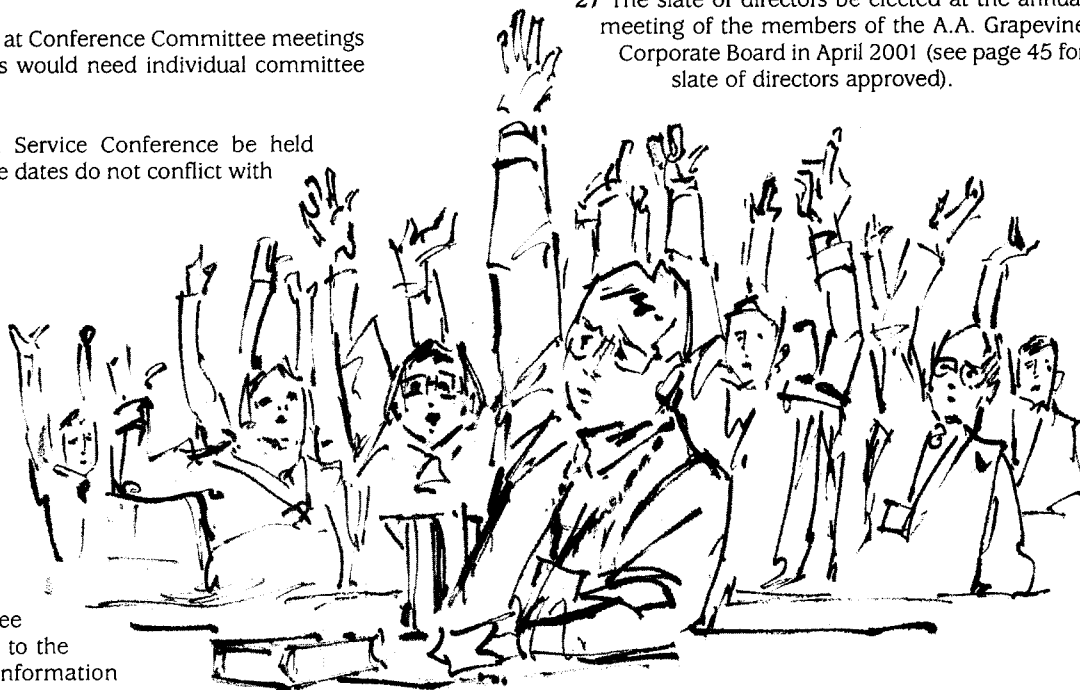
TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

25 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2001 (see page 45 for approved slate).

26 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in April 2001 (see page 45 for slate of directors approved).

27 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board in April 2001 (see page 45 for slate of directors approved).



Presentations and Reports

REPORT: SUBCOMMITTEE OF THE TRUSTEES' LITERATURE COMMITTEE'S PROGRESS REPORT ON PROPOSED FOURTH EDITION OF THE BIG BOOK

Sunday afternoon, following a rundown of the mechanics of Conference week, Jim Clough, Pacific regional trustee, who chairs the trustees' Literature Committee, gave a progress report on the status of the proposed Fourth Edition of Alcoholics Anonymous.

I am privileged to serve as the chair of the trustees' Literature Committee and also as a member of the Fourth Edition Big Book subcommittee. The original subcommittee was formed in May 1997 as a result of an Advisory Action of the 47th General Service Conference. I will recap all Advisory Actions concerning the proposed Fourth Edition and then outline the subcommittee procedures and recommendations since its formation. The original 1997 Advisory Action recommended that a draft Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be developed and a progress report be brought to the 1998 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind the 1995 Advisory Action that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is."

A progress report was submitted to the 1998 Conference Literature Committee, and their recommendation to the 1998 Conference resulted in an Advisory Action, which stated that: "A draft Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, continue to be developed and a progress report brought to the 1999 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind that, if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: 'The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare' and the Appendices remain as is.'"

Again, a progress report was submitted to the 1999 Conference Literature Committee. The committee recommended, and the 1999 General Service Conference passed, three Advisory Actions:

The first action stated that a progress report and/or a draft of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be brought to the 2000 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind, that if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is."

The second action of the 1999 Conference stated that the Publications Department of the General Service Office maintain the following specific editorial responsibilities regarding the Fourth Edition Big Book Project: editorial "fine tuning" such as footnotes, punctuation, capitalization, spelling, updating, jacket materials, page numbers, etc. Thus, page numbers are likely to change for content after page 164.

Coordinating the flow of work between the book designer, typesetters, proofreaders and the production people, who order the paper and schedule the printing with the book manufacturer would also be the responsibility of the Publications Department.

In the case of the proposed Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the G.S.O. editors would prepare or coordinate new material and changes such as: *New Material* — Cover and jacket design; jacket copy; foreword to the Fourth Edition. *Changes*: Title page; contents page; factual material that appears in footnotes; introductions to personal stories.

The third 1999 Advisory Action recommended that, based on precedent in regard to previous editions of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the A.A. history book, and *Daily Reflections*, any draft copy of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be considered a work-in-progress, and as such, is confidential; the operating principle being that any story material brought forward to the Conference Literature Committee will be done on a "for-their-eyes-only" basis, adhering to the principle of the "right of decision," and not brought forward for any other general distribution until publication.

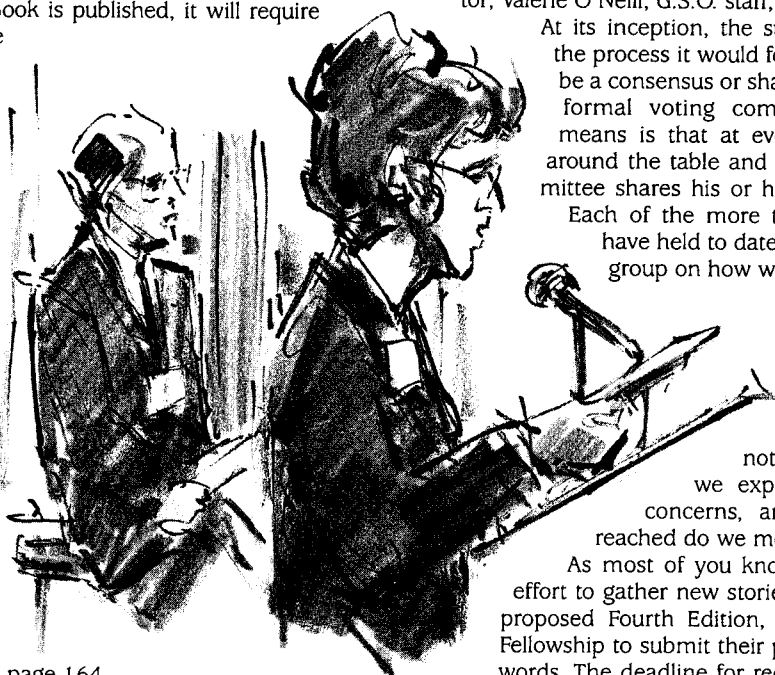
In May 2000, the 50th General Service Conference passed an Advisory Action, which recommended that: Following serious consideration of the comments and suggestions expressed at a joint meeting of the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees about the proposed new stories and the list of stories from the Third Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* to be included in the Fourth Edition, a draft copy of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, or a progress report be brought to the 2001 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind that if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is.'"

Members currently serving on the subcommittee are: Richard Roughton, general service trustee, chairperson of the subcommittee; David Every, Grapevine director; Marne Hill, Eastern Canada regional trustee; John Koster, A.A.W.S. director; Beth Rabren, Southwest regional trustee; Vinnie McCarthy, Publications director; Valerie O'Neill, G.S.O. staff, Literature coordinator.

At its inception, the subcommittee determined that the process it would follow in its deliberations would be a consensus or sharing model rather than a more formal voting committee structure. What this means is that at every step of our work, we go around the table and each member of the subcommittee shares his or her view on the topic at hand.

Each of the more than twenty-five meetings we have held to date has begun with a sense of the group on how we are experiencing our process and progress of our current assignment. Every step taken is by unanimous group conscience. We do not rely on "yea" or "nay" votes. If there is a sense that we are not together, our process stops, we explore our different views and concerns, and only when unanimity is reached do we move forward.

As most of you know, in September 1997, in an effort to gather new stories for possible inclusion in the proposed Fourth Edition, the subcommittee asked the Fellowship to submit their personal stories of up to 3,500 words. The deadline for receipt of manuscripts was June



1, 1998 and the response was a gratifying 1,222 personal stories. The initial work of the subcommittee was to review the 1,222 stories in several stages, which were called "rounds." Each story was first read separately by individual members of the subcommittee, then by members working in pairs, and finally by the full subcommittee, so that every story was thoroughly reviewed. As stories were reviewed, we determined which of them we believed were possibilities for inclusion in a Fourth Edition. The subcommittee was grateful to find that the stories submitted were wonderful and the challenge became the need to set aside stories.

Some of the guidelines developed by the committee for use in the selection of stories include a description of what happened from the mental compulsion to the physical craving; a narrative of the progress of the disease including the denial, the alibis, and self-delusion; the self-imposed crisis that made the author look at his or her drinking; the description of one's introduction to A.A. sponsorship, spiritual development and how the author works the program, offering a solution to the newcomer and participation in A.A. service.

Throughout its work, the subcommittee looked for the best possible A.A. stories representing the current membership, always remembering what Bill W. stated: "We are looking for straight personal narratives which describe the drinking history, how the newcomer arrived in Alcoholics Anonymous, how A.A. affected him, and what A.A. has since accomplished for him." After thoroughly reviewing 1,222 stories by late spring of 1999, the original subcommittee had reduced the stories to 95. Those who had submitted stories that would not be included in the Fourth Edition were notified and their stories were returned. Using the same criteria as on the newly submitted stories, and remembering Bill's words regarding what constitutes a good A.A. narrative: "The main purpose of the revision is to bring the story section up to date, to portray more adequately a cross section of those who have found help — the audience for the book is people who are coming to Alcoholics Anonymous now. Those who are here have already heard our stories. Since the audience for the book is likely to be newcomers, anything from the point of view of content or style that might offend or alienate those who are not familiar with the program should be eliminated," the subcommittee selected seventeen "keeper" stories from the Third Edition to recommend for inclusion in the Fourth Edition.

In May 1999, several original members rotated off the subcommittee and others joined the group. Their task was to review the 95 new stories selected by the first subcommittee and, ultimately, to select the best of the best. In the course of our deliberations, using the same criteria, the 95 stories became a short list of 38. Aware that they had ten to fifteen too many stories, the subcommittee then recommended that the 2000 Conference Literature Committee be sent the 38 stories selected by the subcommittee, as well as a list of stories in the Third Edition that were suggested for inclusion in the proposed Fourth Edition. The members of the Conference Literature Committee were asked to adhere to the confidentiality policy of the subcommittee. That same information was also sent to the members of the trustees' Literature Committee not currently serving on the Big Book Subcommittee. A joint meeting of the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees was held on Saturday, April 29, 2000, prior to the opening of the General Service Conference for the purpose of obtain-

ing input about the selected stories. On May 2, 2000, following this joint meeting, the trustees' Literature Committee met and gave serious consideration to the extremely valuable input received. They proceeded through the sharing model to select 25 of the 38 new stories to be forwarded to Publications for editing.

In July 2000, the trustees' Big Book Subcommittee met to reconsider the 17 "keeper" stories from the Third Edition Big Book proposed for inclusion in the Fourth Edition. The subcommittee discussed page count and content and unanimously chose to drop one story and add one story from the Third Edition. It was recommended to the trustees' Literature Committee that these 17 stories be forwarded to Publications for possible inclusion pending final determination of the length and content of the book.

The Fourth Edition Subcommittee next met on October 26, 2000, to review a binder of the 25 new edited stories with editing notes, and the 17 "keeper" stories with their respective editing notes. There was strong praise for the excellent quality of editing and for the user-friendly binder-style organization of the information provided by the Publications Department. Publications estimated that some additional pages needed to be cut from these stories to maintain a page count similar to the Third Edition Big Book. As a result, the subcommittee submitted their written suggestions for a second round of editing and agreed to reduce the number of stories carried forward from the Third Edition from 17 to 16 stories. In addition, the subcommittee agreed that the selection process had resulted in capturing broad and diverse A.A. experience, although the criteria for stories had been focused on recovery from alcoholism.

On January 25, 2001, the subcommittee reviewed the second round of edits of all stories. Based on a revised projected page count, the subcommittee agreed to reduce the number of new stories from 25 to 24. With much gratitude for the opportunity to participate in this process, the subcommittee agreed to forward the binder presentation of a draft compilation of all stories, along with working titles and editing notes to be mailed in February to the Conference and trustees' Literature Committee for their review. In keeping with the 1999 Conference Advisory Action, introductions to personal stories will be prepared by the Publications Department after Conference approval of the Fourth Edition Big Book.

Jim Clough, Pacific regional trustee



REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon, the Finance report was given by Ron Gauthier, A.A.W.S. director. Art Knight, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairperson of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, could not be present. The report was followed by questions and sharing. For more details please see the Finance section of this Report, and the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee's report.

As a friend of Alcoholics Anonymous. I'm here today in gratitude, both for the wonderful gift A.A. has given to our family in the restored life of a precious loved one, and for the personal gift association with this Fellowship has given to me. Now in my sixth year of service as a nonalcoholic trustee, I continue to see how the power of this program has changed my life in many ways, and I thank you for the opportunity to be "in service," and "of service" (I hope), to this Fellowship.

In the back of this report is the complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company. Kevin Sunkel, our auditor, is available at the Conference, and Don Meurer, G.S.O. controller and both Bob Slotterback, who served as Grapevine controller until recently, and Linda Thaler, your new Grapevine controller, are here to help answer any questions. I want to formally acknowledge the outstanding service that Kevin, Don and Bob provide to this Fellowship, and I'm sure next year I'll be adding Linda to that roster. While they are all nonalcoholics, they are clearly alive with the same love of this Fellowship that you have.

Our chair, Gary Glynn, and the chairs of the respective boards, Marne Hill and Jim Clough (who filled in for Jackie Johnston), have covered the salient points of this past year's financial performance, so I will deliver not only the fine points of the "good news," but also the "bad news."

I'm going to start with the good news first. Your Fellowship is in excellent financial health, with results from both the General Service Office and the International Convention substantially better than expected. As a result of this unusually good financial performance, the Reserve Fund stands at an equivalent 11.6 months of operating reserves. The outlook for the year 2001 is positive and will enable the Fellowship to continue to carry the message around the world. That is all good news.

Total revenues from all sources were \$11,273,000, compared to a budget of \$10,782,000. That's a substantial \$491,000 better than expected, essentially due to greater book sales and contributions. For the second year in a row, we saw an increase in both unit and dollar sales of the Big Book, our mainstay of recovery literature. Sales were more than 5% better than budget and 3% better than '99. Most importantly, that increase was totally due to higher sales to A.A. groups and central offices, rather than to institutional buyers.

But the really enormous "good news" is that contributions increased for the third year in a row, topping the budget by more than 4% and the previous year by over 6%.

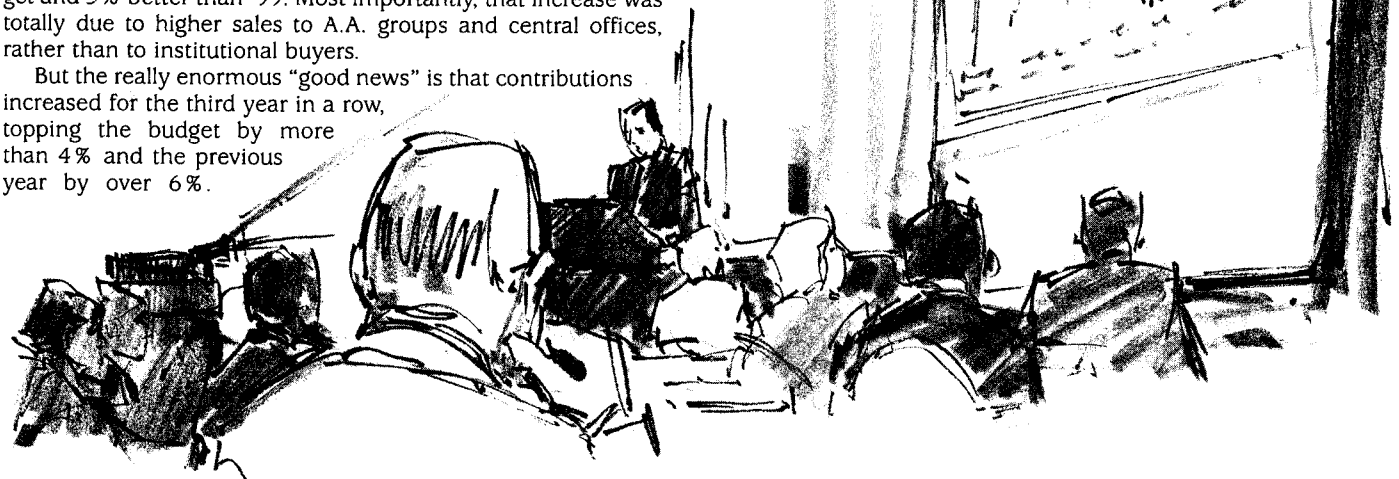
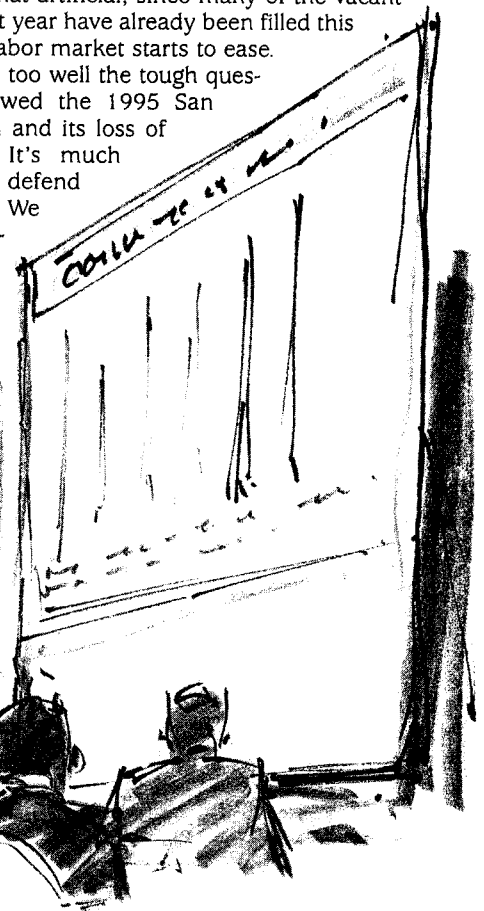
Contributions reached slightly more than \$4.5 million, breaking the previous high set just a decade ago. While the percent of groups contributing to the G.S.O. has remained in the 44% range for six years now (down from a high of 56% in 1987), the average contribution per group has now reached \$80.

While the gains at G.S.O. in both contributions and book sales were the primary contributors to the overall increase in income, the Grapevine also registered a modest \$38,000 gain from budget, primarily from a slight increase in magazine circulation to 115,700. As this chart shows, Grapevine circulation has been stuck in an uncomfortable range between 115,000 and 120,000 subscriptions for the last four years, and while it was good to see 700 more subscriptions than budgeted, it was not enough to bring the operation to breakeven.

Total expenses of \$10,355,000 were well below the budget of \$10,766,000, and here again, the bulk of the savings were realized at the General Service Office. However, these "savings" are somewhat misleading, since most of the lessened spending was due to the fact that many open requisitions for office positions remained unfilled through a good part of the year.

The combination of these factors resulted in a significant \$983,000 income at G.S.O., offset by somewhat more modest losses of \$16,000 and \$50,000, respectively, at the Grapevine and La Viña, leading to a combined income from ongoing operations of over \$900,000 (\$917,541 to be specific). Since we had anticipated just a \$15,000 profit in the budget, the gain from original expectations was equally large at \$902,000. Impressive...but, again, let me point out that the savings realized were somewhat artificial, since many of the vacant positions from last year have already been filled this year as the tight labor market starts to ease.

I remember all too well the tough questioning that followed the 1995 San Diego Convention and its loss of over \$600,000. It's much more pleasant to defend a gain than a loss! We budget international Conventions to break even, since the major determinant — attendance — is dif-



difficult to accurately forecast. In 1995, we budgeted 60,000 paid attendees and just 56,000 registered. For Minneapolis, the budget was for 42,000, and 47,000 happy A.A.s and their equally happy friends and families showed up! That meant substantially more revenue than expected and, combined with lower expenses, allowed net income of almost a million dollars.

When viewing the entire history of the Fellowship's ten Conventions, stretching back 45 years, I suspect that the variation from profit to loss and back to profit again might mirror the history of many area, state and regional conventions—sometimes they do OK, sometimes they lose money. Hearing of the experiences of many areas as to how local convention activities are handled, this year the trustee's Finance Committee asked the Conference Committee on Finance for some guidance. Hopefully, their discussions will save future treasurers the task of trying to explain the wide swings from one Convention to the next!

The combination of over \$900,000 in income from operations, combined with the \$998,000 of income from the International gives the Fellowship the financial wherewithal to add one and one-half million to our Reserve Fund, not only ensuring the capability to service groups carrying the message in their local areas, but also to offer the helping hand of A.A. anywhere in the world. To me, that's the reality — and the spirituality — of the Seventh Tradition.

So, based on these results, where does the Reserve Fund stand today? Following the transfer of \$1.5 million from G.S.O., the Fund rose from 9.9 months to 11.6 months of equivalent operating expenses. After deliberate actions were taken in 1995 to reduce the Fund, you can see that it held quite steady in the nine to ten-month range for several years, and, in fact was at 9.7 months before the last transfer of funds from G.S.O. Let's not forget the purpose of the Reserve Fund. It was not, and is not, intended to fund operating losses from the service entities. It is to provide the financial resources necessary to continue essential services to the Fellowship in the event of an unexpected reduction in revenues; it's the shock absorber that allows a continuing stream of services regardless of current economic circumstances. However, based on this year's results, we are coming close to the cap established by the 27th Conference. While the budget for 2001 does not anticipate breaking through the twelve-month cap, the trustees' Finance Committee has asked the Conference Finance Committee for guidance in determining the best way to handle any future excess funding.

So much for the "good news" about this past year, what about that "bad news" I mentioned earlier? Well, here it is. Your Fellowship is in excellent financial health, with results from both the General Service Office and the International Convention substantially better than expected. As a result of this unusually good financial performance, the Reserve Fund was augmented by \$1.5 million dollars and today stands at an equivalent 11.6 months of operating reserves.

This is good news, because it will enable the Fellowship to continue to effectively carry the message. However, from my very personal perspective, if there are those in the Fellowship who perceive this unique financial situation as an abundance of riches, then it is "bad news" indeed. "Ah, let's not send any money to New York...they don't need it...they made close to a million bucks on the Convention alone!" I believe it's our collective responsibility to carry the message — the good news that this past year's results are what enable the hand of A.A. to always be there.

Let's look at the budget for 2001. Generally speaking, G.S.O. gets its funding to support Fellowship services from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. When we put numbers to that equation, this year, contributions are forecast to pro-

vide close to \$4.6 million dollars, and the net revenue from literature is anticipated to provide about \$5.1 million to defray the cost of services provided to the Fellowship by G.S.O. In my opinion, based on last year's experience, this G.S.O. budget reflects prudent optimism. It anticipates a modest 2% increase in contributions and flat literature unit sales, with no planned change in pricing. These assumptions result in projected income for this year of \$9,702,000, essentially the same as last year. Total expenses, however, are expected to rise to \$9,565,000, an increase of about \$775,000 over last year's level. As I noted earlier, most of the vacant positions from last year are already filled, and additional funds have been provided for PSAs, and for a significant \$90,000 increase in literature assistance to other areas of the world. Based on these assumptions, G.S.O. is projecting a modest income of \$137,000 for this year.

Turning to the Grapevine, we can view its finances in a similar way. Like G.S.O., it receives its income from sales of its principal publication, the Grapevine, as well as sales of other special items, like *The Language of the Heart*, other specialty literature, tapes and calendars. However, by its very charter, the Grapevine receives no contributions, and therefore, if it cannot break even, it must look to the Reserve Fund to make up any deficit. As I noted in discussing its purpose earlier, the Reserve Fund was never intended to fund operating losses indefinitely, and I'm pleased to report that this year, the Grapevine budget projects essentially a breakeven from operations.

Revenues will decrease to \$1,451,000, primarily due to a reduction in gross profit from specialty items, but operating expenses are expected to decrease by more than the reduction in income, leading to essentially a breakeven. We will, however, experience one-time charges for the outsourcing and reorganization effort that allows the Grapevine to reach this breakeven, and these charges—incurred in 2001 only—will be \$338,000. Hopefully, we have seen the last of seven consecutive years of losses from the Grapevine, and will now return to a period of self-sufficiency. In my personal opinion, if we are unable to reach and sustain at least a breakeven over the next handful of years, future Grapevine Boards, trustees' Finance Committees and the Conference as a whole, should seriously consider a reorganization of the Grapevine to preserve its editorial independence while integrating as many operating aspects with the G.S.O. as possible to insure financial integrity.

Finally, let's look at the La Viña budget. As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference to provide a powerful printed recovery message for our Spanish-speaking members. Since its inception, circulation has appeared to stabilize in the 8,000-8,500 range, producing very modest revenues (this year just \$8,500), while expenses hover in the \$60,000 to \$75,000 range. This year the loss at La Viña is expected to be about \$63,000. So, over the life of the project to date, the Fellowship has invested about \$445,000. As you know, the General Service Board has recommended to this Conference that La Viña continue to be published indefinitely at the General Service Board's expense.

So there you have it, a 2001 budget that anticipates revenues of slightly over \$11.1 million, expenses of about the same magnitude—before the one-time Grapevine charges—and an operating income of just about \$74,000. When we include the one-time expenses, the expected loss totals \$264,000. Now we see why a prudent reserve is so critically important. And that's also why I can report to you that your Fellowship remains in good financial condition and continues to have the financial wherewithal to carry the message to that still-suffering alcoholic, wherever he or she may be.

Arthur L. Knight, Jr., treasurer, General Service Board

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE — EMBRACING CHANGE

Monday afternoon's presentation/discussion session was chaired by Tom Maguirre, general service trustee and Grapevine director.

In the Fellowship

Looking at a Grapevine from 1974, I discovered that the same messages hold true today. A.A.s all over the world share their thoughts with the Grapevine. "Our Meeting-In-Print" offered solutions in sobriety and freedom for everyone. The A.A. Preamble in the Grapevines explains its intent. I have been an avid reader for years.

Upon being given Grapevines from the 1960s, I immediately noticed the same problems existed then as they do today. It is amazing how we have the same solutions to solve problems of change. Like many oldtimers, I was also afraid of A.A. changing. But because of A.A., I've learned that fear is a self-centered response to reality. Fear is overcome by faith. It is how our Higher Power works. Is not a spiritual awakening merely another way of describing change? The message is full of love and service. A.A. always gets back to the supreme spirit, which will always be there, and absolute spiritual truths will not disappear. A similar message was in the October 1999 Grapevine.

I have had the privilege of taking the Grapevine to shut-ins. I will never forget my first visit. I was told my shut-in was an old-timer, a black man in a nursing home who couldn't talk but could mutter, could understand what you were saying, and was able to read. I first saw Allen S. sitting slumped over in a wheelchair. I approached him, introduced myself as a friend of Bill W's, and said I was from Area 55 Shut-in Committee. He smiled, lifted his head and mumbled (as I was expecting). He also tried to extend his hand to me. I told him I wanted him to have a copy of the Grapevine, our meeting-in-print. I handed it to him and he grasped it to his heart and smiled. He held on to it like I had given him his life back. He tried to extend his other hand to grasp mine, nodded his head and smiling, tears in his eyes. I knew the tears were tears of love. I played only a small role of service and my pay in return was something money couldn't buy — Love and Service. We continue the practice in our area of taking all shut-ins a Grapevine when we visit them.

I also feel privileged to share my copies of La Viña with other Hispanic alcoholics in our area. We have several Spanish-speaking groups. I take it to the group, share it, and encourage them to get their own copy and save them. Many of them share them at home, because not everyone in the family can read and speak English. They ask me to help save La Viña, and I tell them we must get others to subscribe. It is not something I alone can do. This is so little to give, for what so freely has been given to me through our meeting-in-print. We also encourage groups to buy subscriptions for doctors' offices and school libraries to allow others to become familiar with a tool that helps save many lives. For that I am very proud to share my love and service with others.

Shirley Bair, NW Ohio/SE Michigan delegate

In Technology

It is a privilege to participate in this Conference and to comment on how the Grapevine, by utilizing the Internet, is embracing the new changes afforded by the technological advances. As the Web site manager, I have the opportunity to witness on a daily basis the way the Grapevine is able to employ the Internet and spread the Fellowship's message to a largely new audience. And, make no mistake, the Internet is here to stay; its usage is skyrocketing. According to some sources, worldwide Internet usage is doubling every year. And, nearly 40% of the English-speaking world now has Internet access. But, since I'm not Bill Gates, let me zero in specifically on the Grapevine's Web site. A survey that we conducted last year shows a much different population than those who currently subscribe to the Grapevine. This is really heartening, for it gives us the opportunity to extend love and service to a population that is different from the magazine's historical subscription base. As the survey showed, on average, our Web site is being visited by a younger group that is also split pretty evenly between men and women. Further, a majority of the individuals who visit the site enjoy anywhere from two to ten years of sobriety.

The Grapevine's Web site currently has three major components: an Archives Section that now contains about 120 previously published articles; an On-line Catalog that offers subscription and renewal information along with books, audiocassette tapes and other products; and, finally, a moderated bulletin board known as the "i-Say" forum, which is really an extension of the PO Box 1980 letters section of the magazine. This PO Box section is where we publish many of the varied and often conflicting opinions of A.A. members, as well as their thoughts about articles in recent issues and matters of current interest in A.A. As Bill W. noted in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*: "The Grapevine is the mirror of A.A. thought and action, worldwide. It is a sort of magic carpet on which all of us can travel from one distant A.A. outpost to another. . . ." (p. 202) This i-Say forum is a prime example of how changes in technology via the Internet have broadened our appeal and extended Bill's magic carpet to access a larger number of A.A.s. Not only are replies to postings possible in a matter of days, instead of months, but i-Say is also not constrained by the space limitations inherent in our monthly publication.

We all know that discomfort often accompanies change. For example, when incorporating changes afforded by Internet technology to our Web site, it was not a totally painless experience. The evolution of i-Say illustrates perfectly how we at the Grapevine had a significant challenge in finding the appropriate balance between permitting open communication on the Internet, while at the same time respecting the Traditions. Originally, i-Say enjoyed a brief life as an unedited, real time medium. After some controversy that focused primarily on anonymity, i-Say became a moderated, edited bulletin board which does not operate in real time. In its present form, i-Say not only ensures the anonymity of any contributors, but it also permits the review of content for appropriateness before the actual postings take place.

Because it is not in real time and therefore precludes spontaneity, some might be critical of the moderated aspect of our bulletin board. However, it is not a subject we have treated lightly. Ensuring anonymity is one of the greatest expressions of love our Fellowship offers and it is not something that we at the Grapevine in any way want to jeopardize.

The future of our Web site is most promising. In 1999, we were averaging about 8,600 hits a month; a year later that number was almost 10,000 and, in early 2001, we are on track to average

Richard Levesque (Arkansas) was reading the latest Grapevine on the plane enroute to the Conference. A flight attendant leaned over and asked, "Anything special in this issue?" For the next three minutes, at 30,000 feet, Richard and Mary Pat had a two-person meeting and Richard's white knuckles disappeared.

11,000 visits a month. Catalog and subscription sales via the Web site are showing the same sort of growth rate, which suggests we must be doing something right.

Meanwhile, we continue examining new ways to improve our Web site — one is to expand the archive component, which we are doing on a monthly basis; another is to make it easier to subscribe to our publication. And, to me, a most encouraging note is that even in its moderated form, the i-Say forum is attracting contributions from the still-active alcoholic who often is striving to find that initial life raft in sobriety. What better way to spread the word of our Fellowship through love and service than to give feedback to those Internet visitors who are reaching out for help.

*Maggie Keogh, GV Web site manager &
Special Projects coordinator*

In the Office

I was honored to receive an invitation to share on "Embracing Change in the Grapevine Office." As is my usual custom, I headed for *A.A. Comes of Age*, *The Language of the Heart*, and *As Bill Sees It* to get some inspiration. This time, Growth and Change came out as themes that felt right. As in my own recovery and life, I have found that sticking to basics and keeping it simple helps to keep change in its proper perspective. Implementing and living through change at the Grapevine office or anywhere else in today's world will require listening, communicating, accepting and making choices about our roles and lives. As you know, the Grapevine Office is here to help get the word out via our "meeting in print." Augmenting this simple purpose, the Grapevine Board developed the following Mission Statement at its retreat in September 2000: to oversee the publishing operations of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.; to provide sound financial management of the corporation; to establish corporate policies and set corporate priorities; to engage in the ongoing process of strategic planning; to operate in accordance with the principles of A.A., as expressed in the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts.

While your Grapevine Board was beginning to put our new mission in place, changes began to occur in the Grapevine process and office. Change usually does not come in nice neat, compartmentalized packets in perfect order for easy handling, and our office is no exception to the rule. It is interesting to note that three of the highest impact changes were not even on the drawing board at the time of last year's 50th General Service Conference. Here is some insight into what is happening.

In January, the executive editor reached a mutual agreement with the GV Board to pursue creative outside opportunities. Late last year, the controller of the Grapevine, seeking an opportunity to grow, accepted a job at your General Service Office. During the fourth quarter of last year, outside consultants hired by the General Service Board recommended that the Grapevine outsource its fulfillment operation, thereby creating savings and having a favorable effect on the Grapevine balance sheet. However, this would mean a reduction of force and seven Grapevine staff members would be losing their jobs during April and June of 2001.

Even one of the above scenarios, on its own, would create a major change, let alone all three scenarios occurring simultaneously. How was the board going to embrace these changes in a positive manner? What about the timely delivery of the Grapevine, La Viña and other related products? Who would manage the Grapevine? What would happen to staff with all of this change?

The board assigned two of the Grapevine trustees the responsibilities of the day-to-day Grapevine operations. The two trustees began traveling into the office one day a week to meet with staff,

make financial and human resource decisions and begin to effect change with staff. A research process was also underway to hire a new director of finances. Lastly, an outsourcing plan of our fulfillment operation was developed and the implementation process was in full swing.

What we, the two GV trustees, began to notice was that the senior staff members were beginning to embrace these changes with an honest, open and willing approach. They were operating as a team, without really noticing, and they became very effective in their day-to-day operations. They were basically managing themselves. There was an excitement in the office! All products were being delivered on time, with the same quality that is expected by our readership. One of the senior staff members volunteered to become the interim Spanish editor of La Viña. A former managing editor of the Grapevine returned to help us over the hurdles. The GV Board began meeting regularly with some of the unsung heroes of the magazine — those who sit on the Editorial Advisory Board. With their help, and that of all staff members, we have been able to continue with successful operations and generate new ideas along the way.

The board is looking to be as fair as possible to minimize adverse staff reactions of those employees that are being severed. The board is also very much attuned to the change of management process that must be in place for those employees who will remain on staff. A transition process and a space management review are being developed.

The major support of the General Service Board throughout this entire process is very much appreciated. The General Service Board can help us by objectively assessing actions to ensure sound motives that will result in positive changes.

Are we embracing change in the office? Yes, most definitely! Where are we today, April 23rd, 2001? Less than two months ago, a new director of finances was hired at the Grapevine. The former controller is splitting his time between training the new director and the start-up of his duties at the General Service Office. The outsourcing and reduction in force are on schedule. The search process has begun for a new executive editor and the Grapevine Board is very enthusiastic that this process will be completed in the near future.

In the meantime, we all need to be sure we understand what is happening, why it is necessary, and how we can continue to value the past while finding ways to help people let go of it. Our sense of humor, relationships and resilience will come in handy for these changes, just as they do for the changes we face every day in every facet of our lives.

*Tony Taschner, Northeast regional trustee and
Grapevine director*

SPANISH TRANSLATIONS

*Monday evening's presentation/discussion session was moderated
by Jan Polak, A.A.W.S. director.*

Where Are We Now?

When asked to give a presentation on this topic I almost balked. First, I have a slightly different view of our Spanish literature translation problems that we have before us. Another reason is that the Spanish literature translation dilemma in New Mexico has taken a back seat to the problem of lack of unity with our Hispanic groups. We have made much progress in the area of verbal translations in New Mexico. We purchased translating equipment back in 1993. This slowly brought into being an active, viable Bilingual Committee that became part of our area standing committees in 1999. This committee now has a group of volun-

teer interpreters that attend each assembly so we can translate the whole assembly for the Spanish-speaking members. The problem is that we have very little participation from the Hispanic groups, yet we continue to get the word out and have workshops across the state with hopes of encouraging our Spanish-speaking groups to attend our assemblies.

Although the Spanish literature translation problem may have taken a back seat in New Mexico, that is not the case in our Southwest Region over the years. I have seen much heated debate over this issue. I agree that we do need to look at this problem, but let us not be too hasty in reaching a decision. With all love and respect to my Hispanic brothers and sisters, I believe that we must always place principles before personalities, no matter what the issue is before us. Yes, we must move on and address the problem, but we must move slowly. This should not become a matter of them versus us. We must remember Unity, Love and Service in reviewing our Spanish literature.

When I was young in recovery, living in southeastern Arizona, I met a fellow Hispanic member from Tucson, Arizona named Carlos C. When addressing the Unity issue Carlos would always say, "Remember that there is not a Spanish A.A. and English A.A. There is just one A.A. with many different languages." At that time we had two Big Book translations: the 1983 Mexico translation and the 1986 G.S.O. translation (the 1986 was revised in 1990). All three had very different dialects of Spanish. So which do we like? You ask ten different people and you'll get three different answers.

I wish I had a solution to our Spanish literature translation problem, but I don't. I do have a solution today for my living problem. My first sponsor, Lauren E., passed this on to me. He told me that now that I have the solution to my living problem, it was my responsibility to carry that solution to the still-suffering alcoholic. Whether I have an English Big Book or Spanish Big Book it still comes back to me. I have the responsibility to sit down with that newcomer, English- or Spanish-speaking, and help him understand the directions of recovery outlined in the first 164 pages of our basic text. I still believe in our basic principle of one alcoholic talking to another.

So let us continue to address the issue of our Spanish literature. Let us ask for guidance from the God of our understanding for a solution. And in the meantime, let us not forget our beloved Responsibility Declaration:

I am responsible...
When anyone, anywhere,
reaches out for help, I want
the hand of A.A. always to be there.
And for that: I am responsible.

David Lozano, New Mexico

As we all know, the A. A. program started 65 years ago when Bill W., trying to maintain his recently acquired sobriety and inspired by a Superior Power, came to believe that talking to another alcoholic would help him avoid the first drink. Later, Bill, Dr. Bob and the A. A. pioneers continued to look for that inspiration that would help them maintain their sobriety and change their attitudes. They were touched in a way that influenced them to live their lives under spiritual principles, and such experiences molded the A. A. program as we know it today.

The message received by the early newcomers from the A.A. pioneers helped them to evaluate their own situation, accept their alcoholism and become willing to follow the A.A. program of

recovery. This message, with few exceptions, has remain unchanged for many years. That is why we all are here, because we heard the message that impacted our lives and opened our minds to hope and faith.

We continue to pass the message one-to-one — from an alcoholic in recovery to one who is still suffering the devastation of the illness. But we also pass the message through our literature. That is why it is important that we continue giving special attention to the revision of our literature in the English language, because later it will be translated into other languages, including Spanish.

This brings us to the question, Where Are We Now?, regarding the Spanish translation of the literature that carries the message to the newcomers. Well, it is good to recognize that we had made an enormous advance in the Spanish translations. We have very competent and professional translators doing important work for our Fellowship, helping us to carry the message to the Spanish community. We have translated a significant amount of literature into Spanish, which gives us Spanish speakers the opportunity to have a better understanding of the A.A. program as a whole; it helps us to be better prepared to fight our alcoholism, as well as to carry the message in a better way.

Nevertheless, we always have opportunities to improve and this is good news, because our Fellowship "... is a society of alcoholics in action" (*The A.A. Service Manual*, 2000-2001 edition, p. S1). We are willing, and are always looking for opportunities to pass on the message; we are also looking for tools to help us carry the message to those who are still suffering from alcoholism. I don't know if we still have literature to be translated into Spanish — not only literature, but also cassettes, tapes, etc. So, I think we have room for improvement regarding this matter.

It is important to recognize that a translation in any language is more than translating one word into another. This is especially important in the case of the Alcoholics Anonymous program, because we are not just translating the word or the phrase — we also must express the love and spirituality that goes with the words. This is very important, because nothing impacts a still-suffering alcoholic more than hearing the language of the heart from another alcoholic in recovery. We need to provide newcomers with all the opportunities possible to hear the same message that changed our lives. We have a lot of A.A. members throughout the U.S., as well as in Puerto Rico, who are bilingual and I for one am willing to participate in these translations. I am not referring to the translation of pamphlets, etc. (which is very important), but to the Big Book and Twelve and Twelve, for which we have a special gratitude and love.

We are here because of the Love and Service of those who came before us, but we are also here for Love and to Serve those who are going to come in the future.

Eric Rossner, Puerto Rico

Where Do We Go From Here?

The subject of Spanish translations has not been a part of the General Service Conference before, but a topic that has been discussed before the Conference officially opens. This has been in the process of becoming a reality for at least four years. Thank you for allowing me to share! We have three linguistic districts in the Northwest Texas Area — two in El Paso and the third in the San Angelo area. Every Friday night in El Paso, the district meets to study the *A.A. Service Manual*. People involved in these linguistic districts and in service know the *Service Manual*. Their meetings last several hours, sometimes until the wee hours of the morning. Each one is dedicated and committed to carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Such commitment

and dedication is deeply admired in our area. When our area assembly is in session, the *Service Manual* of Alcoholics Anonymous is cited as the *only* guideline that we must use — not our area guidelines, but the *A.A. Service Manual*. This is the structure in the linguistic districts. Besides the three D.C.M.s, we have two area officers and two area committee chairs who are Spanish. Each has expressed concern many times over the translation of our literature, not only to me, but also to my predecessors. Many area assemblies seem to lose their real meaning and focus on these differences, with some people leaving our assemblies with feelings of frustration, myself included.

Last year, I wrote to G.S.O. requesting information on the evolution of literature translation from English to Spanish. Vinnie McCarthy and Danny Mooney both responded to my request, sending many explanations of the transition that evolves in the translation process. There was a lengthy discussion last year — before the General Service Conference began — involving the translators, as well as many people who were interested in the translation process. Back home, people were waiting for me to return with answers to their questions concerning the translation from English to Spanish.

Friday evening, after all Conference business concluded, several people went to a Spanish meeting in the Washington Heights section of Manhattan. Cookie S., Southeast New York delegate, had arranged for two people to come to this hotel to pick up people for a good old-fashioned A.A. meeting. Of course, when the members arrived for the meeting, fashionably late, they were immediately asked to share. Each one responded with great enthusiasm! That is, all except one. One could not speak Spanish. Fortunately, there were several other people who volunteered to translate. So, the one who, because of the language difference, was reluctant, began to share experience, strength and hope — the experience from one's own drinking, the strength and hope that had been received in hundreds of meetings of A.A. The translator must have done a splendid job! Before the meeting was over, the miracle that is ever prevalent in Alcoholics Anonymous had happened! One alcoholic was talking to another, although the language that was spoken from the mouth was not the same.

Bill Wilson relates a similar story in *The Language of the Heart*, pp. 295-296. He was concerned about language barriers throughout the world, until he traveled throughout the world. Everywhere he went, he received the same welcome, not with words, but "... the forming of heart to heart in wonder, in joy, and in everlasting gratitude." Upon returning, he was told a story about a small English-speaking A.A. group in Japan. Two members were unable to understand a word of English, but had not missed a meeting for months and were sober. Bill explained, "The speakers were talking far more than English; they are speaking the universal language of deep and abiding brotherhood — the language of the heart."

Upon my return from the General Service Conference, I traveled many miles giving my report. The experience received at that A.A. meeting in Washington Heights gave this member a deeper meaning of the language of the heart. Many times this experience was shared in my delegate's report, including one linguistic district in El Paso, where someone translated for me again. Not once was the question of translation asked. I would like to believe that the members of the Washington Heights Group shared with the members in the Northwest Texas Area that we trust our trusted servants, and in turn, our belief that the future of A.A. and the translation process will be in the hands of God.

Where shall we go from here? I have no doubt the message of Alcoholics Anonymous will continue forward into this century. The language of the heart knows no barriers.

Linda Counts, NW Texas

I remember the day the Spanish-speaking members from our southern area first attended our area committee meeting. It was about the middle of 1993. I was a recently elected general service representative for the As Bill Sees It Group. My sponsor thought it would be a good idea to attend the monthly area committee meeting in addition to my monthly district meeting. The Spanish-speaking members attending the area committee had been bringing Spanish-speaking groups together to form a district. They had received encouragement and help from Spanish linguistic districts from our neighboring area, California Northern Coastal. That day the Spanish-speaking members requested that they be accepted into California Northern Interior. At our election assembly in the fall of 1993, District 53, our first Spanish linguistic district, was formally accepted into our area. Two years later a second Spanish linguistic district, District 54, was accepted.

At that first area committee meeting, I suggested to the Spanish-speaking members that they address the issue of purchasing translation equipment. The area assembly agreed to purchase translation equipment later that year. Spanish translation of our area's monthly newsletter soon followed. Translation services were provided by the Spanish-speaking membership. Today our area is looking into providing professional translators for our area meetings and assemblies. The involvement of the Spanish community in our area has brought us to where we are today — two active linguistic districts and the voice of our Spanish-speaking members in the general service process. This increased involvement has helped to make our area stronger through the increasing number of groups participating in the process.

Over the past few years there has been discussion, at the Conference level, about Spanish translations of our literature. I have read much of the background information on this subject. The Spanish-speaking groups in my area have not expressed any problems with the current translation of the Spanish Big Book. Most of the complaints have been toward the Spanish Twelve and Twelve by members who are bilingual and who read both the English and Spanish versions. Otherwise, the Spanish-speaking groups are encouraged with the increase in service and A.A.W.S. material that has been translated into Spanish.

I do, however, empathize with the Spanish districts in other areas who have voiced objections to the current translations of the Big Book and Twelve and Twelve. A few years ago there was a lot of talk about rewriting the Big Book, updating the language and removing gender-specific language. These changes, of course, were to be for the benefit of the newcomer. If I were to suddenly find these suggested changes included in the next printing of the Big Book, I believe I would become very upset. How dare they change the Big Book? It is obvious to me today that such a change, if it were to occur, would have been thoroughly communicated to the Fellowship through the general service structure, *Box 4-5-9* and the Grapevine magazine. The problem is that unless my home group is connected to the chain of communication so wonderfully explained in the pamphlet "Circles of Love and Service," I probably would not have known that the change was coming. Nor would I have had an opportunity to support or disagree with the decision to change the Big Book.

The reaction of the Spanish-speaking groups to new translations is easy to understand. In our literature it states that pain is the touchstone of progress. The pain of the new translations was the

For four years, Tina Hobson (NE Ohio) has been communicating via an online A.A. meeting with a young lady named Mary Ann J., and her husband Jimmy. The three A.A.s finally met face-to-face in New York — which probably would not have been possible without the Conference.

beginning of progress toward a uniform translation of A.A.W.S. literature to be used by all Spanish-speaking countries with G.S.O.s. Over time we will adjust. As participation in Spanish-speaking A.A. communities increases in the circles of love and service of our service structure, our communication will also improve. Hopefully someday we have all Conference background material available in Spanish and the English and Spanish *Conference Reports* will be shipped at the same time. There is still much room for improvement. We must continue to move forward.

I am reminded of a quote from *As Bill Sees It* (p. 229): "We must think deeply of all those sick ones still to come to A.A. As they try to make their return to faith and to life, we want them to find everything in A.A. that we have found, and yet more, if that be possible. No care, no vigilance, no effort to preserve A.A.'s constant effectiveness and spiritual strength will ever be too great to hold us in full readiness for the day of their homecoming."

Woody Roderick, California/Northern Interior

THE GROWTH OF THE CONFERENCE

Tuesday afternoon's presentation/discussion session was chaired by Tom Ardolf, Northern Minnesota delegate.

Is the Conference large enough, or is there room for additional areas, thereby increasing the Conference with additional delegates? In other words, should the Conference grow? It is difficult for me to give an opinion and take a firm position on the subject. I can only express my feelings and have confidence in God as He may express Himself through the group conscience of future Conferences.

My humble opinion is that although the Conference, as it presently exists, may have room for a few more delegates (maybe five or six), we should be very careful and prudent when we are thinking of increasing the number of participants. I feel that if we allow the Conference to overgrow it will become more and more difficult to have discussions and sharing in an orderly fashion and for everyone to express their thoughts and opinion and share with others as we do now. The group conscience of the Conference might miss some information which would be beneficial to our entire Fellowship. Thus, the group conscience might not be fully enlightened to be able to take the proper decision.

It would become more and more difficult to share with one another, and we might be inclined to have lobbying interventions and hallway discussions if we do not have the opportunity to express our opinions freely; some decisions of the Conference might be politically influenced, etc. In other words, we might eventually forget Dr. Bob's wise advice — "Keep it simple."

As an alternative, we might be tempted to divide or split the Conference into two Conferences, and how do we do that? Would we divide into a Conference for the U.S.A. and one for Canada?

This, I believe, would not solve the problem. Canada, being so small, could have a Conference. On the other hand, the U.S. Conference would still be very large and would eventually be faced with a similar problem shortly thereafter.

I am of the opinion that dividing the North American Conference

into two Conferences on a per country basis would not be a solution, as we presently benefit mutually from the experience of both countries. Then could it be divided into a North American East Conference and a North American West Conference or North and South? I honestly do not believe that a division of our

Conference is the solution.

If it comes to be that our Conference is in danger of becoming too large, the solution might lie in a complete revision of the territorial limitations of each and every area. Perhaps a full study could be made in an effort to try to reduce the number of areas, wherever the territorial limitations would allow us to do so, thereby reducing the number of delegates and thus allowing the Conference to accept additional delegates where justified and warranted by the territorial limitations.

This would definitely not be a popular decision, but having in mind the spiritual aspect of our Fellowship we should always remember that "Our common welfare should come first...."

I really do not think this Conference should be divided. However, something should eventually be done to prevent this overgrowth and I rely on future Conferences to make the proper decision, where God will express Himself through their group conscience. One thing I am convinced of — that our Conference, being as large as it is, should be very prudent on this matter of growth.

Gaetan Mongeau, Northwest Quebec

I am an engineer by trade, and engineers by their nature look to formulas and equations to solve their problems. My natural tendency when confronted with questions like "How many is enough?" or "How big is too big?" is to seek out some sort of formula so that we can all agree upon what the *one and only correct* answer is. I am still looking.

In doing the research for my presentation I learned that concerns regarding the growth and composition of the Conference have existed virtually from day one. In 1956 California received the distinction of being the first area to have a request for an additional delegate denied. It would not be the first time. The request was later granted at the 1957 Conference. In 1957 the Committee on Admissions developed the first guidelines for additional delegates. These guidelines suggested that no state or province should request an additional delegate unless its A.A. population exceed-



ed certain limits, with consideration also to be given to mileage. As an example, one of the guidelines suggested that an area should not request an additional delegate when two delegates were serving less than 7,000 A.A.s. As a modern day point of reference, the delegate from Southern California represented 59,020 A.A.s prior to the creation of Central California Area.

In 1961 Bill W. wrote the "Memorandum On New Delegates" that has become the cornerstone for virtually all subsequent deliberations regarding the growth of the Conference as it relates to additional delegates. The Conference grew steadily from the mid to late 50s through the 60s, reaching 90 delegates in 1968. In 1968 the Committee on Admissions recommended that a study of admissions procedures be conducted and in September of that year it was recommended that a standard form be prepared for use in applications for additional delegates. In 1969 the first moratorium on new applications was declared.

In 1971 the General Service Board's Long-Range Planning Committee recommended that: "The size of the Conference should not be much larger than it is now; that the makeup of Conference should remain proportionately similar to its present structure; and the number of nondelegate members of the Conference should not exceed one-third of the total Conference membership."

The next three decades would see further requests and denials for new delegates. There would be moratoriums, requests for further guidelines, studies by the many relevant trustees' and Conference Committees, presentations to the Conference and further guidelines. In 2000 the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee considered a request for an additional delegate area from Southern California, but took no action because they were unable to reach a consensus. The Conference later granted the request, bringing the total number of delegates to 93.

As a member of the Policy/Admissions Committee at the 2000 Conference, I had several questions and concerns as I considered Southern California's request for an additional delegate: What really were the guidelines? The history of all the deliberations regarding the growth of the Conference contained many suggestions, but the suggestions themselves lacked a specificity with which I felt I could tackle the question of new delegate areas and the growth of the Conference. Certainly, as areas grew, there were going to be legitimate requests for additional delegates, but what were the practical limits to the size of the Conference?

As of the 2000 Conference, there were six areas with more than 1,500 groups and more than 50,000 A.A. members. If Southern California were granted an additional delegate would that not open the door for other large areas to apply for, and be granted, additional delegates? Taking it a step further, there were eight areas with over 1,000 groups (but less than 1,500). Would they be next? I became concerned that there was a potential for as much if not more growth in the next few years as the last three decades had seen. What were the practical limits?

Comments by two Conference members helped me to solve the problem that I found myself confronted with. A delegate suggested that "I could only solve the problem in front of me," and that was Southern California's request. At the microphone during the floor debate, a G.S.O. staff member said that he "didn't think that one additional delegate would 'break' the Conference." My immediate problem was solved and I could, with good conscience, speak in favor of Southern California's request for an additional delegate.

As part of my research I consulted with individuals who I felt would have insight into what the practical limits of the Conference might be with respect to the logistics of putting on the Conference. I spoke with the current Conference coordinator, as well as G.S.O.'s liaison with the hotel. Neither saw a

problem, logistically speaking, with adding a few delegates to the Conference. However, there are physical limits to our current hotel arrangements. The current meeting room can probably handle an additional 6-8 delegates. Any more than that could probably require us to consider moving the Conference. What about Conference committee assignments? There are currently eleven standing Conference committees, seven with eight delegates and four with nine delegates. There are also two secondary committee assignments. Seven delegates could be added to the Conference without exceeding nine members per Conference committee.

So, in the short term, will one more or even a few more delegates break the Conference? No. However, I believe in the long term that trend will, assuming that the growth of the Fellowship continues.

So what are the long-term solutions to be? One solution might be to create more districts, thereby improving local communications. Quoting from Bill's memorandum on new delegate areas: "What we shall need will always be enough delegates at New York to afford a reliable cross-section of A.A. plus enough more to make sure of good local communication."

Quoting from a letter written in 1978 from the staff member on the Conference assignment to the delegate chairman: "It was Bill's feeling that as A.A. grows, it would be preferable to add more districts rather than more areas because our General Service Conference would become unwieldy if there were many more than the 91 delegates which now represent the United States and Canada. A.A. will have gone far into its future before there are too many district committee members to be heard in assemblies. Co-founder Bill W., when he conceived our general service structure, felt that the answer to growth could always be found in the setting up of more districts (and subdivisions of districts) within an area."

One solution, proposed in 1988 in a paper on Geographical Representation, written by a trustee, would be to reapportion the delegates. By shifting delegates from states with multiple delegates and small populations to areas with large populations, the problem of increasing delegate representation could be solved without increasing the size of the Conference. A decidedly unpopular solution if your area (state) were to lose a delegate.

The Conference theme this year is Love and Service, two commodities I knew little of when I first entered the halls. These two commodities exemplified were by my first sponsor. He taught me about the undying love of one alcoholic for another, asking for nothing more in return than the opportunity to share the experience, strength and hope of his recovery. He demonstrated his love for the Fellowship with his willingness to participate in service, no job too big or small. I too learned to love the Fellowship, service, another alcoholic and, finally, myself.

It is my belief that our mutual love for our Fellowship and what is best for A.A. as a whole will guide us through the growth of the Conference. That through continued efforts to improve our local service structures we can, if not eliminate, at least lessen the need for additional delegates and thereby reduce the strain of growing the Conference.

When I read what Bernard B. Smith said: "We may not need a General Service Conference to ensure our own recovery....We need it to ensure the recovery of a child being born tonight, destined for alcoholism." I realize I may still be a tad selfish. I think of my own children, precious gifts of my sobriety. I want the same hand of A.A. that I found when I reached out for help, to be there for my children and my children's children, and for that, I am responsible.

Mark Sawyer, New Hampshire

INTERNATIONAL REPORTS

Leonard Blumenthal, Class A trustee, moderated the presentation/discussion session preceeding lunch on Wednesday.

16th World Service Meeting

The 16th World Service Meeting, whose formally stated purpose is, "to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, wherever in the world he or she may be, whatever the languages he or she speaks," was held at the Crowne Plaza Manhattan Hotel, New York City, October 22 - 26, 2000. It was the largest one held since its inception. The first World Service Meeting was held in New York City in 1969, with 27 delegates from 16 countries — the most recent one consisted of 39 delegates from 30 countries. The theme was "A.A. — Our Future Is Our Responsibility."

Registration and the reception for delegates, participants and guests, saw the start of activities and gave everyone a chance to mingle and start getting acquainted. The next "ice-breaker" was a Twelve Traditions skit, put on by G.S.O. staff members. The skit was humorous and very well done, and put everyone in a relaxed and happy mood for a "red ball meeting" that followed, allowing us to hear some A.A. stories from around the globe.

Following a welcoming address by Gary Glynn, roll call and orientation by Greg Muth, and the Keynote Address by Rina Rosseels (Flemish-speaking Europe), we heard Country Highlights, mostly from first-term delegates from eight countries. These reports are similar to the Area Highlights given at our General Service Conference, only they give a brief overview of the service structure and some highlights of what is happening in that country. A report giving the highlights of each country was given over the next few days.

There were 15 interesting and informative presentations on the following topics: The Flow of Information Within A.A.; Making Service More Attractive Through Improving Communication; How Can We Better Carry the Message in a Changing World?; Changeless Message in a Changing World; United for Those Yet to Come; and A.A. Magazines and Newsletters. Although the presentations were given by delegates from around the globe, the message was the same as if one of our home-town members had presented it. The love of A.A. and what's best for A.A. was always there.

Each delegate is assigned to one of four standing committees, and each committee met separately on Monday and Tuesday to discuss the business of that committee and to elect a chairperson for the next two years. Reports of the meetings were given to the whole assembly on Wednesday. Here are some of the highlights.

The Agenda Committee agreed that the theme of the 17th World Service Meeting will be "The A.A. Message — A Message Without Borders." I can't think of a more appropriate theme,

because throughout the whole of the W.S.M. it was demonstrated that A.A. itself was indeed a Fellowship without borders. The love and respect that was shown for each other was just phenomenal.

The Literature/Publishing Committee recognized the importance of continuing to have a strong stand on protecting and defending A.A.'s copyrights to ensure that the integrity of the A.A. message is preserved, and it was unanimously recommended that the 1998 statement regarding copyrights be reaffirmed. They also discussed future needs for literature and translations in Asian countries, emerging nations and other parts of the world.

The Working with Others Committee discussed a wide variety of topics, such as carrying the message at professional conferences and conventions as well as into correctional facilities or prisons.

The Policy/Admissions/Finance Committee discussed the current practice of alternating the meetings between New York and another country and agreed that no changes were needed. Everyone liked the idea of coming to New York and seeing first-hand our General Service Office, as well as Stepping Stones. Although a request from Peru for participation was approved, it was also withdrawn, so the committee encouraged Peru to reapply to be seated at the 17th World Service Meeting. The committee reviewed the applications from Seccion Mexico and Native American Indian Nations and, because they did not meet the qualifications for delegate participation, the committee suggested they participate in local structures. Based on a recommendation by the Site-selection Committee that the next meeting be held in Spain, the committee recommended that the meeting take place October 6 - 10, 2002.

Various workshops were held during the week and each delegate was assigned to one of three groups so that everyone had a chance to participate. The workshop "Communication Between Countries" brought out some interesting information on the challenges experienced in "sponsoring" other countries. Mexico continues to sponsor Cuba, and provides literature as well as service experience. Providing information about A.A.'s Traditions to the Cuban government is a real challenge. Colombia works with Venezuela, Panama, Peru and Chile, but geographic distances prove to be a major obstacle. Often the major problem is convincing boards and groups in their own countries of the need for this kind of work. Zonal meetings are also helping A.A. members to look beyond their own borders.

Presentations were given on country-to-country sponsorship and brought to light some of the problems, as well as some of the successes. The New Zealand delegate spoke of carrying the message to Polynesia, Micronesia and Melanesia, a vast multicultural region. One of the experiences he recalled was with a Samoan family. He was returning from an A.A. meeting with a gentleman who had recently been Twelfth Stepped, only to find his family waiting for him. They promptly set about beating him up because he had gone outside the family and church for help. Tomas from Mexico spoke of how in 1992, 56 Mexican A.A.s arrived in

Havana where, together with a number of Cuban A.A. pioneers, they launched C.P.C., P.I., and institutions service projects. Within the space of three years there were more than 40 groups and there are now 130 groups. They also have a General Service Board and a General Service Conference.

Time was provided during the week for General Sharing — What's on Your Mind? This allowed all of the delegates to share and to listen to other opinions. One of the topics was placing the Big Book on the Internet, and some of the comments are as follows. There goes our income — if people get it free we would



The Growth of A.A. Through Zonal Meetings in Emerging Countries

go broke. / We depend on literature sales. / I'm afraid and skeptical we would lose contact with people. / We have to preserve what is so important to us. / Literature sales account for 80% of our income — our structure would collapse. / We must protect the Big Book so that our message remains in tact. It was an excellent session which brought out a lot of discussion.

Another topic was that of doing a Fourth and Fifth Step. The delegate from Japan stated that it was difficult to do them in Japan. Some pointed out how crucial to sobriety these Steps are. / Some groups took on the responsibility of helping their members. / Emphasis was put on going to the right person. / There was a story of one woman who went back to drinking after taking her Fifth Step with a priest. He told her she was going to go to hell. / Others described the freedom they experienced after doing these Steps.

One of the most lively discussions, however, was that of the "13th step." It seems that this is a universal problem and no one is exempt from it. One delegate raised the idea of insurance policies to protect the Fellowship. The police got involved after sexual abuse charges were made when a man Twelfth Stepped a woman. That country wanted to be seen as acting responsibly and had the Conference ask all the groups to discuss it. A suggestion that men call on men and women call on women followed, although another delegate quickly stated that they had a problem of older men Twelfth Stepping younger men and going so far as to giving massages. A suggestion that two members should always go on Twelfth Step calls followed. One country stated there were a lot of "Don Juans" in his country and another said they lynched people like that. A couple of weeks prior to the W.S.M. I was at an assembly in eastern Canada and the same topic was being discussed, so I felt right at home. One delegate expressed his appreciation for the W.S.M. and this discussion since he no longer felt alone.

As is frequently the case, the closing session on Thursday afternoon was a very emotional event, as the second term delegates gave their closing remarks and said goodbye. Greg Muth gave the farewell talk and Gary Glynn gave the closing remarks. The Serenity Prayer was then said, one at a time, in 16 different languages, and finally, with everyone joining hands, we all said it together. Needless to say there were not many dry eyes in the room.

Delegates, guests and participating G.S.O. staff members of the W.S.M. attended the closing dinner. Some professional entertainment was provided and this was followed by an amateur night for anyone who was willing to participate. Even Dean and myself did a little number and a good time was had by all.

Most of the delegates had a tour of G.S.O. on Friday and many attended the 11:00 a.m. A.A. meeting. All were invited to attend a dinner meeting Friday with members of the General Service Board, directors and G.S.O. staff. One of the major highlights of the week was a trip to Stepping Stones, the home of Bill Wilson. Delegates and guests filled two buses and spent a couple of hours touring the home and workshop where Bill did most of his writing. Most of the delegates and guests attended the annual Bill Wilson Dinner that is put on by New York Intergroup, and many spent the weekend observing the board weekend.

Like so many A.A. events, no amount of words on paper could ever capture the feelings, the emotions, or the Spiritual Power that permeates an event such as this — one simply must experience it. It was a fabulous meeting and an even more fabulous experience. It was truly an example of Love and Service in action. Thanks for allowing me to be a part of it.

Alex Palmer, trustee-at-large/Canada

This year's theme, Love and Service, is certainly fitting in regard to the ongoing work of A.A.'s World Service Meeting and the interim zonal meetings, all of which help carry the A.A. message of recovery throughout the world. At present, there are three interim zonal meetings which meet on the years when the World Service Meeting is not held. The Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) covers North and South America; the Asia-Oceania Service Meeting, which includes the Pacific rim area of Japan, Korea, China, India, Vietnam, Indonesia, the Philippines, Australia, New Zealand, New Guinea and the many Fiji Islands of the South Pacific; and the European Service Meeting.

Poland is now making plans for an Eastern European service meeting, which would include Belarus, Bulgaria, Czech Republic, Estonia, Hungary, Latvia, Lithuania, Moldova, Russia, Romania, Slovakia, Ukraine, and possibly others.

This past year, upon invitation, representatives of G.S.O. — Greg Muth, general manager, and staff member Eva Sanchez — traveled to South Africa to meet with members of Great Britain's General Service Board and G.S.O., as well as South Africa's board, to discuss possibilities of a zonal meeting for countries of sub-Saharan Africa.

The General Service Board of Central Mexicana is currently sponsoring Cuba, providing literature and sharing A.A. experience. Mexico is also sharing experience with Belize. Colombia is making efforts toward assisting their neighbors in Venezuela and Peru. Brazil is involved with Argentina and Bolivia.

Poland now has more than 1,500 groups with several thousand members. They are carrying the A.A. message into former Soviet Republics such as Moldova, Kazakhstan, and Kyrgyzstan. Belgium is sponsoring Romania with literature, visits to groups and helping them to establish a service structure. As trustee-at-large/U.S., serving on the Trustees' International Committee, it was my pleasure this past year to have participated in the Second National Service Conference in Romania, sharing the collective A.A. experience of our service committees and service structure. There can be no greater example of love and service in country-sponsorship than sharing experience, strength and hope in areas of the world where A.A. has little or no presence, but where there is a great need to hear the message of recovery provided in our Twelve Steps and the Big Book.

This past year translations of the Big Book were published in Romanian, Mongolian, and Slovakian. Numerous other translations have been completed. The generosity of the Fellowship of the United States/Canada in carrying the message to other countries through literature assistance is a classic example of one alcoholic helping another. Evidence of this continued support of other language literature is evident by the fact that the 2001 Literature Assistance budget is \$212,500.00.

This budget will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish foreign language A.A. books, pamphlets and reprints. Some of this cost is defrayed by the International Literature Fund, which is made up of contributions from established A.A. service

Vicki Bigelow (Arizona) displayed the souvenir pins (from delegates areas or states) on the flap of her carrying case — arranged in the form of a map of the U.S. and Canada.

Another talented delegate, Helaine Bertrand (Northeast Ontario), livened up the two-minute Area Service Highlights by singing hers to the tune of "Jingle Bells."

structures of other countries. The 2001 budget allows for translations of A.A.'s Legacies of Service and the Twelve Concepts for those countries requesting this. A.A. material such as pamphlets, books and service material has been translated into Ukrainian, Turkish, Croatian, Burmese, Shan, Chinese, Mongolian, Slovakian and other languages.

One of the activities of our interim zonal meetings is to connect A.A. with neighboring countries. In our Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) this past year, several countries of the Americas were present, including a representative from Belize who was an observer. The next interim zonal meeting, to be held in 2001 in Colombia, will be the Meeting of Americas; the European Service Meeting will be in Germany; and the Asia-Oceania Meeting in South Korea. The next World Service Meeting will be in Spain in 2002.

It has been my privilege and opportunity to share collective experience over several countries around the world and to see A.A. in various stages of growth. One of the most moving experiences was to observe the loving efforts of a few groups scattered throughout Romania to set up their service structure to establish better communication, to provide public information and to relate the A.A. message of recovery from this devastating disease.

I took several copies of the Romanian Big Book and other literature to Romania when I went there in November for their service conference. Some of the literature was carefully and reverently passed from one alcoholic to another. Plans were being formulated as to how they could share the literature for a few weeks with other groups, since there was not a sufficient amount for all to have their own copies. I was moved by the love and sacrifice exhibited by one alcoholic sharing with another through literature. I have never experienced a more wonderful example of love and service than what I witnessed among the A.A.s at the Romanian National Service Conference. At this conference, Romania elected their first delegate who plans on attending the service meeting of Eastern European countries in Poland.

My heart is filled with gratitude for the opportunity and privilege you have given me to assist in providing service to help carry the A.A. message to others throughout the world. The sun never sets on the A.A. program and the message of Alcoholics Anonymous is worldwide today. May the God of my understanding continue to bless this wonderful Fellowship and its message of recovery that we share with all people of the world today.

Dean Rinehart, trustee-at-large/U.S.

SPONSORSHIP

Thursday morning the Conference opened with a presentation/discussion session led by Betty Scherer, Kentucky.

The Home Group

September 18th of last year, my sponsor, Dr. Bill M., successfully completed the A.A. way of life with 44 years of continuous sobriety. I was honored by being asked to speak at his funeral. One of the heartfelt things I shared with those in attendance was the thought that if I had to sum up Bill's life, I would use two words, "Love and Service."

These two words also sum up the A.A. way of life — Love and Service. I would like to give you my understanding of the words, so we know we are all on the same page. Love — I wish for all the promises that are made in our basic text, the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, to come true in your life. Service — Taking whatever action is asked of me by the God of my understanding to assist in those promises coming true in your life and mine. In other words, living the A.A. principles in all our affairs.

Shortly after my name was drawn from the hat to represent my area as delegate, Bill brought a Second Edition of the Big Book to my home. It had been his sponsor's. Bill shared with me that his late sponsor, Clyde G. from Utah, had been a delegate. He didn't know what Panel, but his Big Book had been signed by Bill and Lois and Ebby. So during the 50th General Service Conference, while on a tour of G.S.O., I went to the Archives and asked Judit to look up Clyde in the computer. It was one of those special moments that we get once in a while when it seems that everything fits and makes sense. When we know that, without a doubt, there is a God and He is in charge. Here I was, a Panel 50 delegate, and a man I had never known, but who was my sponsor's sponsor, had been on the 1st Panel of delegates to New York, 50 years before me.

The other night, after a meeting of my home group, I overheard one of the guys who calls me sponsor, sharing with a new guy: "No, you don't have to pay anything. We just pass the basket at each meeting to pay our expenses. There are no bosses around here. Some of us have service jobs, like getting the coffee made and chairing the meetings, but these jobs rotate. We sure believe in sponsorship. What's that? Well, a sponsor is someone to help you through the tough spots and share his experience with you." These two were talking about the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous — the 36 principles that are embodied in the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts of A.A. and are encompassed by our Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service.

Most of us are fairly good about using these principles within our Fellowship, but how about in all our affairs? To our friends, our jobs, in the shopping mall, in the third lane of traffic on the freeway, and yes, here comes the big one, even in our own homes. My experience has been that home was the last place to start seeing the benefits of the A.A. program. And, at times, it still seems that this is where it is the hardest to practice these principles. But, as with most things, the rewards of trying to do these things in all my affairs are equal to the task. I have some true and trusted friends in this world; I have a job that appreciates me enough to make it possible for me to accomplish the things required of a delegate. I have a wife who is a true and trusted partner; I have a relationship with my adult children, as well as with an eight-year-old little girl who was a wonderful gift in my seventh year of sobriety. She has taught me much about what it really means to love another person. I have all of you, my A.A. family. And, perhaps the most important thing, I'm able to live comfortably in my own skin. These are just a few of the things that happen when we practice these principles with each other.

I like to think that my home group, The Sturgis Group of Alcoholics Anonymous, is a good example of these things. I feel that it is the best group in the world and I hope that you feel the same way about your home group. What is different about the home group and any other group we may, and do, attend? It is at the home group where we really get to know each other, where we commit ourselves to the various tasks that make a group effective. It is my home group that recognizes my birthday and may even send me a get well card if I should miss two meetings in a row.

When I look at our Twelve Steps, I see how much Bill W. wrote about alcohol. The first half of the First Step mentions alcohol, the other eleven and a half Steps are about a design for living that works. I believe a study of the Steps, Traditions and Concepts will also confirm that this is a program about how to live and how to get along with others. It is a program by which we become so comfortable with who we are that we don't have to drink to be someone we are not. It is a program through

which we learn how to make contact with a Higher Power and how to share that with others.

Yes, we must stop drinking for any of this to work, but let's not short change the A.A. way of life by reducing it to just a way to stop drinking. When we close our meetings at my home group, my eight-year-old daughter is often there. She joins hands with a couple of recovering drunks, her eyes seek me out, she gives me a big wink and a smile and recites the Lord's Prayer.

You see, things like that happen when guys like Clyde share with guys like Bill who share with guys like me, the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous. Thank you, A.A., for my life!

Paul Jacob, South Dakota

Sponsorship Into Service

More than 15 years ago I asked a man named Frank M. in New York City to be my sponsor. I was having trouble getting sober, and Frank had something that I wanted, namely years off the sauce and a passion and love for Alcoholics Anonymous that I felt every time we talked. Frank had mentioned that he "worked for A.A. at the headquarters" and I didn't know enough to know that this meant he was involved in service at our General Service Office. Frank was our former Archivist, as many of you know. He was my first sponsor and also my first service sponsor. After that I always looked for a man with Frank's passion for A.A.

Sobriety, however, didn't come easy for this stubborn drunk. I moved to Maine (the truth is I got thrown out of my place to live in New York) and I drank on and off for several more years. But I did always stick with A.A. I knew I was one of you; I knew this was the place for me; I knew you, like Frank, had what I wanted. I just wasn't ready to give up the bottle. Shortly after moving to Maine, I asked a kindly old fellow, with a twinkle in his eye, Hank C., to be my sponsor. I heard him talk at meetings about "wearing sobriety like a comfortable loose old coat." I wanted his serenity and the balance in his life. He talked of meeting Bill Wilson and Ebby, of working the Steps, and he also talked of his service to A.A. as something he called a delegate. I was a lot more impressed with Bill and Ebby than with the "D" word! But without knowing it, I had picked another service sponsor.

It was more than 13 years ago that my own service career started at a meeting of my home group of Alcoholics Anonymous. You see, I was unemployed and unemployable, and the group members were too polite to point that out to this haughty drunk, so they suggested that I take over as secretary-treasurer because, as they put it, "You have a lot of free time." I was flattered, eagerly said "yes" and received the ziploc bag with the money, checkbook, and group records. As we left one of them said, "Oh, yeah, you make the coffee, too, and by the way there's my anniversary next week. I like chocolate cake." I was completely convinced they didn't know I was still drinking.

It was very difficult to keep track of the days of the week, make the coffee at the right time in the right place, get the cups, sweetener and milk, get the right kind of card, get the correct medalion and cake, all while still woozy from "the sauce." Of course, when I needed a jug, there was always that ziploc bag with the money in it. The group members kept smiling, hugging and saying things like, "Keep coming back. It gets better." One or two even had the gall to say, "It works better when you don't drink." I still really thought they didn't know.

And so my service career in Alcoholics Anonymous began, many months before I got sober. I have since understood that by taking on that job, I had to keep coming back, and A.A. finally got me. About this time I asked another man to be my sponsor, or rather he volunteered his services, noticing my often bloodshot

eyes. Roger P. had a zeal for A.A. that also appealed to me. He was something he described as a D.C.M. Too many letters at one time for me, I felt.

The miracle happened one cold March day. I had been on a three-day toot. Neither Roger nor my dear friend Jeff had heard from me for several days. Jeff called Roger, who drove the 15 miles and walked in just after I had come home from the store with a full half-gallon of Jack Daniels. I was down through the neck of it, feeling a bit better and he was the last man on earth I wanted to see. He took one look at me, the bottle, looked at me with loving eyes and said, "Haven't you had enough?" Something inside me melted and I said simply, "Yes, Roger, I've had enough." The grace of God entered me that day and I was able to walk away from that nearly full half gallon and I haven't had a drink since.

When I was three days sober, my sponsor Roger was going to a Maine Area Assembly. Not knowing what else to do with me, he took me along, at his own expense. He explained to me that I was so sick that when I was alone, I was in bad company. While his explanation made no sense, I went. I was amazed to find 150 drunks way up north in Presque Isle, Maine for this two-day event. I heard the Twelve Concepts read for the first time, and when I asked Roger about them, he replied, "The triangle has three sides, doesn't it?" His cryptic answer made as little sense as the comment about being in bad company. About a year later, I understood something about the Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service.

Something else happened at that first assembly. Folks like you got into a fight over the cost of the statewide meeting list booklet — would it be 23 or 25 cents. The discussion, if you could call it that, went on for over two hours. People got red-faced, shook their fists and shouted into the mike. I knew I was home. If any outfit could fight for two hours over two cents, this was the place for me. You were my kind of people! I haven't missed a Maine Area Assembly since.

Over the years, I moved on to G.S.R., district secretary, D.C.M., and a number of jobs for Area 28. I have traveled to Regional Forums, NERAASA, NERC, NERD and visited many districts, workshops and other service events. I have had other sponsors since, as life has taken me to new places in Maine. Frank C. was a D.C.M in District 2; Al R. ran our Central Service Office; and Cena R. is a past delegate. Without really thinking about it, I have always picked someone in service to Alcoholics Anonymous. Taking a cue from Roger, I have sometimes taken newcomers along to introduce them to this wonderful life of service. My friend Jeff has been with me throughout my service experiences and he, too, has become active in service. We have taken along the men we sponsor to show them this way of life. The people I have met along the way are the kinds of people I want to be with. I look forward to every service experience and I thank you for my life.

Jesse Mase, Maine

Never Too Late To Get a Sponsor

The theme of our 51st General Service Conference, "Love and Service," is an invaluable tool for all of us. In Dr. Bob's last talk, July 19, 1950, in Cleveland, when he was very ill, he stressed that Alcoholics Anonymous was love and service. Dr. Bob also advised us to watch our erring tongues. I have used and distributed his last talk in problem areas such as treatment centers, service functions, workshops district meetings, area meetings and A.A. groups. His talk seems to stem alcoholic anger and ego. Believe me, it works.

In this presentation I must personally include "service spon-

sor." If your sponsor is involved in service there is probably no need for a service sponsor. It was not the case for me. When I came to A.A. in 1966, I was reluctant to ask for a sponsor, as I thought I would hurt someone's feelings if I didn't ask them. There also seemed to be a problem with false pride and ego. After many relapses I was strongly advised to get an A.A. sponsor. I ran through a series of about five sponsors and they helped me. I believe I was sucked into what I call "the sponsor wheel," this is when the alcoholic slips and spins the wheel and gets a new sponsor. A couple of mine moved away, two died and one fired me. I did not kill the two that died, they died on their own.

When I got out of my tenth treatment modality I was very angry that they made light of my lack of involvement in the A.A. community structure. I became involved and was blessed with a tough service sponsor. My other sponsor was director of the local halfway house. He helped save my job and marriage. My service sponsor insured my sobriety by getting me involved in the district and area.

I must tell this story, as it is a good example of what a service sponsor will do to insure his sponsee's involvement. I got a call from Gene McGinnis, my service sponsor. He advised me we were going to a special meeting of the No. 11 Area. On the way I asked him what the special meeting was about. He told me we were going to have a special election and elect a new chairman, the previous chairman had committed suicide. I asked him whom we were going to elect. He said, "I am going to nominate you." I said, "Why me?" He said, "You are good at crowd control." I was elected, filling out the term, and elected to another term and then alternate delegate. The new chairman was in California with an ill father and the delegate, Dr. John Getchel, volunteered me to chair again. Many of my A.A. friends said it took me six years to learn the job. They were probably right.

Unfortunately, Gene, a heavy smoker, died of emphysema. At that time I had a good, strong A.A. sponsor who helped save my long-time marriage (presently 52 years). I didn't find it necessary to get a service sponsor as I was as knowledgeable about A.A. service as any other in the area.

When I became a trustee in 1997, the general manager, George D., was very helpful. I was a little green, having been a delegate over 12 years ago. When George retired and I became chairman of A.A.W.S., I asked him to be my service sponsor. He never told me what to do, but shared his experience, strength and hope with me. I have lost a brother and a son to our illness. George has not been a replacement, but has filled a big gap in my A.A. life.

I will be rotating after this Conference, but will keep in close contact with my A.A. sponsor and service sponsor. Sponsorship is a must for me. I will never chance being without a sponsor. Thank you. I remain your trusted servant.

Jack Ostrem, East Central regional trustee

THE G.S.R.'s ROLE IN A.A.

Thursday evening, John Koster, A.A.W.S. director, moderated the presentation/discussion session.

In the Home Group

Before I was chosen the general service representative (G.S.R.) of my home group, some group members cornered me in the hall and told me our group needed a new G.S.R. and they wanted it to be me, would I do it? I did not even know what a G.S.R. was or what they did, but who could say no to the person who brought the book to my home when I called Alcoholic Anonymous? They followed through and told me meetings that I was to attend. My job was to listen and learn they told me. Many

G.S.R.s talk, some jokingly, about being elected when they went to the bathroom. Those who are dedicated and have good leadership to follow, pick up the responsibility and follow through, others do not. Bill writes in Concept IX: "In this area a degree of weakness tends to persist. The needed improvement seems to be a matter of increased care, responsibility, and education." (*The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, pp. 36-37) Not much seems to have changed since Bill wrote the Concepts. We are constantly looking for new G.S.R.s and putting on workshops for them.

Our "upside-down pyramid" lists groups at the top. The home group, as the heartbeat of A.A., has the "ultimate responsibility and the final authority for our world services — those special elements of over-all service activity which make it possible for our Society to function as a whole." (ibid., p. 6) "The home group affords individual A.A.s the privilege of voting on issues that affect the Fellowship as a whole; it is the very basis of our service structure....the home group is where they participate in business meetings and cast their vote as part of the group conscience of the Fellowship as a whole." (ibid., p. S23)

"The general service representative has the job of linking his or her group with A.A. as a whole. The G.S.R. represents the voice of the group conscience, reporting the group's thoughts to the district committee member and to the delegate, who passes them on to the Conference. This communication is a two-way street, making the G.S.R. responsible for bringing back to the group Conference Actions that affect A.A. unity, health, and growth. Only when a G.S.R. keeps the group informed, and communicates the group conscience, can the Conference truly act for A.A. as a whole." (ibid., p. S24)

Concept IX states: "When making their choices of G.S.R.'s, the A.A. groups should therefore have such facts well in mind. It ought to be remembered *that it is only the G.S.R.'s* who, in Group Assembly meetings (or in caucus) can name Committee Members and finally name the Delegates. Hence great care needs to be taken by the groups as they choose these Representatives. Hit-or-miss methods should be avoided. Groups that name no G.S.R.'s should be encouraged to do so." (ibid., p. 36)

Groups that have a G.S.R. who is enthusiastic when giving a report seem to have the most enthusiastic and loyal members, which is helpful in carrying the message of recovery found in Alcoholics Anonymous. G.S.R.s have an added benefit of meeting people they never would have met if they had not been willing to serve. We can have great fun while looking after the affairs of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Most successful G.S.R.s have had their start in service by being an active member in their home group in other service capacities, such as secretary/treasurer, intergroup representative, or by serving on committees where they have seen the Traditions in action. They are usually willing to learn and to read pamphlets and other literature, which can be helpful when faced with group problems. The G.S.R. informs the group on the Traditions, Warranties, and Concepts, thereby helping the group arrive at an informed group conscience. As a guardian of our Traditions, the G.S.R. learns to place principles before personalities. Hurt feelings can come about when the group ignores the G.S.R. and goes the way it wants to after being informed. This can be a growth experience for the group and for the G.S.R. as well. Being G.S.R. teaches a degree of patience, tolerance and love, it also helps the individual to apply the principles of the Twelve Traditions, which can enhance sobriety, in their personal lives. In the home group the G.S.R. learns he or she is a trusted servant, that they do not govern.

Bill said, "The strength of our whole A.A. service structure starts with the group and with the general service representative

(G.S.R.) the group elects. I cannot emphasize too strongly the G.S.R.'s importance." ("G.S.R. May Be the Most Important Job in A.A.") The home group is the heartbeat of A.A.; the G.S.R. is the heartbeat of the home group.

Carolyn Chamberlain, Southern Indiana

Link to the District, Area and G.S.O.

I realize that almost everyone in this room knows the G.S.R.'s link to the district, area and G.S.O., but to the still-suffering G.S.R., "Do not fall into despair!" There is light at the end of the tunnel and hope just around the corner. It doesn't matter how you got here, whether you were railroaded by your home group, nudged by a strong suggestion of your sponsor, or (like how I got here), by thinking I was going to be paid for the job. There is a reason your higher power has given you this responsibility.

The first thing you should do as a G.S.R. is go to your district meeting, which is where your second link lies. When I went, I found not only new G.S.R.s like myself, but G.S.R.s with experience, as well as district officers and the district committee member (D.C.M.). The first district meeting I attended I expected to find a bunch of people sitting around dividing up money. What I found instead was information being passed back and forth between the G.S.R.s and the D.C.M. They were talking about special events within the district, service workshops in the area, and A.A. around the world. I had never experienced the kind of love for Alcoholics Anonymous shared by these people. My heart was filled with joy and embarrassment at the same time. I had come to this meeting for selfish reasons, expecting to receive extra income. After the meeting I approached the alternate D.C.M. and confessed my motives for being there. She just gave me a big smile and in a very loving way told me I would not be paid for this service work. She went on to say that we do this for the gift we have been given, our sobriety, and would I like to help out our district because we were hosting the next area assembly? I said, "Sure," and left the meeting wondering, "What is an area assembly?"

I arrived early the morning of the area assembly and was told this is where the next link in the exchange of information happens, where the group conscience is heard and the area's group conscience is formed. I was then given a handful of extension cords and sent out to find different electrical outlets, because the 15 or so crockpots for the lunch kept blowing out the fuses in the building. I started to feel a part of something larger than myself. My new service friends shared what was going to happen throughout the day, the reports from the districts, standing committees, motions that we were to vote on, and a report from our delegate. I was to take this information back to my home group. Much of what went on that day I did not quite understand, but I knew it was important that I complete the circle of communication.

I spent that first year understanding our next link, the General Service Office. Through our delegate and the reports she shared with us, I learned of the many group services G.S.O. provides. I learned that contributions from my home group, together with groups across the United States and Canada, help to produce books, pamphlets, and bulletins. Our G.S.O. funds the cost of translations of A.A. literature to countries which would otherwise not be able to afford the initial cost. This link, which started in our home group, now goes around the world.

Over ten years have come and gone since that first year in general service. It is, at times, hard to believe I'm standing in front of my peers at the 51st General Service Conference, grateful for the gift to be of service. Throughout this week we have discussed at length items that could affect the future of Alcoholics

Anonymous, here and around the world. I want the G.S.R. to know you are with us here, in our hearts and in our voices. We cannot forget our link to the group, which starts with the G.S.R. You are our eyes, ears, and voice which completes the circle of Love and Service.

Mark Koons, California, San Diego/Imperial

Guardian of the Traditions

Like a lot of us here, I first began in general service through doing Twelve Step work on a general service committee. That is, I started going into prisons, hospitals and treatment facilities, but my first general service position was as alternate G.S.R. and then G.S.R. for my home group. It was an exciting introduction into the world of the service structure and I truly felt a part of the A.A. Fellowship as a whole.

I soon found out that the role of the general service representative for my home group was one of the most important jobs I would ever have; that all information for my group began and ended with me. I was part of the pipeline of information from my group to my district, area and the rest of A.A. and, conversely, from the rest of A.A., from my area, and my district, back to my group. I was to carry my group's conscience and was told that in this position I was a "Guardian of the Traditions." The result of doing my job as well as I could, along with the other G.S.R.s, was to promote unity, health and growth at all levels of Alcoholics Anonymous.

So exactly what was my role; and what did it mean to be the Guardian of the Traditions? Well, in my group that meant that when voting on issues pertaining to group, district, area and Fellowship matters, it was my responsibility to point out the Tradition or Traditions involved, to give all the pertinent information about the matter and to try to remain as neutral as possible. In other words, to let the group discuss matters thoroughly without trying to sway the vote with my opinion. This way I could come away with a truly informed group conscience and not just a one-sided agreement with how I felt. It also meant that I kept my D.C.M. and area committee up to date with information when anything changed. It was a commitment to attend group, district and area meetings and as many workshops and learning sessions as I was able. I had to become a student of the Traditions and learn as much as I could about how they applied to my group and the rest of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Does this mean I was to be an A.A. cop? Well, I wanted to be. However, I soon realized that by becoming familiar with all our literature, and pointing out the Traditions involved, I could hopefully guide the group by showing where I got my information and trusting that our ultimate authority would be a Loving God expressed by our informed group conscience. I believe that through the position of G.S.R. I learned that love and service were really the same thing and that the role of the G.S.R. is as valid today as it was when the Conference structure was first conceived.

I think that as I traveled down the Conference structure ladder, I learned how important it was to nurture newcomers and expose them to general service. I need to encourage members to take on this important position when they are ready so that the continuity of love and service in Alcoholics Anonymous is always maintained. This is something we can all do through sponsorship and service sponsorship. We can be examples of love and service and keep the attraction of service in A.A. alive. In this way we will always have someone ready to step into the position of G.S.R. and as we end our service careers in the general service structure we can gracefully become elder statesmen and let the new gen-

eration of G.S.R.s step confidently into their roles as Guardians of the Traditions.

Maria Emery, Oregon

THE LANGUAGE OF THE HEART

The final presentations of the Conference, on Friday morning, were moderated by Barret Francis.

Listening to the Language of the Heart

Thank you for the kind invitation to speak today about the language of the heart. As I speak, I'm sure you hear me. But how many of you are really listening? What does the word "listening" mean? In my French dictionary, incidentally called *La Petit Robert* (The Little Robert), and not in deference to my predecessor Robert L., one reads that "to listen" means, among other things, to pay attention...to welcome. The *Merriam-Webster's Collegiate Dictionary* also says that "to listen" means "to hear something with thoughtful attention." Are we always listening well? Are we always paying attention? Are we always welcoming? Do we have the wisdom to know the difference between hearing and listening? Even I may at times fail to listen or even sometimes to hear, especially when I withdraw, to smoke a cigar.... And I notice that there are many members of A.A. who have not yet learned to listen. Even our co-founder Bill had the reputation of not being a good listener, as noted by our first archivist Nell Wing in her memoirs: "You could carry on a spirited conversation with him," she writes, "as long as you stuck to the subject he was hot on at the moment. If you tried to shift to another subject, he might simply walk away. He could be a poor listener if the topic of conversation didn't interest him." Unfortunately, or perhaps fortunately, there are still many Bills among us.

Language of the heart — is there really such a language? Is it a reality or simply a generous utopia, like Esperanto? *The language of the heart* could at least become the universal language of A.A.s, whatever their mother tongue is in the 150-odd countries where Alcoholics Anonymous exists. There are more than two million of us. How many have purchased or read the book *The Language of the Heart*, or a translation of it? Yet what better initiation could there be to this new language? We still have a long way to go; we A.A.s are not very good at reading. Our literature sales are rather eloquent in this regard. The Big Book is our only best seller really. Nearly everybody buys the Big Book, but a survey has shown that many members have never read it from cover to cover! We are a "fellowship of men and women who share." We talk a lot, but we don't read much. We live in an oral tradition, and we like to repeat and embroider on somebody else's often misguided interpretation. If you don't read the literature, you may find yourself at the mercy of another ignorant who hasn't read the literature either.

In order to share, you need at least two people. One speaks and the other listens. Then you switch. I've heard it said that we have one mouth and two ears, because it's twice as important to listen than to speak. And in A.A., we're asked to speak the language of the heart. The language of the heart is the language of love. Since Tradition Two talks about a "loving" God — the only qualifier A.A.s have taken the liberty to attribute to God — it follows that the language of the heart is the language of God. Do we listen to God when He expresses Himself through our individual conscience, through our group conscience, and through our fellow travelers? We are all trusted servants. Speaking of trust, in *As Bill Sees It*, on page 144, Bill writes, "There can be no trust where there is no love, nor can there be real love where distrust holds

its malign sway." Though he warns that we should not "be blind to other people's motives." We ought to be worthy of the trust invested in us and, above all, be rigorously honest. Sometimes false harmony, based on hypocrisy, is valued. Under the pretext of showing unconditional love, we may avoid talking about the real issues. We may feel we have to be politically correct. In my humble opinion, if we play that kind of game, we neither speak nor listen to the language of the heart. If I manage to practice all 36 spiritual principles of our way of life, I will aim at Unity — with rigorous honesty!

Our service structure, as defined in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, is a true model of democracy. When creating this model, Bill Wilson and Bernard Smith took great pains to avoid sectarian politics. In A.A. there are no parties, and therefore no official opposition. In their decision, Bill and Bernard assumed that the minority opinion would play the role of an opposition party. They made the assumption that people would be sober enough to be clear-headed, recovered enough to have some discernment, honest enough to admit evidences, brave enough to speak their minds, tolerant enough to respect somebody else's opinion, and disciplined enough to submit to the decision of an informed group conscience. You have to be courageous and brave-hearted to voice your opinion. You have to be tolerant and kind-hearted to listen to the opinions of others, especially when they contradict your own. In such instances, do we always speak with the language of the heart, or do we argue for the sake of arguing? Do we take the time to listen respectfully to the language of the heart as spoken by the defenders of a minority opinion? Exacerbated because they feel they are being censored or that nobody listens to them, those people may sometimes use words that do not fit well with the language of the heart, but still their talk is far less ungraceful than what is often heard in the Canadian House of Commons, or perhaps in the American Congress (you tell me). We may sometimes use rough language... but we are not the only ones!

The theme of this Conference is Love and Service. Let me just formulate a few elements for reflexion. Do we serve with love? What about the language of the heart? Is that the language we speak? And above all, do we listen to it? Is our capacity for welcoming and listening to the minority opinion an indication of the quality of our recovery and emotional sobriety? Perhaps some day, people will say about us, "They are anonymous, but by their words and by their deeds you will recognize them: they speak the language of the heart, they listen and they serve with love."

Vincent Cousineau, Southwest Quebec

Sharing Experience, Strength and Hope

When I received the invitation to speak, my thoughts alternated between fear and a mixture of pleasure and excitement. I began to wonder what I would say, and that was what prompted the excitement. It is always a pleasure to serve the Fellowship that saved my life and it's exciting to think that maybe I can pay back a little something. At other times, when given the opportunity to share, God has put words in my mouth, and I prayed that this would be the same.

The next day, another envelope arrived from G.S.O. and one of the items included was the pamphlet, "Circles of Love and Service." Then I knew what part of my message would be. You see, when I was newly sober I attended a workshop in a neighboring town. We were divided up into small groups and each was given a few different pamphlets to review. This very pamphlet was one of the ones we studied, but at that time I had never seen it before. At first I didn't understand, but the lady that was mod-

erating explained the different colored parts of the circle. She was patient and kind, taking the time to explain things completely. I could feel the unconditional love but didn't know what it was then. Today I realize she was speaking the language of the heart. It attracted me, got me interested in service and later was the thing that kept me here.

A few months later, I was elected general service representative at my home group, then as district committee member the next term. During this time we had a little problem with one of the groups in our district. They had Al-Anon and A.A. meetings together as one meeting. We knew it wasn't working, but they didn't want to change their meeting and I felt like it was up to me to do something. I spent a lot of time thinking it over, trying to decide what to do. One day, when I was home making apple juice, the phone rang and it was one of those voices from the past that you think you'll never hear again. I talked on the phone for a while and it was just like I was back about six years earlier. My vocabulary changed, my thinking changed, and when I got off the phone I just wanted to jump in the car and head up to the city. But I didn't. I had made plans to take a car-load of members to that meeting in my district where they were having problems, and I knew I had to keep my word. So we went to the meeting and talked and things began to change. We tried to support the meeting more and finally we took an Al-Anon member with us and that seemed to work wonders. It took about a month before things in the district were back to normal. I got caught up in trying to help with the problems, and today I know that is what saved me from heading up to the city to have that one last party. I know that service saved my life.

When our area was looking for people to chair the various committees, some of the members talked with me and reasoned that since I had grown up in the newspaper business, perhaps I should put my name in for the Grapevine committee. I thought maybe, in some small way, I would have something to offer, so I agreed, saying that I would help if they needed me. Still, I was surprised to see my name on the board the next day as chairperson for the Area 78 Grapevine committee. And once again the fear was there, but I prayed and was reminded that when you have faith there is no room for fear. The next term I served as treasurer for our area and found it to be a busy position, but once again my Higher Power sent me help in the form of a loving partner who was more than happy to come with me to assemblies to help out. So, love and service were becoming very intertwined in my life.

When I was elected area chairperson, it was the first time a female member had served our area in this capacity. I had been hesitant to let my name stand, but had been reminded that other female members needed to know that they could do it, and I remembered the words: We lead by example. It was a wonderful learning experience and I could feel the "I" becoming "We." I learned that everyone has a voice and it doesn't matter whether I agree with it or not, it still needs to be heard. I learned to love this Fellowship with all my heart, and found that if someone was persistent with their viewpoint it was probably because they loved it too and wanted what was best for A.A. in their eyes. This made it easier to put principles before personalities and strive for the best.

When I was elected delegate, I was overwhelmed at first, and felt I was not equal to the job. But then a past delegate shared with me and, once again, I heard the language of the heart just when I needed to hear it. At last year's Conference, during our Literature Committee's report, we got to experience first hand just how divinely guided this program really is. We had spent a lot of time trying to come to a consensus on the various recommendations, but it wasn't until the report was given and discussion ensued that it began to work. When we stopped for the coffee break, and I had

a chance to talk with some of the others on the committee, I could see that light in their eyes and feel the excitement — but I couldn't quite put my finger on it at first. It was later, when I began working on a report to give at assembly, that I realized God was doing for us what we could not do for ourselves.

Recently, we attended a one-day roundup in our area. While listening to the speaker, I heard her say how it was the unconditional love that kept her coming to meetings when she was a shaky newcomer, and once again I heard the language of the heart.

I would like to share some of Dr. Bob's words from *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*, (p. 338): "There are two or three things that flashed into my mind on which it would be fitting to lay a little emphasis. One is the simplicity of our program. Let's not louse it all up with Freudian complexes and things that are interesting to the scientific mind, but have very little to do with our actual A.A. work. Our Twelve Steps, when simmered down to the last, resolve themselves into the words 'love' and 'service.' We understand what love is, and we understand what service is. So let's bear those two things in mind."

Thank you for the opportunity to serve. May God bless you and keep you as we trudge the road of happy destiny.

Carol Readman, Alberta/Northwest Territories

Passing On Our Three Legacies

Recovery — I try to pass on our Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service simply by example. By passing on the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous, which were so freely given to me by my sponsor, I point the way for those I sponsor by going through the Twelve Steps with them, one at a time, one-on-one. Also, by trying to practice the A.A. principles in all my affairs, like Dr. Bob said in his story: "I do it for four reasons: Sense of duty; It is a pleasure; Because in so doing I am paying my debt to the man who took time to pass it on to me; Because every time I do it I take out a little more insurance for myself against a possible slip." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, pp. 180-81)

Unity — By giving rides to those who need to get to a meeting, and by sharing my experience, strength and hope with others, I pass it on. By having a home group and attending the home group weekly, I live the A.A. way of life in a healthy way. By chairing the same home group meetings and seeing to it that the group sticks to its primary purpose of helping the still-suffering alcoholic, the A.A. legacy can continue. By seeing that my home group remains self-supporting and continues to remember that "Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities," (Tradition Twelve), I will help the group to grow.

Service — The most important job I can do is to make sure the coffee is hot and the door is open and that my hand is out for the new man that comes through the door. By seeing that my home group has a general service representative, I can participate by sharing with the person what the G.S.R.'s responsibilities are. If the person becomes a district committee member, or a panel member, or area committee member, I can share my experience with that service job, too.

This is what Bill W. had to say in Concept IX about good leadership: "Real leadership, of course, has to function in between these entirely imaginary poles of hoped-for excellence. In A.A. certainly no leader is faceless, and neither is any leader perfect. Fortunately our Society is blessed with any amount of real leadership — the active people of today and the potential leaders of tomorrow as each new generation of able members swarms in. We have an abundance of men and women whose dedication,

stability, vision, and special skills make them capable of dealing with every possible service assignment. We have only to seek these folks out and trust them to serve us.... Our leaders do not drive by mandate, they lead by example." (*The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, pp. 38-39)

Therefore, "I am responsible...When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that, I am responsible."

John Karch, Southwest Ohio

Language of the Heart

Bill W. framed the importance of the language of the heart very well. "From the beginning," he wrote, "communication in A.A. has been no ordinary transmission of helpful ideas and attitudes.... Our channels of contact have always been charged with the language of the heart." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 243)

I first learned about the language of the heart when I was a psychiatric resident. My clinical director, although later president of his psychoanalytic institute, had an extraordinary capacity to Keep It Simple — perhaps the only psychoanalyst in the world with that capacity. In contrast to many of my psychiatric teachers — who had rich Viennese accents, had grown up near opera houses and had physicians and rabbis for fathers — my clinical director, Elvin Semrad, had grown up as a Catholic on a Nebraska farm.

In contrast to almost everyone at Harvard, he understood that the most important human organ was the heart and not the brain. Oh sure, if you want to learn something of no true importance, like the multiplication tables, writing legal contracts, or how to spell schizophrenia, it's a good idea to have a brain. But for the important tasks in life — sending valentines, growing children, making friends, or staying sober — the language of the heart is superior to that of the brain every time.

Semrad taught us to keep it simple. If patients felt entitled, were arrogant and seemed to expect that the world owed them a living, you did not address their brains, or lecture them piously and critically about their responsibilities, for brains are mainly good only for taking other people's inventories. Instead, Dr. Semrad taught us to ask such patients, with genuine curiosity, "Do you got the Gimmies?" If you wished to reach a suffering person, you did not ask them about their depressions, or how long they had been taking Prozac. You asked them about the pain in their heart. If you wished to inquire about their love life, you didn't ask about their "object relations" and their "significant others," you asked them "Who was the person who has most touched your heart?" You never used words longer than two syllables. And you discussed their illness with them by drawing attention to their bodily feelings, not their intellect.

It was Semrad's teaching in 1960 that laid the groundwork many years later for my admiration for the communication style in Alcoholics Anonymous. In the movie *Dead Poets Society*, Robin Williams tells his students to "carpe diem." Such a communication requires both a working knowledge of Latin and a request to perform the technically difficult task of grabbing hold of a day. In contrast, A.A. taught me to speak simple English, "You have one foot in yesterday, one foot in tomorrow and you are pissing all over today."

Okay, so the language of the heart is important in human relations, but why should the language of the heart be particularly important to recovery from alcoholism? First, evolution gave us brains to go to school, to exclaim like two-year-olds, "Get away; I'll do it by myself" and to be in control. That's fine when it works, but what about when we are not in control? What then? Only the heart understands that at times of crisis, without recourse to a

power greater than ourselves, our lives will remain unmanageable. Only the heart understands that recovery depends upon connection. You can get drunk by yourself, but you can only be tickled in a relationship. Again, the heart understands that mere words don't matter. Bill tells us that what he valued from Dr. Silkworth was not words, "Love was his magic. . ." (*The Language of the Heart*, p.243), "the understanding, the interest, and the affection that he so freely gave me. I was not alone anymore with my problem." (*ibid.*, p. 244).

Carl Jung suggested to Bill W. that there were two ways to recover from alcoholism. First, *Spiritus contra spiritum*. (Nuts, there is someone babbling Latin again.) Let my heart translate. What old Carl was really trying to tell Bill was that "God trumps gin." But Jung also wrote to Bill that there was a second cure for alcoholism — the "protective wall of human community." If Jung had only been raised on a farm like my clinical director, he could have condensed all those fancy syllables into "Home Group." The heart keeps it simple.

Now most of you call your higher power "God," but the agnostics among you may prefer to call their higher power "Home Group." For sixty years a lot of A.A. sponsors have worried about the right words to say "God," but regardless of the words, the melody stays the same — love and compassion from a power that isn't you. Remember, the heart only listens to the music, not the words. The heart knows that what is greater than ourselves is LOVE — that is what the heart is all about. Whether you call "love" God or Home Group, your heart could care less.

Remember: First things first. Only the brain worries about "second" and "third" and finding just the right words. The language of the heart, like hugs and smiles, leaps over language barriers. Words do not communicate to someone who does not speak our language, but the heart does. Ten years after his first visit to European A.A. groups, Bill recalled, "We understood not one word of Norwegian.... Yet there was a marvelous communication from the first moment. . . Everywhere, everywhere, it was the same... the communication of heart to heart in wonder, in joy, and in everlasting gratitude." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 250).

Bill also understood that the language of the heart in A.A. is more honest than psychiatrists' words, more honest than either Dr. Silkworth's or mine. Your Home Group has been there; your doctor and your Class A trustee has not. Bill notes, "One of the first insights Dr. Bob and I shared was that all true communication must be founded on mutual need.... We saw that each sponsor would have to humbly admit his own needs as clearly as those of his prospect. (*ibid.*, p. 247) "Perhaps the secret of their power lies in the fact that these life-giving communications spring out of living experience and are rooted in sacrificial love." (*ibid.*, p. 249)

A resident once asked Dr. Semrad, "What do you think helped build your capacity to help people bear intense feelings of loneliness and loss?" He answered simply, "A life of sorrow, and the opportunity that some people gave me to overcome it and deal with it." (*Semrad, The Heart of a Therapist*, p. 206)

Let me close by sharing with you — "in wonder, in joy, and in everlasting gratitude" — how much it means to me as a Class A (and A is for amateur) to be included within your loving family of Alcoholics Anonymous.

George E. Vaillant, M.D., Class A trustee

During the trustee elections, Class A trustee Linda Chezern, when asking for a vote whether or not to go to next ballot, said, "Please raise your *right* hand." Linda is a judge.

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees and G.S.O.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: A highlight for all of us last year was the International Convention in Minneapolis. We celebrated A.A.'s 65th anniversary along with 47,000 A.A. and Al-Anon members, and other friends of A.A. Thanks to careful planning by the G.S.O. staff and the enthusiasm of those attending, this Convention was a great success. We were especially pleased that 3,000 A.A.s from other countries came to the Convention. One of the benefits of holding these Conventions every five years is that it demonstrates vividly that A.A. works, wherever it is carried.

We were hosts for the 16th World Service Meeting last October in New York. Thirty-nine delegates from 23 countries spent a week sharing their service experience with each other. Dean Rinehart and Alex Palmer, our trustees-at-large, were our delegates. Our unity as a Fellowship was there for all to see. Each participant shared the common goal of carrying the message of hope to alcoholics everywhere. We all share the same principles, our Steps, Traditions, and Concepts, and we all share a common belief in the value of service. We also share some common challenges, like encouraging participation in service by others, self-support, and communicating within and among our service structures. I encourage you to read and share with others the report of the 16th World Service Meeting, which is available from G.S.O. The section on country reports shows how much we all have in common. Most of the delegates were able to stay and participate in our board meetings following the World Service Meeting.

We approved several new translations of A.A. literature. This year, for example, we helped finance translations of the Big Book into Mongolian, Romanian and Slovak. We also evaluated, approved and obtained copyrights on translations into Punjabi and Bengali undertaken by the G.S.O. in Bombay. India is also working on translations into Gujarathi, Konkani, Orija, Telegu, and Urdu. The Big Book has been translated into 42 languages, and many more will follow in the years to come.

Our trustees and staff members traveled abroad to share our experience with other countries. We visited Cuba, Romania, Panama, France, Germany, the Czech Republic, Belarus and Brazil. Last year I reported on our visit to South Africa, where we and the G.S.O. of Great Britain explored ways to work with alcoholics in English-speaking Africa. Greg Muth visited France last month to continue a similar effort to help carry the A.A. message into French-speaking Africa. In Africa, A.A. is not nearly as well known as it might be, and millions of alcoholics suffer without ever hearing the A.A. message.

The World Service Meeting reaffirmed its belief that it is essential for A.A. to preserve its copyrights on A.A. literature. Past World Service Meetings have had similar discussions and reached the same conclusion — that we must protect the integrity of the A.A. message as it is presented in our literature. All World Service Meeting participants rely to an important extent on income from literature sales to supplement group contributions. They believe that having a common literature is important to maintaining unity in their countries.

The board's Legal Affairs Committee met several times last year. This committee has oversight of A.A.W.S.'s legal actions to protect copyrights and

other legal matters affecting G.S.O. Committee members are Linda Chezem, Dean Rinehart, Richard Roughton and Tony Taschner. The committee met with Greg Muth, our general manager, Michael Alexander, general counsel, Jacqueline Johnston, the chairman of A.A.W.S. and me. Dean and Michael are lawyers, and Linda is a judge, and we are able to use their expertise to help evaluate the advice of outside counsel.

Bill W. began the practice of registering copyrights on A.A. literature and asking alcoholics in other countries to respect them. As a result, alcoholics can read the Big Book in words that come as close in spirit as possible to the original 1939 English version, whatever language it is translated into.

In 1997, the trustees of the General Service Board voted unanimously to preserve and protect the copyrights we hold in trust for all of A.A. around the world, including taking legal action, if necessary. An individual in Germany published copyrighted A.A. literature in German and other languages. Both we and the German G.S.O. asked him to stop, pointing out the harm that might result from his actions, but we were unsuccessful in dissuading him. We later took legal action to preserve our copyrights. As I reported to you last year, the German courts have ruled that our copyrights were valid and that they had been infringed. The infringing party appealed that ruling, and the matter remains in the German courts.

We will continue to preserve our copyrights, which are valid outside of the United States on the Big Book, and worldwide on the rest of our literature. We are firm in our resolve to take whatever action is necessary both to preserve the integrity of A.A. literature and the ability of foreign G.S.O.s to do their work. We do not and would not take legal action in a dispute about A.A. Tradition or principle. That is something we could never do, as our A.A. principles tell us. Our legal action in Germany is not based on someone's breach of A.A. Tradition. We would be taking the same action if the individual were alcoholic or nonalcoholic, for profit or not-for-profit, or whether he had good or bad motives. Legal action is something we undertake only as a last resort to preserve our copyrights. There are no "copyright police;" if we fail to protect our copyrights, we will eventually lose them. Once lost, they are gone forever. I hope and pray that the infringing party will stop so we can all concentrate on carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics. Bill W. wrote in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* that the Big Book was "put in trust for our Fellowship for all time." We are honoring that trust.

With the growth of the Internet, we have occasionally found that A.A. copyrighted literature was being posted on some Web sites without permission. I'm happy to report that most of those

Web site operators have responded positively to our requests by removing A.A. Conference-approved literature posted to their sites. We have also obtained rights to several domain names that were easily confused with ours.

Michael Alexander has retired from the practice of law and has chosen to end his role as general counsel for the General Service Board. Michael has been involved in A.A.'s affairs for more than forty years, starting as a young lawyer working with Bernard Smith, who was one of the pioneer friends of A.A. and an early chairman of the board. Michael



served for ten years as a Class A trustee and came back to serve four more as chairman of the board. Michael will continue to serve A.A. as an active trustee emeritus.

I want to report how valuable I have found the advice of our two active trustees emeriti, Mike and Jim Estelle, particularly during my term as chairman of the General Service Board. Both men continue to make their experience available to all of us at board meetings, at the Conference, and between meetings.

Since the 50th Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Kingston, Ontario, Burbank, California, and Huntington, West Virginia, and a Special Forum in Spokane, Washington. These Forums were well attended and followed our tradition of sharing and learning from each other about how we can better serve A.A. G.S.O. is planning three Special Forums: an Hispanic-oriented Forum in Austin, Texas, December 8-9, 2001, an "Inner-city" Forum in Chicago, March 23-24, 2002, and a Forum in Chicoutimi, Quebec, May 25-26, 2002. These are all intended to reach alcoholics who do not normally attend regular Regional Forums.

I want to thank the Big Book Fourth Edition subcommittee for their hard work this year. Members are Richard Roughton, chairman, Jim Clough, David Every, Marne Hill, John Koster and Beth Rabren, plus Vinnie McCarthy and Valerie O'Neill. Over the past four years, because of rotation, a total of 11 trustees and directors from around the U.S. and Canada, as well as staff, have served on this most demanding committee.

G.S.O. has made progress on its computer networking and systems upgrading project during the past year. Employees are now much better able to communicate with each other, with trustees and directors, and with those we serve. In the long term, we expect to support our current or greater level of work with fewer employees because of the productivity we can gain through better use of technology. G.S.O. is now into phase two of this project, which involves adapting new software available to us because we have upgraded our hardware.

G.S.O. had another excellent year financially. Sales were greater than expected, and operating expenses were well below budget, largely because of delays in filling some positions. We are especially grateful that contributions were 6.3% ahead of last year. Income was slightly less than \$1 million, compared with a budgeted income of \$148,000 and actual income in 1999 of \$866,000. For the year 2001, we expect flat sales, growth in contributions of 2%, and a 9% increase in operating expenses as vacant positions are filled and more services added. We project income for the year of \$137,000.

As a matter of board policy, we budget International Conventions to breakeven. Forty-seven thousand people attended the Convention in Minneapolis, a greater number than the 42,500 assumed in our budget. The extra revenue from these added attendees, along with the fact that we did not spend amounts budgeted for contingencies as we normally do, resulted in income of \$997,000. As a practical matter, we know that however carefully we plan and control Conventions, we will always make or lose money on them because we can never forecast attendance precisely. Over our long history of ten Conventions, we have had total income of \$750,000. As a result of these exceptionally strong financial results at G.S.O. and the Convention, our Reserve Fund stands at 11.6 months of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine operating expense, after the recent transfer of funds from A.A.W.S.

The Grapevine narrowed its loss to \$16,100 in 2000 and expects to breakeven from operations for 2001, not counting one-time expenses relating to outsourcing and reorganization of \$338,000. The Grapevine Board has made the sound decision to outsource much of its business operations. Outside vendors can perform these business operations much more economically

because they do them for a large number of customers. The Grapevine might save \$160,000 per year from outsourcing, which will help offset rising costs in the future. Since 1994, the Grapevine has lost money every year, a total of \$439,000 not counting La Viña, which, along with the one-time costs this year, means the Grapevine will have drawn \$777,000 from the Reserve Fund since 1994. The General Service Board has been concerned for some time that the Grapevine would either have to continue to receive large subsidies from the General Service Board or raise the price of the magazine again to cover increasing costs. A price increase would likely hurt circulation with the result that fewer alcoholics would benefit from the Grapevine. The decision to outsource some business functions is an important step toward making the Grapevine self-supporting. These changes should not affect editorial or product quality or customer service. The Grapevine is conducting a search for a new executive editor, has just hired a new finance director, and is midway in implementing the outsourcing project.

The Grapevine Board and management are in the midst of an extremely stressful year. They have received much support and advice from the trustees' Finance Committee and the General Service Board about policy matters. Our key objectives are to have the Grapevine continue to carry the message and serve as a voice of the Fellowship, while being good stewards of the funds entrusted to us. We are especially grateful for the hard work of the Grapevine staff during this transition.

The General Service Board took another hard look at our Spanish-language magazine La Viña last year. We appointed an ad hoc committee chaired by Jim Clough, along with Tom Maguire, Greg Tobin and Beth Rabren, to come back to the board with recommendations. The General Service Board believes La Viña should continue to be published because it helps carry the A.A. message to a fast-growing part of A.A. La Viña is a success in every sense except financial. It has accumulated losses, funded by the Reserve Fund, of \$445,000. Because it has almost no chance of becoming self-supporting or being absorbed by the Grapevine financially for many years, it is best to think of La Viña as a service to the Fellowship, just like the corrections assignment or foreign literature assistance. Like these services, it is financed by group contributions and A.A. literature sales. While La Viña technically has been funded from the General Service Board's Reserve Fund, the Reserve Fund is funded by group contributions and publishing income from A.A.W.S. Normally, services to groups are carried out by G.S.O. In this case, the service of La Viña is carried out at the Grapevine, where our magazine publishing experience and skill is found.

The General Service Board will probably have to continue to subsidize La Viña by \$60,000-\$70,000 each year, money well spent, in the board's opinion. The General Service Board, through the trustees' Finance Committee, will continue its oversight, although La Viña will be under the direct supervision of the Grapevine Board. The 1995 Conference Advisory Action about La Viña stated that it could be funded by the General Service Board Reserve Fund for up to five years, and that, if after five years it was determined to be no longer feasible, publication be discontinued. We are nearing the end of five years of publication. The General Service Board is asking this Conference to allow La Viña to continue.

I will rotate at the end of this Conference after four years as chairman, eight years as trustee, and sixteen years of service to this board. I am so grateful that you have let me be a part of this spiritual and practical society, that does so much good for so many people. Thank you for letting me serve.

Gary Glynn, chairman

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a New York not-for-profit corporation. The trustees of the General Service Board are the members of A.A.W.S. and elect the A.A.W.S. directors, who are responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), which provides group services, including printing and distribution of Conference-approved and service literature. The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the last Conference to receive G.S.O. management and staff reports, review group services activity and progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations, review financial reports, price new or revised publications, review publishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration, consider requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A.-copyrighted literature, and address other matters as they arose.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Currently, four are trustees, including two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three other directors; and the G.S.O. general manager and the staff coordinator also serve as directors. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are the services director, G.S.O. staff members, controller, publications director, information services manager, human resources director, archivist, board secretary and a Grapevine staff member. The board welcomed guests, trustees, appointed members of trustees' committees, delegates and other A.A. members to its meetings during the year.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services, which considers the needs of all service assignments; Publishing, which reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications concerns; Finance, which oversees salary and budget, audit review, and retirement; and Nominating. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole.

New Groups — During 2000, a net total of 1,081 new groups were registered with G.S.O.

Group Information Updates — Letters were sent to all area registrars and secretaries, with copies to delegates, informing them of the new procedures for the annual update of group information. Hopefully, the changes will enable G.S.O. to be in contact with more groups by having current contact mailing information. Starting in January 2001, new G.S.R. Kits were sent out by First Class Mail as a result of accumulated sharing from Regional Forums requesting more timely distribution.

Letters to D.C.M.s — Letters were sent to all D.C.M.s concerning visiting new and unregistered groups, including a memo for such groups entitled "Is Your Group Linked to A.A. as a Whole?"

Regional and Special Forums — Since the last Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff participated in the following Regional and Special Forums: Pacific Regional Forum, Burbank, California, August 25-27; Eastern Canada Regional Forum, Kingston, Ontario, September 8-10; Southeast Regional Forum, Huntington, West Virginia, November 17-19. A Special Forum was held in Yakima and Spokane, Washington, January 6-7, 2001, and had over 400 attendees.

Special Needs Service Piece — The board approved a Special Needs service piece, which is in the process of being printed in pamphlet format in English, French and Spanish.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — The A.A.W.S. Services Committee received a report indicating that G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site was visited 1,200,000 times during 2000, an increase of approximately 62% over 1999. The committee approved a disclaimer to be included with G.S.O.'s links to Web sites of overseas G.S.O.s. This allowed us to broaden our number of international links, more easily connecting inquiries that would be more appropriately dealt with by G.S.O.s in other countries.

The Web site was completely reconfigured in June of 2000, expanding beyond its initial Public Information scope. More recovery-orientated pamphlets and a complete new section entitled "Fellowship Services" were added. In addition, the site was involved in the 2000 International Convention. For the first time, we offered information about the Convention online, including an online registration option for attendees. The site also posted a series of Convention Press Releases, including a Friday night release which included downloadable photos of the Flag Ceremony for journalists.

The Fellowship Services section of the Web site has information on Regional Forums, including downloadable registration forms; New Group Information and Group Change of Information in a PDF format for easy downloading; and the 10 FAQs on A.A. Web sites. We are in the process of making our A.A. Guidelines available in this section. On February 16, 2001, we initiated e-mail access to G.S.O. staff through the Web site. The potential for communication about and around our Fellowship through this medium is just beginning to be explored. It is interesting to note that, notwithstanding the broadened scope of the site, the three most frequently visited areas remain those directly related to our Twelfth Step ("A.A. Fact File," "Is A.A. for You?" and the List of Central Offices/Intergroups).

Intergroup Seminar — The 15th Annual Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S. Seminar was held in Little Rock, Arkansas, October 6-8, 2000, with representatives from over 100 offices participating.



Visitors to G.S.O. — G.S.O. welcomed 1,075 visitors during the year 2000. Following the International Convention, many visitors stopped by the office, bringing the total number of visitors during the month of July to 274. In addition, there were 134 visitors in June, compared to an average of 57 visitors per month during the first five months of the year.

International Convention — Over 47,000 A.A. and Al-Anon members, family and friends gathered in Minneapolis, Minnesota, June 29-July 2, 2000, to celebrate the 65th Anniversary of Alcoholics Anonymous. A great many positive comments were received regarding the Convention, including:

- “A+ event. A wonderful, inspiring and loving experience.”
- “Spectacular affair.”
- “Great Convention — looking forward to the next.”
- “Totally awesome, it was the first one I’ve attended in 15 years of sobriety. I absolutely loved it!”
- “This was my first International Convention; it was great in all aspects — meetings, transportation and hotels ... thanks for a great experience.”
- “Thanks for all the hard work and love that was given by all. Attending has given me a new understanding of my fellows and myself.”
- “Well done, see you in Toronto!”

Comments by attendees about the Host Committee included:

- “They were great! They started welcoming me at the airport and never stopped — it touched me, made me cry!”
- “Great job by great folks!”
- “[The] Greeters [were] an explosion of enthusiasm.”

World Service Meeting — The 16th World Service Meeting was held in New York, October 20-26, 2000, with 39 delegates from 29 countries in attendance, and an invitation was also extended to them to attend the October 28-30 General Service Board weekend. The theme of the World Service Meeting was “A.A. — Our Future Is Our Responsibility.” A number of presentations under the topics, “The Flow of Information in A.A.,” “Making Service More Attractive Through Improving Communication,” “How Can We Better Carry the Message in a Changing World,” “Shared Experience Through Magazines and Newsletters,” “Country-to-Country Sponsorship” and more, reflected shared experience and contributed to engaging discussions following each. Workshops included topics such as Resolving Difficulties in the Development of Service Structures, Communication Between Countries, Is A.A. Still Attractive? and one unstructured workshop. As one delegate put it, “It was spiritually uplifting and heartfelt.”

International — General Service Office staff enjoyed visits with trusted servants and A.A. members in service structures from other countries. During May 15-19, 2000, Eva Sanchez participated in the 10th Anniversary celebration of A.A. in Belarus, and visited the Intergroup Office in the Czech Republic and the G.S.O. in Hungary, as well as the G.S.O. in Paris, to meet with their new general manager, Patricia Raynaud, and board members. Dean Rinehart attended the Second Biennial National Service Conference in Romania, November 7-12, 2000, and met with board members of the Romanian General Service Board. Greg Muth visited the French G.S.O. in Paris and also met with the General Service Board, February 28-March 7, 2001.

Dean Rinehart attended the XV National Convention of Brazil, June 23-25, 2000. Alex Palmer visited the G.S.O. in Panama City and, along with Danny Mooney, attended the First National Convention in Panama, November 17-19, 2000. Eva Sanchez vis-

ited the General Service Office of Cuba in Havana, attended the 8th Anniversary of A.A. in Camagüey, and met with professionals during the period January 17-22, 2001.

International Visitors to G.S.O. in New York — Thirty-nine World Service Meeting delegates from approximately 30 countries visited G.S.O. while they were in town for the 16th World Service Meeting. Auykut K. visited from the Intergroup Service Office in Ankara, Turkey. Nonalcoholic “friends of A.A.,” Dr. Elena Filipieva from Ukraine and Dr. Bohdan Woronowicz from Poland, visited the office. A guest of the U.S. State Department, from Manipur State, India, visited and expressed interest in Alcoholics Anonymous.

Financial Results for 2000 — A brief summary of the financial results for 2000 reflected the following: gross sales of \$9,751,700, 6% greater than budgeted and 3% greater than 1999. Contributions received for the year totaled \$4,511,000, 4% over budget and 6% greater than 1999. Participation through voluntary contributions by members and groups increased each month, suggesting that the services offered by G.S.O. are helping groups with vital Twelfth Step work. Total revenue (gross profit from literature, contributions and interest) for 2000 was \$9,772,500, 5% greater than budgeted and 4% greater than last year. Total operating expenses for the year of \$8,789,000 were \$389,000 less than budgeted, but \$273,000 higher than in 1999. In summary, unaudited net income for the year was \$983,200.

2001 Budget — Through its Finance Committee, the board prepared, reviewed and recommended G.S.O.’s 2001 budget to the trustees’ Finance Committee. The budget projects \$9,671,300 in gross sales, \$5,103,200 in gross profit, \$4,595,000 in contributions, and \$9,701,700 in total revenue. Total expenses are projected at \$9,564,870 with a \$136,900 net profit budgeted for the year 2001. The board approved the transfer of \$1,500,000 to the General Service Board’s Reserve Fund.

Publishing — During 2000, 1,755,000 books were distributed, including 897,000 copies of the Big Book — 28,000 more than in 1999. Non-A.A. sales were down 8%, a continuing trend. The transition from the Kansas warehouse to the facility in Tennessee worked out well. The service is very good; most literature orders are shipped within one business day of receipt from A.A.W.S., with an error margin of less than 1%.

Translations — The following translations were completed and priced according to our policy, i.e., English equivalent: Mongolian Big Book; Romanian Big Book; Slovenian *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; Croatian “44 Questions” and “A Newcomer Asks”; Turkish “44 Questions,” “Do You Think You’re Different?” and “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship”; Ukrainian “Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?” “Do You Think You’re Different?” and “Young People and A.A.”; “Twelve Steps” and “Twelve Traditions” in Burmese and Shan; and “Information on Alcoholics Anonymous” service piece in Chinese. The board also approved \$22,000 to cover the cost of revising a Swahili translation of the Twelve and Twelve done in Kenya, to be produced in audiotape format.

Translations Policy — The A.A.W.S. policy regarding translations of A.A. literature—including publications and licensing considerations—has been reviewed and updated. Procedures were explained relating to general considerations, requests received for permission to translate, requests that A.A.W.S. undertake a translation, and translations completed with prior A.A.W.S. permission. The G.S.O. general manager, the International Desk and the Publications Department have been given the latitude to begin translations as needed, rather than waiting for approval at a board meeting.

Discussions Regarding the Big Book on A.A. Web Site — There are ongoing discussions in the A.A.W.S. Publishing Committee regarding the possibility of placing all or partial text of the Big Book on G.S.O.’s A.A. Web Site. The committee discussed the

Marty Sullivan arrived at the Conference with a “care package” from an Eastern Pennsylvania D.C.M. Among the contents: cotton balls, “to insert in mouth”; earplugs; a box of “spare” marbles; a hair brush, “to brush off negative thoughts”; band-aids, “for hurt print”; neosporin, “for bruised ego”; foot powder, “to soothe defeat”; a tea strainer, to . . .

majority of positive responses received as a result of a request for sharing mailed in November to all U.S./Canada Central Offices/Intergroups. This discussion emphasized that the committee is in the beginning stages of collecting information and sharing and continues to be committed to slow, thoughtful deliberations. A seminar led by intellectual property attorneys was presented to the A.A.W.S. Board, G.S.O. staff and Publications Department personnel in December. The committee's overall efforts are to utilize G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site to be of maximum benefit to the Fellowship and the still-suffering alcoholic.

Copyright Infringement — The copyright infringement case involving the German General Service Office is currently before the Frankfurt Court of Appeals. Similarly, the infringement case in Germany involving A.A.W.S. and the same individual is also being heard by the same Court of Appeals. The A.A.W.S. Board continues to pray for a positive resolution to these cases.

The board selected a slate of officers to serve through the April 2001 Conference. The board welcomed new trustee director Beth Rabren, who replaced rotating trustee director Jack L. Ostrem in May 2000. Through its Nominating Committee, the board selected John C. Koster to serve as a general service trustee, replacing Richard Roughton, who will rotate following the April 2001 Conference. Jane Sheppard was selected to replace John C. Koster as a nontrustee director following the April 2001 Conference. All of these recommendations were forwarded to the trustees' Nominating Committee.

G.S.O./Staff Operations — At year-end 2000, G.S.O. had 77 full-time positions plus six part-time positions. A new, comprehensive Personnel Policies Handbook was distributed and discussed at an all-employee meeting. An ask-it-basket session was held to address employee concerns. G.S.O. management reported that on November 13, 2000, the long-anticipated conversion to the new desktop computer system was completed. Much thanks goes to Lillianna Murphy, Information Technology manager, and her staff for the successful completion of Phase One of this project. Phase Two began in January 2001 when the G.S.O. senior management team started the process of identifying operational software systems that will enhance our ability to work efficiently and seamlessly across all departments.

G.S.O.'s Archives celebrated its 25th Anniversary in November. The department produced, for display throughout the office, a sampling of historic pictures.

Archives Audio Preservation Project — Preservation on CD-ROMs of the 1955 International Convention has been completed and we have delivered the complete audio recordings of the 1951 and 1952 General Service Conferences to the audio engineer. The CD-ROM will provide us with an incomparably better method for processing the wealth of audio records accumulated in the Archives. We will be able to describe the talks individually and at a much deeper level, and to allow for comprehensive retrieval that was not possible with the analog reel-to-reel tapes.

Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes Inc. — The directors of Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes (S.M.A.A.), an affiliate corporation of A.A.W.S., Inc., have held meetings on a quarterly basis since the last Conference. At the January 26, 2001 meeting, the directors received reports on the operations and finances of the corporation during 2000. For the 12-month period ended December 31, 2000, S.M.A.A. realized a loss of approximately US\$33,000 from operations. After interest earned on the S.M.A.A. Reserve Fund and currency translations, a loss of US\$30,000 was recorded. The directors reviewed and accepted the S.M.A.A. budget for 2001, which was forwarded to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee. All financial results are combined with A.A.W.S. totals.

Jacqueline Johnston, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: The Archives Workshops at the Minneapolis International Convention were well attended. Each speaker represented a region, thus providing a cross-section of archival activities and services in the U.S. and Canada. Since the traveling exhibit was to be introduced at the Convention, it was agreed to reproduce the centerpiece of the new exhibit. A special wallet card that was developed to commemorate the event quickly became a popular item.

The committee expressed special appreciation to the G.S.O. Archives staff for their work at the 2000 International Convention.

The committee approved the reproduction of a second set of ten photos to be reproduced and distributed within A.A. only for the purposes of local displays. The set includes pictures of early International Conventions and past chairs of the General Service Board. It was agreed to suggest a contribution of \$12.00 from members interested in the new set, based on the assessment of current reproduction and shipping costs. At the same time, the suggested contribution was raised to \$12.00 for the first set as well, since reproduction and shipping costs are the same for both sets.

The committee forwarded for publication the manuscript of the Archives Workbook, which was the result of a few years' preparation and discussion. The new workbook will be available for the Conference Archives Committee's review and comment on an annual basis.

Further discussions were conducted over editorial changes and fine-tuning to be made on the proposed revision of the video *Markings on the Journey*. The running time is expected to be shortened and new narration will also be prepared.

Greg Tobin, chairperson

Archivist's report: The Archives area at the Minneapolis International Convention was a great success. Having a specially designated area was a first-time adventure for the G.S.O. Archives. Our new traveling exhibit was introduced there for the first time. Coincidentally, we repeated history with the timing. The former traveling exhibit was first shown at the Montreal International Convention 15 years earlier. The exhibit has since been scheduled for a number of area events and Regional Forums.

That the Archives area was well attended was demonstrated by the outstanding number of on-site requests we received at the Convention. Our exhibit focused on local history collecting and writing projects in various formats: leaflets, binders, published booklets, pamphlets, even some bound volumes. We extend special thanks to our 50 volunteers whose outstanding assistance greatly contributed to the smooth operation of the area.

The appearance of our permanent Archives exhibit at the General Service Office has been recently refreshed. Many of the picture frames were over 40 years old and could no longer protect the photos. New captions were added to make our exhibit more attractive and informative. We have completed the physical arrangement of our second on-site storage room, with completely new shelving and storage arrangement.

The year 2000 marked the beginning of our on-going audio preservation efforts. We have completed the audio transfer of the following historic events: International Conventions: 1955, 1965; General Service Conferences: 1951, 1952, 1953, 1954, 1956, 1957, 1958, 1962, 1966, 1967, 1968; and finally, the First World Service Meeting in 1969.

The Archives continued to receive outstanding donations in 2000, including early printings of A.A. books, other A.A.-related documents, and the collected papers of the late David Aronofsky (former trustee) and G.S.O.'s first archivist, Nell Wing.

Judit Santon, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 2000 General Service Conference. During that period we reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the 2000 Conference, including the theme chosen for the 51st General Service Conference, "Love and Service."

We reviewed the summary of the 2000 Conference Evaluation Questionnaire. Several suggestions were made, including a suggestion to discuss at the joint meeting of the 2001 Conference the need to have a more flexible agenda and breathing room for new presentation topics that might come up later in the year. The committee discussed participation at the Conference of the trustees, staff, directors and delegates and whether this question was necessary on the Evaluation Questionnaire. The committee felt this question should remain. The continuation of the pre-Conference Remote Communities meeting was discussed. Further discussion will be ongoing.

We also reviewed topics submitted for Conference consideration and forwarded subjects to the appropriate trustees or Conference committee. We reviewed and accepted the committee's 2001 budget and sent it to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee. We reviewed the preliminary main agenda for the 51st General Service Conference, and approved Workshop questions to be distributed in the Communications Kit, which was mailed to all Conference members January 1, 2001. The committee recommended that Bob Smith, Dr. Bob's son, be invited to the opening dinner of the 51st General Service Conference, as our guest, and be asked to read Dr. Bob's Farewell Talk and make a few brief remarks before the A.A. meeting begins.

In January, the committee approved the updated main Conference agenda, including presentation topics chosen by the Conference Agenda Committee and approved by the 2000 Conference. We forwarded over 30 Conference agenda topics to trustees and Conference committees, to A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards and discussed four subjects in great detail. We welcomed the delegate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee to the January 27th meeting and felt ready to join with all Conference members in a special celebration of A.A.'s 51st General Service Conference. Our committee sincerely hopes that everyone has a wonderful Conference experience and that we will continue in the spirit of "Love and Service" to Alcoholics Anonymous.

Beth Rabren, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics

through their area committees for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referral to a Conference committee. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

None of this work would be possible without the help of a very capable staff assistant and an "in-house" team of G.S.O. employees who were behind the scenes to help to make the Conference week a memorable experience.

Susan Ulseth

COMMITTEE ON COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES

Staff report: The trustee's Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities have been meeting jointly since August 2, 1998 as a result of an action taken by the General Service Board on April 21, 1998. Since the 2000 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities has met three times.

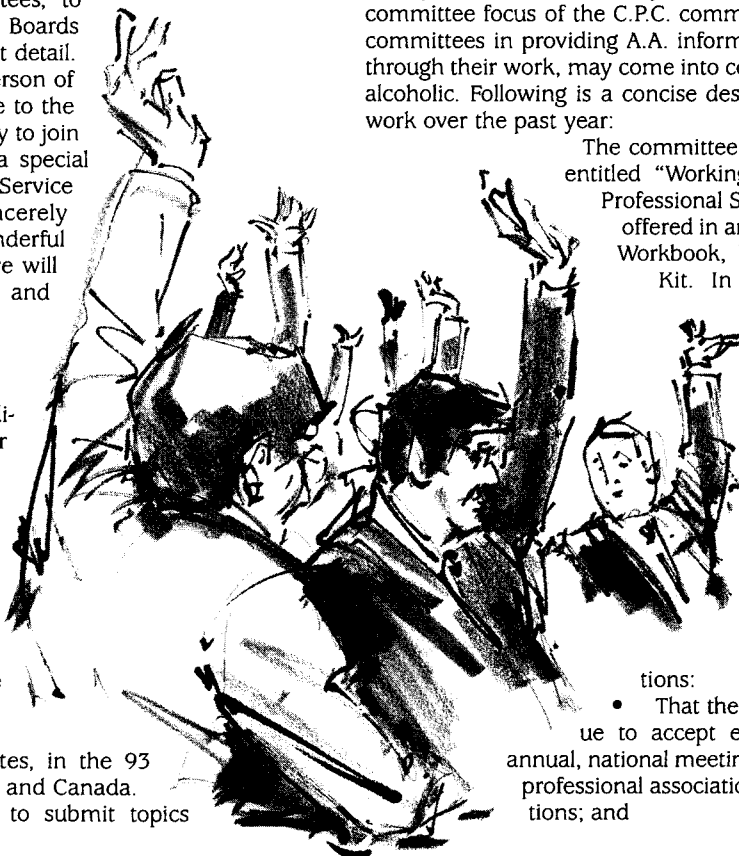
Cooperation With the Professional Community — A primary committee focus of the C.P.C. committee is to assist local C.P.C. committees in providing A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come into contact with the still-suffering alcoholic. Following is a concise description of the committee's work over the past year:

The committee agreed that a service piece entitled "Working With Students Attending Professional Schools," taken from sharing offered in an earlier edition of the C.P.C. Workbook, be inserted into the C.P.C.

Kit. In addition, the committee agreed that a modified version of the same service piece be added to the C.P.C. Workbook at its next printing. And, that the new addition to the C.P.C. Workbook be made available for review by the 2001 Conference Committee on C.P.C.

We reviewed and accepted the 2000 exhibit lists and evaluation reports and made the following suggestions:

- That the C.P.C. staff member continue to accept exhibit opportunities at the annual, national meetings of a wide cross-section of professional associations, including clergy associations; and





- That the Evaluation Questionnaire be revised to better reflect the number of persons visiting the A.A. booth at professional events as well as the number of event attendees.

Thirty-four national exhibits were coordinated by G.S.O. for 2000. In addition, 51 local exhibit invitations were referred to area C.P.C. committees. The committee accepted a preliminary national exhibit list for 2001 and made suggestions regarding future events to be added to the list. Regarding "remote communities," the committee decided that there was not enough information or shared experience available relative to C.P.C. work in remote communities to have a meaningful discussion at this time. We also discussed an ongoing concern often expressed that individuals referred to A.A. who focus on problems other than alcohol (i.e., drugs) at A.A. meetings may undermine group unity. The committee forwarded the topic to the 2001 Conference Committee on C.P.C. for further discussion and to determine how C.P.C. committees can help to address the issue when working with the professional community.

The committee was informed that the G.S.O. staff member on C.P.C. continues to respond to as many as 175 requests per month, via G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, for information about A.A. from a variety of professionals and from students training to become professionals.

Treatment Facilities — The purpose of this committee as it relates to treatment facilities is "... to further the acceptance of A.A. in hospitals, rehabilitation centers, and similar facilities, and to bring additional help to alcoholics under treatment there." (2000-2001 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. S65) The committee's attention is directed to having the A.A. message available to alcoholics in treatment facilities.

We reviewed the annual Treatment Facilities information letter to treatment facilities professionals. In September, this letter was sent to over 18,000 doctors, therapists and counselors in the U.S. and Canada.

The committee reiterated its support for local Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts to introduce those being released from treatment facilities to an A.A. member to help them attend A.A. meetings as soon as possible. The committee also suggested that information about Bridging the Gap work be shared with Correctional Facilities committees. Local Treatment Facilities committees are now carrying meetings into other noncorrectional institutional environments, e.g., shelters, nursing homes, hospices and half-way houses, and not limiting their scope to "treatment facilities." The trustees' committee, working in conjunction with the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee, continues to provide support for this special Twelfth Step Service.

Tony Taschner, chairperson

Staff report:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — The C.P.C. assignment is responsible for providing information about A.A. and establishing good communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work. These professionals include the clergy, physicians, nurses, attorneys, correctional facilities personnel, social workers, counselors, educators and those working in the field of alcoholism. The staff member on this assignment maintains communication with C.P.C. committee chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons are sent a welcome letter and receive the C.P.C. Kit containing the C.P.C. Workbook, A.A. Guidelines, Conference and Trustees' Committee History and Actions, A.A. pamphlets, a Catalog of Conference Approved Literature, Box 4-5-9 and a current issue of *About A.A.* Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience and providing C.P.C. material. Currently, there are over 400 area, district and central office/intergroup C.P.C. committees. We receive committee meeting minutes from committees and encourage all to share their experience for possible inclusion in Box 4-5-9.

In 2000, the C.P.C. staff member responded to over 2,000 inquiries from professionals; 1,569 of these were requests for information which followed visits to our A.A. Web site. Today, many professionals can share that not only does A.A. respond in a friendly manner and provide literature, but many have been put in touch with C.P.C. committee members in their communities who are available to serve as A.A. resources.

Thirty-four exhibits were coordinated for national professional meetings for 2000 and staffed by local C.P.C. committees. Fifty-seven invitations were referred to area C.P.C. committees for local professional events. In addition, G.S.O. furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees. Exhibits continued to be an effective tool in carrying the message to professionals and often result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as requests to receive issues of our publication *About A.A.* Currently more than 21,000 professionals are receiving *About A.A.*

Meetings with students from Cornell University Medical Center, coordinated by the staff member on C.P.C., continue to be set up throughout the year at G.S.O. The aim here is to make these future physicians aware that A.A. can be a valuable resource when working with the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, shown the video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous," and given a brief introduction to the A.A. program and a tour of G.S.O.

Warren Stafford

Treatment Facilities — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to provide information and service material to assist the work of A.A. committees who carry the A.A. message to alcoholics in treatment. We now are in contact with 91 area Treatment Facilities chairpersons, 251 district chairpersons, and 25 "Other" local chairpersons. We also share information with over 130 Bridging the Gap and Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) committees. We maintain an up-to-date list of these committee chairs and provide them with information and literature. Carrying the message to treatment facilities staff and clients remains a vital A.A. service. Our most recent Membership Survey indicates that over 30 percent of our membership came to us through a treatment facility. In order to carry the message into treatment facilities, committee members often meet with personnel in many different types of institutional settings, becoming familiar with the rules and regulations of the facility and complying with them. As an oldtimer once said, "If we can't get in, we can't carry the message!"

Area Treatment Facilities chairs are sent the Treatment Facilities Kit, a helpful guide to carrying the message into treatment facilities. All Treatment Facilities chairpersons receive subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *About A.A.*, as well as a listing of intergroups, central offices and answering services in the U.S. and Canada for referral purposes. They are also sent a list of other area Treatment Facilities chairs in order to share current experience. At committee meetings and workshops members involved in treatment facilities work share how A.A. committees can continue to be effective. Some topics discussed are: getting and keeping volunteer A.A. members involved; Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts; and cooperating with facilities as length of in-patient stays decrease, so that we can still be effective in reaching clients and helping them to find sobriety in A.A. Through minutes and reports sent to G.S.O., the valuable insight gained from these gatherings is added to our collected A.A. experience, and often serves as the basis for articles in *Box 4-5-9*.

Correspondence from local A.A.s who are active in treatment facilities work are answered by sharing experience and literature. Inquiries are also received from newly sober alcoholics in treatment facilities and from treatment facilities personnel requesting information and assistance in setting up A.A. meetings. Each of these receives a response from the office, and area or local chairpersons are notified of the request.

The staff member handled 442 responses to the annual Treatment Facilities mailing. Each respondent is sent additional literature. Any requests for a personal contact are forwarded to the appropriate area treatment facilities committee chairperson for follow-up. The staff member on this assignment also serves as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities.

Rick Walker

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to those alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Since the 2000 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities has met three times. At the recommendation of the 2000 Conference:

- The revision of the pamphlet to replace "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" was forwarded to Publications for distribution.
- A list of literature for young people was added to the Literature Guide section of the Correctional Facilities Workbook.
- The Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook have been designated service material rather than "A.A. conference-approved literature."

The committee decided to focus on the importance of carrying the A.A. message into Youth Detention Centers and short-term facilities and requested that the secretary:

- Provide information to the Fellowship on carrying the message to young people through *Box 4-5-9* and mailings to Correctional Facilities, hospitals and institutions and Bridging the Gap Committee chairpeople.
- Develop a list of Youth Detention Centers and short-term facilities in the U.S. and Canada that may be useful in future communications with administrators of these facilities.
- Continue gathering shared experience, specifically from A.A. members that have been institutionalized and achieved sobriety at a young age.

It was also suggested that area, district or intergroup institutional committees, which have created literature packages or pamphlets for youth confined in a variety of correctional settings, contact the correctional facilities desk at G.S.O. so that this information may be shared with other A.A.s that are doing this kind of Twelfth Step work.

We reviewed the draft of a service piece to accompany the video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" with appreciation and agreed to forward the copy to the 2001 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for their review. This service piece was created to attract and encourage A.A. volunteers, as well as provide shared experience on carrying the A.A. message into a variety of correctional settings.

The committee discussed a report on the Bridging the Gap Workshop Weekend and held a sharing session on Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts. The committee noted that:

- Communication is essential between correctional facilities committees (i.e. district, intergroup, hospital and institutions and Bridging the Gap) in an area, as well as with other areas. The staff secretary annually provides contact lists of area Correctional Facilities Committee chairpersons to facilitate the exchange of information.
- Attendance at correctional facilities workshops, conferences and conventions provides opportunities to gather shared experience. The committee suggested that the staff secretary attend a future Bridging the Gap Workshop Weekend to obtain additional shared experience on Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact Efforts.
- Each area is autonomous and there is no "one size fits all" formula for Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact Programs. It was suggested that each area should determine the best way to carry A.A.'s message to alcoholics, wherever they may be.
- The Correctional Facilities Workbook and *Box 4-5-9* are excellent resources for shared experience on Prerelease/Temporary Contact Programs.

On the subway going downtown, after the Tuesday visit to G.S.O., three delegates were chatting about the tour. A man sitting nearby asked, "Does this have something to do with A.A.?" Whereas he showed them the book he was reading, *Living Sober*, and the copy of *As Bill Sees It* he had in his bag, Harold Peterson (Alaska), Helaine Bertrand (NE Ontario) and Bernie Rienks (W. Michigan) all shook his hand and gave him some pins and pens. They don't know about him — but it sure made their day.

Following a discussion on whether G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site should continue to be an agenda item at all trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee meetings, the committee agreed to encourage suggestions and ideas regarding corrections and the Web site. Such ideas and suggestions would then be forwarded to the A.A.W.S. Services Committee.

The committee discussed a delegate's visit to a correctional facility to report on the 50th General Service Conference. An article about this event was in the February/March 2001 issue of *Box* 4-5-9.

Linda Chezem, chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment is responsible for carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Over 500 letters a month arrive from inmates, most asking for free literature, many asking for names of outside A.A. members with whom to correspond, or for help in making contact with A.A. upon release. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Correctional Facilities committees. The staff member sends a biannual informational letter to wardens and correctional professionals throughout the United States and Canada enclosing a return postcard for those professionals requesting additional information or contact with a local A.A. Correctional Facilities committee. The newsletter, *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, containing sharing from inmate letters sent to G.S.O., is also a responsibility of this assignment.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS), coordinated by this desk, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from experienced A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. We have available a service piece about our CCS (F-26) which we include in new group packages; it may also be ordered for group literature stands. There is an ongoing need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service. Yet, whenever a G.S.O. staff member attending an assembly, convention, conference or other Fellowship function has mentioned the tremendous need for CCS volunteers and provided ample supplies of F-26 service pieces, there has been a substantial increase in the number of A.A.s wishing to correspond with those on the inside. Additionally, a letter explaining the Corrections Correspondence Service is sent twice a year to delegates and Correctional Facilities chairpersons asking for A.A. volunteers to write to inmates on an individual basis. The rewards can be great, as demonstrated by an outside correspondent: "I know how important our Twelfth Step work is and I enjoy writing to men who are locked up. It is one of the tools that I use to keep me sober. I myself found A.A. in prison almost 20 years ago, and it hasn't been necessary for me to return to prison since I was released in 1979."

One of the more persistent questions asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. The fear of not having the inmate identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and the amount of time institutions require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into correctional facilities, are commonly pointed out as impediments to Fellowship participation. "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls," a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in correctional service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

Adrienne Brown

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: At last year's Conference, we reviewed the proposed budget for 2000 and reported that the G.S.O. expected income from operations of \$148,000, approximately even with the \$174,000 budgeted for 1999. This followed substantial, but planned, losses in 1995, 1996 and 1997 that helped to lower the Reserve Fund balance. Today I can report, as I did last year, that actual results for 2000 were considerably better than the proposed budget. Having previously accomplished the mandate of lowering the Reserve Fund balance, we added approximately \$500,000 from 1999 results, and expect a substantial addition in 2001 based on the good results of 2000. The Reserve Fund balance at January 31, 2000 represented approximately 9.9 months of operating expenses. Today, after the transfer, the balance stands at just about 11.6 months.

General Service Office — As you know, our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. We should all be encouraged that contributions in 2000 were higher than both those received in 1999 and the amount we had hoped to receive for 2000. This represents the fourth year in a row that contributions have increased over the previous year and reflects a positive trend. Contributions of \$4,511,200 were \$269,000, or 6.3%, higher than 1999 and \$179,000, or slightly more than 4.0%, higher than our budget as well. The \$4,511,200 in contributions were received from 24,842 groups. That, for comparison, represents 44.1% of the 56,389 groups registered with G.S.O., and is just about even with the 44.2% that contributed in 1999. While contributions were up, the percent of groups contributing reached the lowest point of the past ten years, (perhaps we have reached a bottom here!). Personally speaking, it appears significant to me that over the past several years a lesser percent of registered groups continue to contribute more to general services — supporting the work of the General Service Office — while, in effect, subsidizing those groups who do not contribute to the work done at G.S.O. Is there a message in these statistics?

Net sales of literature were \$9,461,400. This was \$472,100, or 5.2%, greater than budgeted, and \$316,000, or 3.5%, greater than the previous year. Fortunately, the number of actual books and booklets sold increased about 3%, or 40,700 units above the 1999 level, which was itself about 1% over 1998 levels. That means that book sales, as measured in units, finally stabilized after declining over the last ten years. In total, printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were somewhat ahead of budget, as were sales. Gross profit of \$5,220,200 was \$228,600 more than budgeted and \$88,000 more than realized in 1999.

The combination of contributions and gross profit from literature resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$9,772,500, some \$445,000, or 4.8%, greater than originally budgeted, and \$390,000, or 4%, greater than 1999.

Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2000 were \$8,789,000. This is \$389,000 less than budget, but \$273,000, or 3.2%, higher than the previous year. Therefore, compared to the budget, the increase in revenues was augmented by the reduced expenses, resulting in an operating profit of \$983,200 for the year, a substantial improvement from the budget and approximately \$117,000 greater than the previous year as well, thus enabling the transfer of \$1,500,000 to the Reserve Fund. However, these results are somewhat misleading, as several savings in operating expenses were either due to the deferral of expenses that will be incurred in 2001, and, most importantly, due to many office positions which were open during 2000. During 2001, these positions will be filled and the expenses will be incurred.

In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was approaching the upper limit established by the General Service Conference. The Conference-approved limit is 12 months of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine operating expenses. We have accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund. At December 2000 it was just about 9.9 months—in my opinion, about where it should be in normal times. At \$8,504,400 (the adjusted balance used for the calculation), the Reserve Fund amounts to \$151 per listed A.A. group. To give perspective to this number, contributions per group averaged about \$80 for the 56,389 registered, while expenses to support services to those groups averaged \$109. Also to give perspective, and lest we get too euphoric with our leveling unit book sales this past year, since 1990, our unit sales of books have declined so that we are now selling almost one-third fewer books than we were selling in 1990.

While we cannot ignore the reality of the prior trend of continuing decline, in unit literature sales, the 1999 and 2000 results give us pause to consider a slower decline, or leveling off. Therefore, the 2001 G.S.O. budget assumes relatively flat unit sales of books and booklets. In keeping with our Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget includes a 2% increase in contributions. The budget envisions a larger than usual increase in operating expenses. As noted previously, your G.S.O. was running short of help for most of the year and now expects "full employment levels"; thus, a significant increase in "People" cost is anticipated.

We have provided additional funds for work on PSAs, audio, video and CD ROMs. In an attempt to furnish information to the groups on a more timely basis, and while we enjoy good financial fortune, we will send new group information to new G.S.R.s first class, rather than waiting for the slower, less costly "bulk mail" method. In addition, a \$90,000 (74%) increase has been budgeted to help carry the message in other languages under the "Other Literature Assistance" function.

Based on these primary assumptions—level literature unit sales; a 2.0% increase in contributions; a 9.0% increase in total operating expenses—the projection for 2001 is for a modest excess of revenue over expense of \$137,000. As I have mentioned in prior reports, following three consecutive years of planned losses (1995-1997), the Reserve Fund is at the point where it is prudent to anticipate slightly better than break-even years, and we are!

Just to expand a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship—in 2000 we spent \$6,143,300 on services to the Fellowship, approximately \$227,000, or 4.5%, more than the \$5,876,500 spent in 1999. This compares with \$5,867,700 spent in 1998 and \$5,944,000 in 1997. Contributions provided 73% of this and 27% came from the profit from literature sales. (This compares with 74% and 26% last year.) This year, no funds were needed from the Reserve Fund for G.S.O. services.

Services spending amounted to \$109 per listed A.A. group, up \$5.00 from last year, while contributions were about \$80 per group, up \$4.00. The 2000 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 36.6% (which includes the Group Services assignment; Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 13.1%; Loners, Internationalists and Overseas Services, 8.6%; Trustees' and Directors' activities, 7.9%; Regional Forums, 5.3%; Archives, 6.7%; C.P.C., 4.4%; Spanish Services, 4.5%; Public Information, 3.7%; Correctional Facilities, 3.6%; World Service Meeting activities, 1.4%; current year Convention Assignment expense, 2.5%; and Treatment Facilities, 1.7%.

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2001¹

	Groups	Members
United States	51,735	1,162,112
Canada	5,104	98,816
Sub-Total	56,839	1,260,928
Correctional facilities ²	2,504	65,672
Internationalists		106
Lone members		313
Total	59,343	1,327,019
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	41,423	832,994
Grand Total	100,766	2,160,013

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in approximately 150 countries, including 46 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use the previous year's figures.

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately even with last year, as was circulation. Average circulation during 2000 was 115,700, compared with 115,900 for 1999, 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine was \$1,107,400, which was \$43,500 more than last year and \$45,000 more than budget as well. Revenue of Other Items was \$32,000, less than budgeted, but \$5,300 more than last year. Gross profit on Other Items, however, was approximately \$13,000 higher than 1999. While several of the titles the Grapevine publishes were less than last year due to an aging product line, sales of \$55,300 were attributed to a new product *A.A. Around the World*. Therefore, total income, including interest income, was \$1,392,400, approximately \$56,000 greater than last year and \$35,000 more than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,503,800. This is \$55,000 more than last year, but \$12,000 less than budget. As a result, the Grapevine (excluding La Viña) reported a loss of \$16,100, some \$51,000 less than budgeted, and \$6,000 less than 1999.

The Grapevine's 2001 budget, excluding La Viña, calls for a \$4,000 increase in magazine subscription income to \$1,768,100, compared with 2000, with a decrease in magazine gross profit of \$22,000, resulting in a gross profit of \$1,085,400. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to decrease \$13,500, while interest income should remain approximately the same. Excluding one-time expenses associated with reorganization and outsourcing, costs and expenses are projected to decrease by \$53,000 and a break-even is anticipated from operations. One-time expenses associated with the outsourcing and reorganization of \$338,000 result in a budgeted loss of \$338,056 for 2001. Last year I noted that while both management and the Grapevine

Board have worked diligently to get the Grapevine back to a self-supporting position, this 2000 budget reflected the continuing negative trend. With approval of the General Service Board, the trustees' Finance Committee had encouraged the Grapevine Board to pursue the outsourcing and reorganization, which is now underway. As a result of these efforts, I believe the Grapevine will return to modest profitability in subsequent years.

The break-even for 2001 compares with a 2000 budgeted loss of \$67,000 and a 2000 actual loss of \$16,100. The break-even puts a halt to six consecutive years of operating losses for the Grapevine.

La Viña — As we all know, *La Viña* is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2000 average circulation of close to 8,500 (up slightly from 8,000 in 1999, but about even with 8,400 in 1997). Personally speaking, *La Viña* appears to be a first-rate product. Hopefully, it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see continued growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past five and one-half years. During 2000, subscription income was \$62,250 and direct costs of publishing were \$49,700, resulting in a \$12,500 gross profit. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$62,100. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to *La Viña*. Therefore, the overall loss on the project for the year was \$49,600.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. For 2001, the loss on the *La Viña* project is budgeted to increase to \$63,100 and circulation is projected to remain around 8,500 copies. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee will continue to monitor progress against the original business plan and inform the Conference. Since the inception of the project, \$445,000 has been invested in *La Viña*, and the General Service Board has recommended that *La Viña* continue to be published at the General Service Board's expense.

In summary, the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition, the outlook for this year appears to be favorable, and we continue to have the financial wherewithal to carry the message.

Arthur L. Knight, Sr., chairperson

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 50th General Service Conference, the board held three General Sharing Sessions. The topic for the July 2000 session was "Our Friends: The Early Years, Now—The Future?" The October topic was "How Do We React to Criticism, and How Do We Treat Our Critics?" In January 2001, the session focused on "Archives: Preserving Our History, Carrying the Message."

July 2000 — Eva Sanchez, staff member on the International assignment, suggested that A.A. history reveals the impact of nonalcoholic friends on our Fellowship from the early years to now. She referred to Bill W.'s tribute to Class A trustees in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, "Theirs has been the wisdom that has caused our affairs to make financial sense, and frequently, in times of heated debate, they have headed off the rash decisions that we volatile alcoholics would surely have made."

Eva spoke about our friends in the community today, who may have an opportunity to guide our great-grandchildren to A.A.'s life-saving solution, or to remind us of our original vision of self-support and singleness of purpose. Eva asked whether we are as attractive to the nonalcoholic community as before? Are we

attracting new friends or have we become so self-sufficient that we do not need help? Do A.A. groups today welcome medical students and other interested people to open A.A. meetings? As individual members, do we build relationships with people in all professions and with the general public?

Class A trustee Bob Miller focused on the reasons that A.A. chooses to ask nonalcoholics to serve as trustees, noting that "A.A.s in general tend to explain a great deal of who and what they are, feel, do and think as being 'just like an alcoholic.' The Class A trustee who sees what goes on in the outside world . . . can help A.A. members to understand that what is usually at issue is not being alcoholic, but, rather, being human. Giving up alcoholism as an explanation can free A.A. members to think more realistically about themselves, and about A.A. matters." Bob suggested that how Class A trustees "do our work in the outside world, how we bring our experiences and understandings of A.A. and our relationships with A.A. members to bear on the professional problems we face, can clearly show what and how A.A. can contribute to our fields of endeavor."

General sharing included a reminder that it was a non-A.A. who originated the idea that became Regional Forums. Another suggested that Class As are our best ambassadors, and reminded us of the value of contacting students in professional schools. Someone mentioned that non-A.A. professionals can "Twelfth Step" their colleagues, thus giving them an appreciation of A.A.'s availability and usefulness. One member suggested that our experiences with nonalcoholics assuaged our tendency to feel unique and to be self-absorbed as a Fellowship.

October 2000 — Delegates to the 16th World Service Meeting (WSM) attended the board weekend, and participated in an energetic discussion based on the thoughts of three presenters: Linda Chezem, Class A trustee; Arnold Ross, Grapevine director; and Susan Ulseth, staff member on the Conference assignment.

Susan pointed to Bill W.'s suggestion that "In the years ahead we shall, of course, make mistakes. Experience has taught us that we need have no fear of doing this, providing that we always remain willing to confess our faults and to correct them promptly. Our growth as individuals has depended upon this healthy process of trial and error. So will our growth as a fellowship." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 231)

During Susan's years as a G.S.O. staff member, she's been aware of outside criticism of A.A., as well as occasional negative comments from within the Fellowship. Recent television programs in the U.S. prompted some members to express concern to the producers. Others contacted G.S.O., where Public Information staff member Bill Archer reminded them that Tradition Ten suggests that "Alcoholics Anonymous has no opinion on outside issues; hence the A.A. name ought never be drawn into public controversy." We welcomed the opportunity to share A.A.'s policy of reacting to criticism with dignified silence.

Arnold Ross opened his remarks by saying that ". . .when it comes to criticism, we think it's more blessed to give than receive—especially if the criticism comes from a difficult person or a group of difficult people." Arnold suggested that honest answers to four questions will help us to deal with criticism constructively: 1) Is the criticism valid?; 2) Am I doing my best with the life God has given me?; 3) Am I willing to carry the cross of criticism for Alcoholics Anonymous' sake?; and 4) Am I guilty of criticizing others? Arnold said that "There is that occasional constructive criticism that can help our brother. We are to tell the truth in love, but it needs to be cushioned with love or we will destroy others with the very criticism that hurts us so much."

Linda Chezem began by sharing gratitude to the Fellowship of A.A. She said that "It is funny how when I try to determine where my fault or failure lies before doing anything else, my under-

standing of the situation changes. If I try to figure out what I can do to correct myself, the whole situation becomes easier. "Disagreements and critics seem to be a part of the universal human condition. For A.A. to have people who criticize or who hold different views . . . is indicative of the fact that we are a part of humanity. How we treat our critics . . . is critical to the ability of the Fellowship to hold the hand of recovery out to the alcoholic. Petty bickering or large infighting will hurt or prevent the recovery of those who engage in the pettiness, as well as discourage a newcomer."

Linda said that she had recently spent an evening with judges from another country and shared that the work being done by A.A. to carry the message of recovery may well be critical to whether their country can survive. "I cannot carry the message," she told the group, "I can only support and encourage you. Please do not let the importance of your work be sidetracked by those critics who would steal A.A.'s attention and energy for their own personal gratification. Respectfulness toward a critic, yes; refusal to let go of something we disagree with, no. We cannot afford to chew the same cabbage forever."

One WSM delegate shared his reactions to a past delegate in his country, a gentleman who had encouraged changes in how service committees carried the A.A. message. During the sharing today, it occurred to the delegate that he may have reacted to the new ideas instead of looking for the value the ideas might offer. Another WSM delegate closed the session by expressing her pride in the worldwide Fellowship. She has found that taking inventory following criticism helps her regain balance.

January 2001 — We were treated to three thought-provoking presentations by Ric Downey, Western Canada regional trustee; Judit Santon, G.S.O. archivist; and John Sigerson, Panel 50 delegate for the Nebraska Area and chair of the Conference Archives Committee.

Ric said he believed that the genuine history of Alcoholics Anonymous is "authentic events of the past important enough to be recorded." So how do we preserve our history? Restoring a first printing of the Big Book or preserving a photograph is not quite the same as preserving history. Carrying the message of our "...spiritual awakening as the result of these steps" is a vital part of our recovery. Equally important is carrying the message of the other two legacies, Unity and Service. Ric believes that making our Fellowship aware of our history shares the same importance. We must carry the message of our history not only to newcomers but to every A.A. member, so we may avoid making the same mistakes the early members made.

Judit Santon encouraged us to think about why it is important to organize an archival collection. During the fall of 2000, we celebrated the 25th Anniversary of G.S.O.'s collection. Over the years, significant growth has occurred, and today nearly 100% of the areas are active in archival service. We need to maintain our records so that, as Bill W. said, "myth does not predominate over the facts." Judit has come to realize that archives offer great spiritual support in addition to practical assistance. Heated discussions can calm down surprisingly fast when we find that the same problem was dealt with successfully in the past.

John Sigerson reminded us that "Those that don't know their history are doomed to relive it." He said, "Not only do I not want to relive my own personal history, I don't want A.A. to have to relive the trials and bumpy starts we went through in the early days. Just as I talk about my history with newcomers and at meetings, we need the story of A.A.'s trials to be shared in order to keep the history fresh. Without this history it is easy for well-intentioned people to make mistakes." John said that "... history books are nice, but newcomers need living history books—people like you and me."

John went on to share that "Our Big Book is an archive of how the first 100 members got and stayed sober. The Twelve Traditions are basically an archive of the files Bill kept on group conflicts. Our *Service Manual*, the Twelve Concepts, *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, 'Pass it On,' *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*—all of these are archives. We need archives to help us remember."

John also shared a definition for archives from the American Heritage Dictionary: "A repository for stored memories or information." He reminded us that archives is just "us"—"us" then, and "us" now.

During discussion, a director shared her involvement in recording the stories of oldtimers. She talked about the importance of taping conversations with these A.A. members, since they don't write them down. She also reminded us that today is the day to contribute our own memorabilia to archives collections.

A delegate reminded us that today will become the past we need to preserve. She shared that she got to know a member of early Spanish-speaking A.A. groups and hear his stories of that experience. He passed away before she recorded his memories directly.

A director reminded us that learning our history can provide a broad perspective and encourage unity, rather than just ammunition for our own positions.

A past trustee closed the session by sharing wonderful anecdotes he recently discovered in our archives, and reminded us that A.A.'s history has been inspired and guided by Divine Providence.

Jack Ostrem, chairperson

INTERNATIONAL/WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature into other languages and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal service meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

World Service Meeting — The 16th World Service Meeting was held October 22-26 in New York City, with the theme "A.A.—Our Future is Our Responsibility." The biennial meeting for delegates from countries with organized service structures brought together 39 delegates representing approximately 29 countries. Alex Palmer, trustee-at-large/Canada, served as a first-term delegate, and Dean Rinehart, trustee-at-large/U.S., as second-term delegate. Dean served as chairperson of the Literature/Publishing Committee and Alex served on the Policy/Admissions/Finance Committee, which he will serve at the next WSM as chairperson. Gary Glynn presided over the meeting as chairperson along with Greg Muth as vice-chairperson. Eva Sanchez was the World Service Meeting coordinator. Other staff members who served as secretaries to WSM committees were Adrienne Brown, Doug Richardson and Susan Ulseth. John Kirwin was in charge of the workroom and hotel facilities, and additional support from the office included Ivy Rivera and Ellie Biscuti. Both Dean Rinehart and Alex Palmer provided individual reports on the meeting, which may be shared upon request. Also, the *Final Report* of the 16th World Service Meeting is available upon request.

Literature Assistance — The 2001 Literature Assistance budget of \$212,500 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International

Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. If no structure exists, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by Publications and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board. The 2001 Budget includes fees for the translation of "A.A.'s Legacy of Service" and "The Twelve Concepts" for those countries that need them.

Since April 2000, the pamphlets "Young People in A.A.," "Do You Think You're Different?" and "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?" became available in Ukrainian, and "44 Questions," "Do You Think You're Different?" and "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" have been translated into Turkish. Other new translations: "A Newcomer Asks," "44 Questions" in Croatian, "Twelve Steps" and "Twelve Traditions" in Burmese and Shan, and the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous" in Chinese. In addition, the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in Mongolian and Slovakian, and the Slovenian *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, are now available.

Interim Zonal Meetings — Interim zonal meetings are held in the year the World Service Meeting does not meet and board and office are represented as delegates or observers and participants in these meetings. The U.S./Canada will be represented by our trustees-at-large at the Meeting of the Americas, of which U.S./Canada is a part, which will be held in Cartagena, Colombia. The European Service Meeting will be held in Germany, and the Asia/Oceania meeting will be held in Seoul, Korea.

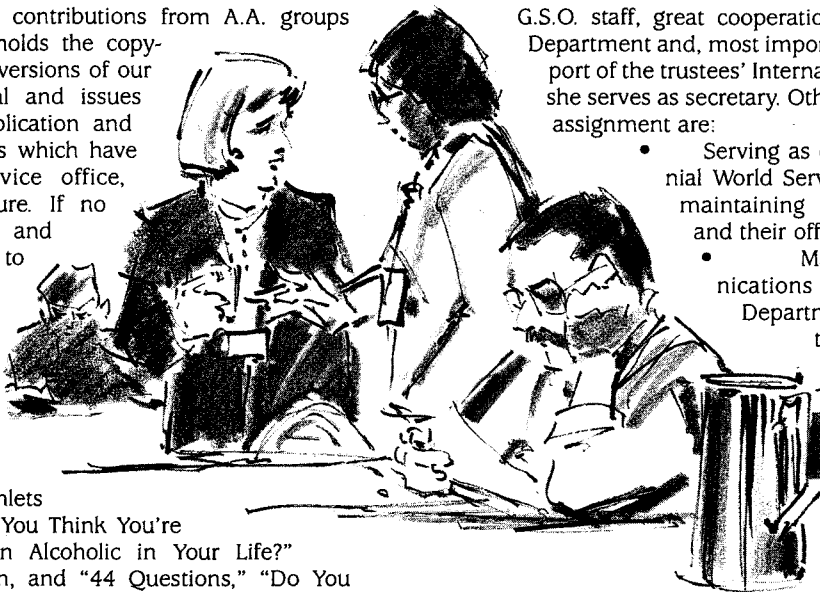
International Trips — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings office visits regional assemblies or events.

Trustees and staff members visited many countries, including Belarus, Brazil, Cuba, Czech Republic, France, Germany, Hungary, Panama and Romania. We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the International A.A. community and General Service boards and offices in other countries, who carry our message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Dean Rihenart, chairperson

Staff report: The International Desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 46 international general service offices and literature distribution centers. Correspondence arrives at the International Desk in many languages and, with the help of outside translators, it is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. Where there is a nearby office, we share the location, telephone number and e-mail or Web site address. The emphasis is on our faith that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits by the experience of



G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature (most touching are the unanticipated translations of the Big Book lovingly prepared by an A.A. member), and the beginnings of new General Service or Information offices that may be able to dis-

tribute literature to local members and groups.

- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of helping check each translation against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into about 40 languages, and additional translations are pending approval and/or funding. Responsibilities in regard to translations include close cooperation with the Spanish Services staff member who may first receive up-to-date details on A.A. literature in a country where Spanish is the primary language.

- Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. Our board sends one or two representatives to the Asia-Oceania Service Meeting, the European Service Meeting and the Meeting of the Americas (formerly the Ibero-American meeting).

Eva Sanchez

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A. A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention — We know that the 2000 International Convention, held in Minneapolis, Minnesota last summer, was a wonderful experience for the approximately 47,000 participants. Valerie O'Neill, the Convention coordinator, other G.S.O. personnel, the Convention consultant and an incredibly supportive Minneapolis Host Committee combined to provide a truly International celebration of sobriety.

The committee received a report from its subcommittee evaluating the 2000 Convention. The subcommittee's suggestions were accepted and will be incorporated into the planning for the 2005 International Convention in Toronto. The Minneapolis Convention manager reported to this committee, assessing the event from his perspective, and his recommendations will also be

incorporated in the planning strategy for 2005. For the first time, 900 questionnaires were randomly distributed before, during and after the Convention for attendees to evaluate the 2000 International Convention. Of the 185 attendees responding, 98% rated their experience at the Convention as excellent (73%) or good (25%).

Selection of the Convention management for 2005 is subject to a widely distributed solicitation for bids. Twenty-three organizations had either inquired or been contacted regarding bidding to be the 2005 International Convention consultant/management firm. Three companies submitted bids—all were competitively priced. G.S.O. management again selected Talley Management Group, Inc. to be the convention management firm for the 2005 International Convention. The General Service Board accepted a recommendation from this committee that Al-Anon/Alateen be invited to participate in the International Convention in Toronto Canada in 2005. This participation would be based on the very successful Minneapolis model.

In August 2000, invitations to submit bid proposals for the site of the 75th Anniversary International Convention (2010) were sent to delegates in the United States and Canada. Bid proposals were received from ten delegates for the following cities, Anaheim, Atlanta, Denver, Detroit, Honolulu, Indianapolis, Philadelphia, Phoenix, San Antonio and Vancouver. The Anaheim, Philadelphia and Vancouver convention bureaus subsequently declined to bid. The following seven cities met the basic requirements established for bidding on the Convention and were invited to give bid presentations at the joint meeting of the trustees' and Conference Committees' on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums: Atlanta, Denver, Detroit, Honolulu, Indianapolis, Phoenix and San Antonio. (Subsequently, the Denver Convention Bureau withdrew its bid.)

At the joint meeting, during Conference week, three potential sites will be recommended to the Conference from these possible site cities. The General Service Board will make a final selection of the site for the 2010 International Convention in late 2001, following site-inspection trips. Financial negotiations will be made as part of these site-inspection trips.

Regional Forums — Since the last Conference, the following regions have held Forums: Western Canada, Pacific, Eastern Canada and the Southeast. All were well attended by enthusiastic members interested in service. A Special Forum was held in January 2001 in Spokane and Yakima, Washington State. Many members were attending their first A.A. service event as well as their first Forum at this two-city Forum. The following Regional and Special Forums are scheduled prior to the 2002 General Service Conference:

2001		
June 8-10	Northeast	Rochester, NY
August 24-26	West Central	Sioux Falls, SD
September 28-30	Southwest	Albuquerque, NM
October 12-14	East Central	Toledo, OH
December 8-9	Special Hispanic	Austin, TX
2002		
March 23-24	Special "Inner City"	Chicago, IL

Alex D.J. Palmer, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Conventions — This assignment involves coordinating every aspect of the many processes and plans that go to make

up A.A. International Conventions, held every five years. The 2000 International Convention in Minneapolis was spectacular from the imaginative "Walk-the-Walk," to the over 250 meetings and workshops with nearly 750 speakers, to the engrossing Big Meetings where 86 flags, representing A.A. meetings and members worldwide, kicked off the Friday night festivities. The International Convention coordinator is responsible for making sure that the Convention comes together as an opportunity for A.A. sharing and gratitude. There was agreement that Minneapolis provided a wonderful opportunity for individual A.A. members to serve, celebrate and share sobriety.

Preliminary plans are underway for the International Convention in 2005, to be held in Toronto, Canada. Preparations and logistics are being studied to plan for three stadium meetings in the Skydome Stadium, celebratory dances and block parties, accommodating 250 workshops, panels, regional alkathons, topic meetings and marathons, which will require nearly 1000 speakers and moderators. Special attention will be paid to housing, registration and transportation. One major convenience in Toronto is having the enormous convention center directly across the plaza from the stadium. Toronto A.A. members are already excited about the unique opportunity they will have to extend the hand of A.A. to those who are able to attend the International Convention 2005.

It is hoped that the International Convention in Toronto for 2005 will provide the same mountaintop experience that A.A. members found in Minneapolis—a landmark A.A. event filled with sober gratitude and the language of the heart.

Doug Richardson

Service Material and A.A. Regional Forums — To assist groups, G.S.O. provides service material to the Fellowship, based on an indicated need, to provide information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. A four-page list describes the service items in detail. Examples of service material include: Regional Forum Reports; A.A. Guidelines; Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.; a catalog of A.A. Literature and Audiovisual Material for Special Needs. Current ongoing projects involving Service Material:

- Coordination of three A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and Canadian. The staff member on Service Material/Regional Forums works closely with the Special Projects manager regarding directories and central/intergroup offices' records and lists.
- Supervision of G.S.O. service files. There is a variety of service material available, upon request, to A.A. members, groups, and for service workshops.
- Supervision/production of service material such as A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, and G.S.R. Kits.
- Liaison with intergroup/central offices, including serving on the Policy and Site Committees of the 16th Intergroup Seminar, which will next take place in Edmonton, Alberta, Canada, September 6 - 9, 2001.

The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; there are four Forums annually. The work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The responsibility for direct contact with the hotel is assumed by a local A.A. host contact working with the Regional Forums coordinator and regional trustee. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates the details of the Forum. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing a comprehensive report of the Forum to all who attend. A new addition to the format of Regional Forums has been a Full Forum Workshop, which has proven to be an exciting and thought-provoking activity.

A region may request a Special Forum, which has fewer participants from the boards and staff over a shorter time period. Special Forums require the approval of the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums. They may be designed for remote, sparsely populated or urban areas. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the regional trustee and host contact, tailoring each agenda to local needs.

The staff member on Service Material/A.A. Regional Forums also serves as secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee, Conference Committee on Trustees and, currently, secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Doug Richardson

LITERATURE

Trustees' committee: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2000 General Service Conference.

Report on Projects For the Past Year:

Special Needs Service Piece — The committee returned this service piece to the A.A.W.S. Services Committee for final review prior to distribution as service material in pamphlet format as suggested by the 2000 Conference Literature Committee.

Proposed Fourth Edition Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous* — The subcommittee on the Fourth Edition Big Book met three times since the 2000 Conference for a total of 23 meetings since its inception in May 1997. Rotation occurred on the subcommittee last summer. The current subcommittee consists of three regional trustees, one general service trustee, two nontrustee directors, the Publications director and the Literature coordinator.

A previous subcommittee had reviewed 1,222 new stories submitted by June 1, 1998 by members of the Fellowship for possible inclusion in the Fourth Edition. As a result of an intensive review process over two years, 24 final stories were selected, each story meeting the two major criteria which the subcommittee has applied to its review of all submitted stories: a.) Each story must, as Bill Wilson recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution; b.) Each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells in a general way what the individual used to be like, what happened, and what the person is like now.

A letter has been sent to all A.A. members whose stories are no longer under consideration expressing deep gratitude for their efforts and for their participation in this process.

Since May 2000, the subcommittee has reviewed two major edits prepared by the Publications Department of the final 24 stories. The editors used the following criteria which were approved by the current subcommittee:

- The editors have tried to approach these stories through the eyes and ears of a newcomer, almost like listening to a qualification.

- As a result, the editors deleted a lot of reference to service positions and jobs; deleted slogans or sayings that are familiar to us, but may not be to the newcomer.
- Dates have been deleted in most cases; however, sometimes they are necessary and set the scene for the story. The same applies to cities, states, institutions, etc.
- Names have been deleted.
- Most reference to other substances were deleted—except when it fit into the story.

The second edit, which was completed in January 2001, includes changes suggested by the subcommittee and some additional adjustment and cuts suggested by the Publications Department.

The subcommittee had also conducted a systematic review of all Third Edition stories to determine which of those stories it will recommend for inclusion in the Fourth Edition. The current subcommittee has selected 16 Third Edition stories with minor edits to recommend for inclusion in the Fourth Edition. All stories, both Third Edition stories and new stories, were evaluated through the use of the same criteria. The goal of the proposed Fourth Edition is to reflect the broadest possible sharing to reach newcomers. The committee has forwarded a binder presentation of the draft manuscripts of the stories for the Fourth Edition Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, to the 2001 Conference Literature Committee for their consideration.

The committee agreed to forward a request from the Fourth Edition Big Book Subcommittee that the Publications Department be responsible for the order of the presentation of stories in the Fourth Edition Big Book following page 164 and "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" to the 2001 Conference Literature Committee.

The committee agreed to forward a request from the Fourth Edition Big Book Subcommittee to the General Service Office to contact all current and previous subcommittee, trustees' and Conference Literature Committee members after the 2001 General Service Conference to request that any material in their possession pertaining to the Fourth Edition Big Book be returned to the General Service Office. All draft manuscripts of stories for the Fourth Edition Big Book have been held in trust by all involved. This is a customary request to protect the confidentiality of all stories submitted by A.A. members.

Proposed Pamphlet for *Black/African American Alcoholics* — As a result of a request by the 1999 Conference Literature Committee and the 1999 General Service Conference Advisory Action, a subcommittee was formed to work in conjunction with the G.S.O. Publications Department to develop a pamphlet directed to Black/African American alcoholics. A call for stories was sent to all Conference members. By the end of the year, 34 stories had been received and were reviewed by members of the subcommittee. Those submitting stories were asked to write their story for the newcomer to A.A. to help a Black/African American alcoholic identify. They were asked to describe, as our Big Book says, what they used to be like, what happened, and what they are like now. It was suggested that they might include the following experiences: their preconceived notions about A.A., their first impression about A.A., what surprised them about A.A., what did not happen when they came to A.A.

The subcommittee was pleased with the quality and variety of stories received and, following review and discussion, selected 14 stories to pass on to Publications for editing. Since the last Conference, the subcommittee has met four times and offered extensive editorial input and requested text additions to the original 14 selected stories. The subcommittee also requested inclusion of two additional stories of A.A. members who attend meetings in a black community. The committee has gratefully for-

warded a report and a draft manuscript consisting of an introduction and nine final stories for consideration by the 2001 Conference Literature Committee.

Proposed Pamphlet to Replace "Time to Start Living" for Older Alcoholics — Following its review of the 1999 Conference Advisory Action, a subcommittee was formed to work in conjunction with the G.S.O. Publications Department to develop a new pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace the pamphlet "Time to Start Living." In October 1999, a call for stories was sent to all Conference members and to all past trustees and past staff members. By December 15, 1999 the subcommittee had received 33 stories reflecting a variety of experiences. Following a review of the stories, the subcommittee selected eleven stories, with four additional stories to be passed on to Publications on a provisional basis, to be used if needed to cover all relevant points. Since the last Conference, the subcommittee has met four times and has worked intensively with publications to select and edit eight final stories and to approve an introduction which includes references to these stories. The committee has gratefully forwarded a report and a draft manuscript for consideration by the 2001 Conference Literature Committee.

Proposed "Spiritual Variety" Pamphlet — This subcommittee has met five times since the last Conference and has prepared a report on this proposed pamphlet outlining the purpose for such a pamphlet, with suggested title options and format. The committee agreed to forward this report to the 2001 Conference Literature Committee for their review and consideration.

Revised Concepts Checklist — The committee agreed to make the following changes immediately to the current Concepts Checklist:

- To delete the question, "What are the Conference Bylaws?" (from Concept vii).
- The word "notion" be replaced by the word "principle." (from Concept vii).

Since the accuracy of at least one of the remaining questions was raised and since some terminology could be considered inappropriate or confusing, a subcommittee was appointed to consider revising the Concepts Checklist. The subcommittee has met twice by conference call since the last Conference, has unanimously agreed to proceed with revisions to the current Concepts Checklist and agreed with the original intent and purpose of the Concepts Checklist, which was to make the Concepts more accessible and more understandable. The purpose of a revised Checklist will be self-examination or self-inventory at the group, area, district or individual level. The proposed Checklist will ask whether our behavior and actions are in accordance with the Concepts just as the Traditions Checklist asks whether our behavior or actions are in accordance with the Traditions. In keeping with this purpose, it was agreed that any revisions would try to get away from any academic, exam, quiz or "right or wrong" type of questions. It was also agreed that Concepts discussion is important and the Concepts Checklist should encourage discussion.

Each member of the subcommittee has prepared suggested revisions to the Concepts Checklist. At the last conference call, it was agreed that the suggested revisions need extensive "face-to-face" discussion and this subcommittee will meet in person in March 2001.

The subcommittee remains committed and enthusiastic about improving the Concepts Checklist. It was noted that the current corrected Concepts Checklist continues to be available to A.A. members for use as a service piece and resource.

Projects Forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee for Discussion:

- Draft stories for the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

- Draft manuscript of proposed Black/African American pamphlet.
- Draft manuscript of pamphlet to replace "Time to Start Living."
- Request from trustees' Literature Committee to consider further development of the proposed "Spiritual Variety" pamphlet.

Jim Clough, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the literature coordinator works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the editor, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

This was a year of extensive subcommittee activity. The literature coordinator served as secretary to the subcommittee on the proposed Fourth Edition Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*. In addition, the literature coordinator served as secretary to five other hard-working subcommittees: proposed Black/African American pamphlet subcommittee; revised "Time To Start Living" pamphlet subcommittee; Concepts Checklist subcommittee; proposed "Spiritual Variety" pamphlet subcommittee; and the A.A.W.S. Board Publishing Committee.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about literature. Contact is maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 50 area literature chairpersons, 203 district literature chairpersons and 193 literature persons serving intergroups and individual A.A. groups.

The staff member handling literature also serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish with the following distribution: 66,000 copies in English, 5,200 copies in Spanish and 1,500 copies in French. *Box 4-5-9* (French) is translated and printed by Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes, Inc. in Montreal, in cooperation with this office. The staff member works closely with the editor of the Publications Department and a small editorial committee to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. as well as shared experiences from A.A. groups, committees and members worldwide. The editorial committee welcomes ideas and suggestions from the Fellowship.

Valerie O'Neill

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: As the name implies, "Loners" are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are 305 Loners in 89 countries, including the U.S. and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s, known as Internationalists, number about 108, with an additional 47 Port Contacts. Six Internationalist Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. "Homers" are A.A.s who are housebound due to illness or physical disability. We now have 195 Homers in the Loners/Internationalists Group. Loners, Homers, and Internationalists stay sober by reading A.A. literature and by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tapes and e-mail.

In addition, there are 545 Loner Sponsors. They are neither "Sponsors" nor "Loners" in the traditional sense; they are avail-

able to share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence.

A complimentary literature package is sent to each new LIM member. Each receives a *Loners, Internationalists, and Homers Directory* and a complimentary subscription to *Box 4-5-9* and the *Loners/Internationalists Meeting-by-Mail* (a bimonthly publication made up of excerpts of letters from LIM participants received at the General Service Office). These bimonthly publications are sent in alternate months to keep the lone member linked to the Fellowship.

Since January 2000, we have received sharing from every continent except Antarctica, and from over 60 countries. A single issue of LIM may offer sharing from places as various as Australia, Bahamas, Canada, Germany, Finland, Great Britain, India, Ireland, Israel, Papua New Guinea, Slovenia, Taiwan, the U.S. and Zambia. A.A. is truly a worldwide Fellowship.

This year, Loner Kelly R. from Brazil shared "The beauty of Alcoholics Anonymous is that I don't have to be alone any longer—none of us do—and wherever we go, we have the Fellowship. Writing to you all, thinking about the A.A. Fellowship and remembering that A.A. works because of people makes me very grateful to be sober and to be a member."

Homer Glenda L. of Australia shared that, "Although I am not in the best of health, and I am almost totally housebound, my life is full and has meaning... Today, I count my blessings instead of how many empty wine casks there are around... So thank you LIM for enabling me to reach out to other alcoholics via the postman."

Last year at the International A.A. Convention in Minneapolis, many LIM members had the opportunity to share in person for the first time with A.A. members they had previously met only through correspondence. A cross-section of LIM participants from around the world had the opportunity to speak at two meetings devoted to the Loners-Internationalists Service.

It is a privilege to work on the LIM assignment and to coordinate service for so many A.A. members who show, on a daily basis, courage and commitment to their recovery, and to Alcoholics Anonymous, under very challenging circumstances.

Rick Walker

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: The committee received the report of the Subcommittee on Nominating Procedures and made revisions to the procedures in the committee's "Composition, Scope and Procedure."

A search for a Class A trustee was made and two excellent "friends of A.A." were interviewed. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Allen L. Ault be invited to serve as a Class A trustee to replace Elaine McDowell, Ph.D. Allen's background is in the correctional field.

After lengthy discussion and careful review of background material related to the growth of the Conference, the committee recommended that Bill W.'s "Memorandum on New Delegates," as written in the 1961 *Final Conference Report*, page 34, continue to stand as the foundation for the Fellowship's philosophical guidepost regarding any future growth of the Conference.

In addition, based on recent experience over the last eight years with only two delegate areas coming into the Conference, and Bill's guidance in his 1961 "Memorandum on New Delegates" that "...this process of adding Delegates ought to be gradual," the committee agreed there was no need, at this time, to place a ceiling on the number of delegate areas in the Conference or to revise the regional boundaries.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board the following nominations:

A.A. World Services Corporate Board — R.J.M. (Ric) Downey, Western Canada regional trustee, replacing Jim Clough; and *A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board* — Ted Stoa, West Central regional trustee, replacing Marne Hill.

The General Service Board unanimously approved the trustees' Nominating Committee's recommendation that Elaine McDowell Johnson, Ph.D., serve as Chairperson of the General Service Board to replace Gary A. Glynn upon his rotation following the conclusion of the 2001 Conference.

The proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors were forwarded to the 2001 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any. The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 2001 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.
Allen L. Ault
Leonard M. Blumenthal
Linda L. Chezern

Arthur L. Knight, Jr.
Robert O. Miller, D.D.
George E. Vaillant, M.D.

Class B

Charles Bartell
Jim Clough
R.J.M. (Ric) Downey
David V. Every
Richard Gallagher
Marne Hill
Jacqueline Johnston
John C. Koster

Dorothy May
Alex D.J. Palmer
Beth Rabren
Ted Stoa
Tony Taschner
Gregory Tobin

Officers of General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.
<i>First Vice-Chairperson</i>	Linda L. Chezern
<i>Second Vice-Chairperson</i>	Robert O. Miller
<i>Treasurer</i>	Arthur L. Knight, Jr.
<i>Secretary</i>	Marne Hill
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Joanie Moncrief*

Directors of A.A. World Services Corporate Board:

R.J.M. (Ric) Downey	Greg Muth
Ronald J. Gauthier	Jan Polek
Jacqueline Johnston	Beth Rabren
John C. Koster	Jane Sheppard
Joanie Moncrief*	

Directors of A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board:

Susan Campbell	Arnold L. Ross
David V. Every	Ted Stoa
Raymond Massey	Tony Taschner
Robert O. Miller	Gregory Tobin

*To be replaced at G.S.O. staff rotation in September 2001.

Richard Roughton, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The responsibilities of the trustees' Public Information (P.I.) Committee include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; coordinating health fairs and other community exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the A.A. Membership Survey; carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media.

The committee met three times since the last Conference. Much of the work of this committee was done through a subcommittee and the Public Information staff coordinator in the office. Following is a list of some of our work over the past year:

- Following up on a request from the 2000 Public Information Conference Committee, the committee appointed a subcommittee to prepare a concise statement of policy on the posthumous anonymity of our co-founders, for discussion at the October meeting.
- The committee received the subcommittee's report and expressed appreciation for their efforts. The committee approved the policy and agreed to forward the proposal as a discussion item to the 2001 Conference P.I. Committee for wider sharing.
- The committee reviewed and approved the annual media Anonymity Letter mailed to media professionals (English, Spanish and French media outlets) in February 2001.
- At the suggestion of the 2000 Conference P.I. Committee, the committee approved a P.I. Audiovisual Materials sheet and agreed to its inclusion in the P.I. Kit.
- The committee examined the current status of our television Public Service Announcements and concluded that a new P.S.A. should be developed. The committee reviewed initial costs and concepts from three independent producers and selected one to be forwarded to the 2001 Conference Public Information Committee for their review and approval.
- The committee also examined the current distribution process and investigated the viability of doing a centralized distribution to top market locations and centralized tracking of P.S.A. broadcasts. It agreed to forward the subject to the 2001 Conference P.I. Committee as a discussion item.
- As a result of its examination of the current P.S.A. production and distribution processes, the committee began discussion on formulating a long-range development plan for future P.S.A.s to ensure that we are maximizing our efforts and resources.

Robert Miller, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic, potential alcoholic and the general public through the media, health fairs, schools and G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site on the Internet. A crucial part of Public Information work here at G.S.O. is to act as a resource and central repository of the sharing from Public Information Committees throughout the U.S. and Canada. Throughout the year, the staff member and a staff assistant respond to hundreds of written and telephone inquiries that come in from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff member is also responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what it can and cannot do. The assignment provides accurate and consistent information to the media, researchers, students and the general public about Alcoholics Anonymous.

The staff member regularly communicates with over 500 P.I. Committee chairpeople at the area, district and intergroup/central office level. All new Public Information chairpeople are

sent a "welcome" letter and receive the P.I. Workbook, A.A. Guidelines on Public Information, P.I. Discount Package Order Form, and Box 4-5-9, as well as current P.I. information from the staff member. The results of the A.A. Membership Survey are also made available in display board and pamphlet formats to local P.I. committees.

During the past year, literature has been provided for a large number of local health and community fairs. In many cases, local Public Information committees provide this literature and participate in these events. Whenever possible, we try to connect the community resource with local P.I. committees, so that there can be a local group conscience decision about how A.A. can best participate in these local events.

The Public Information staff person made available to local P.I. committees the service piece "Suggestions for Working with Your Local Television and Radio Stations to Help Carry the Message," to encourage and help committees set up P.S.A. contacts at local TV and radio stations. As a way of helping committees become familiar with the content of our P.S.A.s, a compilation copy of all the TV P.S.A.s was formatted onto VHS tape for use by those P.I. committees interested in distributing TV P.S.A.s.

The Public Information desk receives information regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio or film and, most recently, the Internet. If the local area is identified, this information is forwarded to area delegates. The delegate chooses whether to respond to each anonymity break on a case-by-case basis. In the past twelve months, approximately 47 articles were forwarded to area delegates. In January, all new Conference delegates were sent a letter explaining our procedures for forwarding anonymity break information to local delegates.

The annual Anonymity Letter to Media, including a Rolodex card with an explanation of Alcoholics Anonymous highlighting our Web site address and a return postcard for those who wish additional information about A.A., was mailed in February to more than 9,000 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included all daily newspapers and wire services, 4,755 weekly newspapers, 1,665 AM/FM radio stations, and 897 TV networks, stations and cable services. The distribution included 1,000 French and English outlets in Canada and 600 each of both the black and Hispanic media in the United States.

The 2000 International Convention in Minneapolis afforded the Fellowship a unique opportunity to communicate with media and the general public. The G.S.O. Public Information desk coordinated the Public Relations surrounding the Convention. We distributed Media Kits, including Press Releases on the Convention and the publication of the twenty-millionth copy of the Big Book, to approximately 1,600 media outlets across the U.S. and Canada, including the U.S. offices of major international publications. In addition, for the first time we placed these Press Releases on our Web site, where they served untold others.

This past year, the A&E Network produced an hour-long documentary entitled "Inside Alcoholics Anonymous" as part of their series "Investigative Reports." Our office cooperated by arranging interviews with the general manager and two staff members. We also furnished material, both video and print, to assist the producers in having accurate information about the history and current state of our Fellowship. We responded to numerous other requests from newspaper, magazine, TV and radio professionals for information about Alcoholics Anonymous or information on subjects related to alcoholism. We referred inquiries not directly related to A.A. to the appropriate source. We also reviewed movie, television and radio scripts to see that references to A.A. were accurate and in keeping with our Traditions. We declined to comment on controversial issues in keeping with our Tenth Tradition of not entering into public controversy. In this instance, Alcoholics

Anonymous is unique in that Public Information succeeds when we do not get media attention. Just as the strongest Twelfth Step with the alcoholic is often the quiet power of our own sobriety, in dealing with the media we try to present A.A. in a courteous and dignified manner. As our Eleventh Tradition reminds us: "Our public relations policy is based on attraction, rather than promotion . . ."

The success of any Public Information work at G.S.O. is measured in the same way as any other A.A. service: are we doing all that we can to see that the A.A. message is available to all, as we strive to see that information conveyed about A.A. is accurate and easy to understand?

Bill Archer

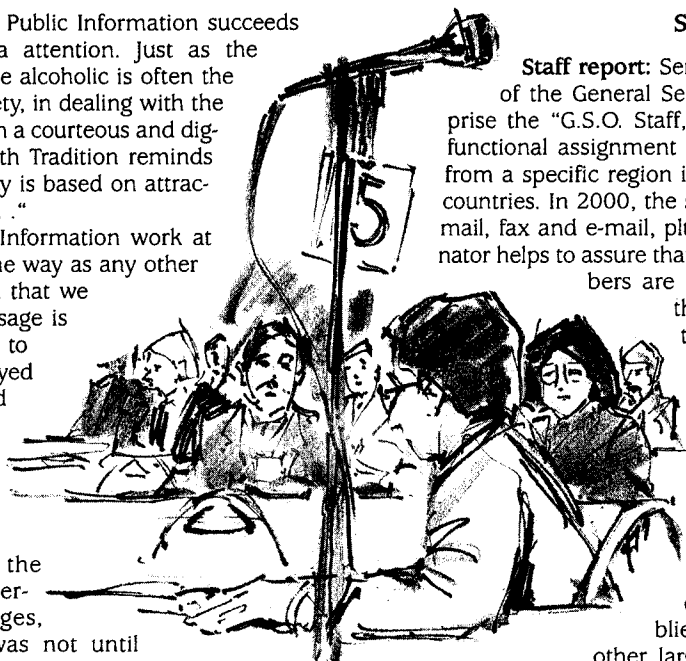
SPANISH SERVICES

Staff report: Throughout the years, G.S.O. has provided services in several languages, including Spanish. But it was not until 1984 that the assignment of Spanish Services was formally initiated. In our general service structure there are more than 40,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members. They meet in 1,500 groups in the U.S., Puerto Rico and Canada. The Spanish Services staff person, who does not rotate, coordinates and interfaces with the rest of the staff assignments and assists in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community that are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. All these groups that register with the G.S.O. in New York receive the Group Handbook, and every G.S.R., its corresponding kit in Spanish. D.C.M.s also receive their service kit in Spanish, and each group receives a copy of *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving. The groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added recently to the areas in our service structure, and continue to grow in other parts of our Conference. Many service pieces are now available in Spanish, among them the General Service Board's *Quarterly Report*, with highlights of its activities, as well as the A.A.W.S. monthly report. The Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish is immediately available upon completion of our Conference, and a list of preliminary and final Conference Agenda items is distributed in Spanish to all delegates and alternate delegates.

The staff member on this assignment works closely with the two in-house translators, assisting, developing, updating and revising literature, pamphlets, and so on. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our Publications Department. All correspondence in Spanish from the United States and Canada comes to the Spanish Services desk. The Spanish Services coordinator also helps answer correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments, especially by the International desk. The Spanish Services staff member may attend regional meetings, such as the Meeting of the Americas, World Service Meetings and Regional Forums, and many other activities in the Spanish-speaking world of A.A.

Danny Mooney



STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Ten A.A. members comprise the "G.S.O. Staff," with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 2000, the staff received 22,676 such requests by mail, fax and e-mail, plus many phone calls. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members

are involved in large projects, away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. Last year, staff participated in more than 90 conventions, assemblies, roundups and Regional Forums, where we provided information on services available through G.S.O. and gathered shared experiences to bring back to the office to be used to benefit other groups.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums and other large A.A. events, making sure that the

office is adequately covered at all times. To further ensure that the work flow is smooth and adequately covered, assignments are divided into two units. Unit A consists of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, International Convention, Literature, Public Information and Treatment Facilities. Unit B includes Conference, Regional Forums/Service Material, International, Spanish Services and staff coordinator.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experiences of A.A. groups gathered over many years, resources that are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Ideas received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, where we focus on problems best addressed by a group conscience. Our weekly meetings also provide a forum for sharing ideas on ways to further improve services to A.A. groups and members.

Danny Mooney is retiring July 1st after 10 years of devoted service. Danny will not be easy to replace, but we hope to have a bilingual staff member on board before the 51st General Service Conference. Criteria for applicants who want to be considered for an opening in the G.S.O. staff are: a minimum of six years sobriety, professional background, communication skills and A.A. service experience. The staff coordinator is involved with training new staff.

Each G.S.O. staff member serves as secretary to a Conference Committee and is a voting member of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

During 2000, we welcomed 1,075 visitors to G.S.O. from around the world. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Often, visiting members and guests attend the "open" A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance materials, preparing the minutes of board meetings and the *Quarterly Report*. The staff coordinator serves as a director of A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the assistance of very capable support staff.

Joanie Moncrief

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: The Grapevine Corporate Board met eight times following the 50th General Service Conference. The board held four formal meetings—three during General Service Board weekends—to discuss an extensive agenda of policy and financial matters. Four planning committee meetings, of a more informal nature, were held, allowing for more in-depth discussions of such matters as budget forecasts and the future of La Viña.

The GV Corporate Board also met twice with the Editorial Advisory Board, an advisory body made up of publishing, graphics and writing professionals (all A.A. members) who share their experience, insight, and perspective concerning editorial content, graphics and readership. The joint meetings allowed the two boards to exchange ideas about the future goals of the Grapevine in an informal, freewheeling environment.

Board Structure — This past year the board welcomed two new nontrustee directors, Susan Campbell and Arnold Ross, and two new trustee directors, Bob Miller, Class A (nonalcoholic), and Tony Taschner, Class B, Northeast Regional. These four new directors joined the board in May 2000.

On December 15, 2000, the board selected Arnold Ross as its nominee for the general service trustee position (to succeed Tom Maguire upon rotation). Raymond Massey and another candidate were elected to fill the nontrustee director openings to occur on the Grapevine Board following the 51st General Service Conference. On January 29, the General Service Board selected David Every as its nominee for general service trustee on the Grapevine Board; so, pending Conference disapproval, if any, David will begin service as a trustee and Ray Massey as a non-trustee director of the Grapevine Corporate Board following the 51st Conference.

Mission Statement — At the September 2000 Planning Committee Meeting, the board held a retreat to discuss issues affecting the functioning of the board and the needs of the publishing operation. Among other activities during the retreat, we drafted a Mission Statement and agreed to publish this statement as a part of our agenda for all subsequent board meetings.

The following Mission Statement was reviewed and approved unanimously at the October board meeting: "The purpose of the Grapevine Corporate Board, an affiliate service corporation of the General Service Board, is to serve the A.A. Fellowship in the following ways: • To oversee the publishing operations of the A.A.

Grapevine, Inc.; • To provide sound financial management of the corporation; • To establish corporate policies and set corporate priorities; • To engage in the ongoing process of

strategic planning; • To operate in accordance with the principles of A.A., as expressed in the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions, and the Twelve Concepts."

Circulation and Operations— In July 2000, the Grapevine Corporate Board authorized management to contract with Kable Fulfillment Service, an off-site fulfillment service located in Marion, Ohio, to process the magazine's fulfillment and shipping operations. Since that decision, much staff time and many of the activities of the office have been geared toward laying the groundwork for the change. Grapevine management met with the fulfillment service, discussed severance and other management issues with counsel, and discussed the impending changes with all employees. Jeff Monasch, the customer relations coordinator, and Bob Slotterback, controller, attended a three-day client workshop in Marion to facilitate the exchange of information and services.

The conversion from the AS400 system to Kable outsourcing has been overseen by the director of operations and circulation, Mary Pat Hester. Installation of the new computer hardware and modem lines with T-1 hookup was followed by training of the Grapevine's customer relations staff. In February, Kable provided an on-site three-day training session for staff. Once staff training is complete, the Grapevine will go "live" with subscription processing. La Viña subscription processing will proceed following the Grapevine's. After both subscription systems are fully operational at Kable, we will begin the process of relocating the processing and shipping of related items to Kable. (For Canadian customers, however, the current suppliers in Canada will continue to be used both for mailing subscriptions and shipping related items.)

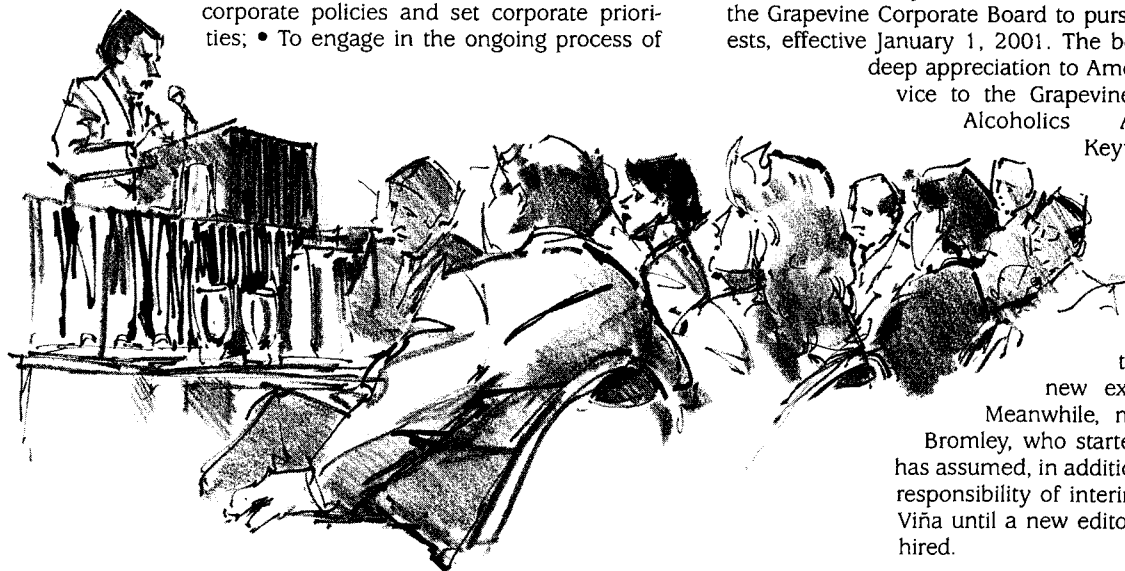
The Grapevine's customer service will continue to be provided by Grapevine staffers in New York. Much of the transition to this more cost-effective and technologically efficient method has involved the testing and upgrading of our computer systems. The change to this new system will be phased in over the course of many months.

Part of this transition is the replacement of telephone lines for online access with T-1 lines. The T-1 lines allow customer service personnel to have continuous Internet access (which means no dial-up) to Kable's K-net subscription system. T-1 lines are also much faster and less costly.

The Grapevine Office — This has been a time of important transition and change for the Grapevine. Ames Sweet, executive editor of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., reached a mutual agreement with the Grapevine Corporate Board to pursue outside creative interests, effective January 1, 2001. The board and staff expressed deep appreciation to Ames for his 15 years of service to the Grapevine and the Fellowship of

Alcoholics Anonymous. Cynthia Keyworth, who retired as senior editor in the summer of 2000, was asked to return as interim managing editor to oversee the production of the magazine and to manage the editorial department until a new executive editor is hired.

Meanwhile, new senior editor Robin Bromley, who started with us in June 2000, has assumed, in addition to her other duties, the responsibility of interim managing editor of La Viña until a new editor of Spanish resources is hired.



During the transition, Grapevine directors have been in the Grapevine office weekly to help the staff with both administrative and editorial matters.

Changes have been implemented, specifically with regard to the conversion to outsourcing; biweekly editorial meetings have been instituted; there is also a regular senior staff meeting, which has been a positive communication vehicle between the Grapevine Board and staff. The board has been kept up to date on the production schedule of all issues of the magazines.

In addition, as reflected in the body of this report, the entire staff has pulled together to keep the sales of magazines and related items on track, to keep customer service at a high level, and to serve the Fellowship of A.A. in the special way that has been a hallmark of the Grapevine since its inception in 1944. The board, and this Conference, owes a debt of gratitude to all the workers in the office for their commitment to the Grapevine and its mission during the past year, and as we face continued challenges and positive opportunities in the year ahead.

La Viña — Since the 50th General Service Conference, the Spanish-language magazine project of the General Service Board, La Viña, has achieved a bimonthly circulation level of about 8,500 copies, which is an increase of nearly 500 copies. At service events across the U.S. and Canada, including Regional Forums, A.A. members share their experiences with the magazine, especially how La Viña carries the message of recovery to alcoholics in correctional facilities in every delegate area with a Spanish-speaking population. The commitment of RLVs, group members, district and area officers, delegates and trustees, in addition to the editors and circulation professionals in the office, have kept the magazine alive and growing incrementally throughout the year—leading to this year's General Service Board and Conference discussions of the publication. The General Service Board and the Grapevine Corporate Board look forward to a year of healthy circulation and a revitalization of the editorial content of our "meeting in print" in the Spanish language.

2000 Financial Results — The Grapevine's loss on operations is \$16,100 for the year ended December 31, 2000. This loss is \$51,043 better than budget and \$5,791 less than the actual loss in 1999. The Grapevine's \$16,000 deficit is the closest to break-even we have been since 1995's actual \$3,000 loss.



The board approved and forwarded to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee budgets for the year 2001. The Grapevine budget projects a break-even result on operations, with one-time charges for restructuring and outsourcing for a total loss of approximately \$340,000 in 2001. The Grapevine Corporate Board's preliminary forecasts for both 2002 and 2003 reflect anticipated profitable bottom lines. Circulation is projected at 117,000 for the current year, 2,000 copies higher than the previous year. This budget reflects the full impact of implementation of the outsourcing of the magazine circulation and related item fulfillment functions beginning in the second quarter 2001.

The deficit for La Viña for the twelve-month period ending December 31, 2000 is \$49,570, which is \$16,644 under budget and \$9,654 lower than the 1999 actual loss. The budgeted deficit for La Viña in 2001 will be \$63,116.

Related Items: Anthologies — *AA Around the World*, was published in June 2000, and as of January 2001, had sold over 11,600 copies at \$5.00 each—almost double the amount projected by the 2000 budget.

To assist in making up a shortfall in sales for the *Best of the Grapevine* series, Mary Pat Hester and Ken Chaya designed a new flyer offering "Three Great Volumes at One Special Price"—fifty cents off the price of each volume. The flyer was tested in the February/March edition of *Box 4-5-9*, and distributed to area Grapevine chairs and intergroups.

In the fall of 2000, the board gave final approval for publication in 2001 of a book of letters selected from past issues of the Grapevine. This softcover anthology is now on a production track, with an expected publication in the fall of 2001. Members of the Editorial Advisory Board will help make the first round of selections for the book.

Grapevine Web Site — The Web site continues to function as an introduction to the magazine and its related material, to generate circulation and sales, and as a gateway to A.A. itself. The online i-Say Forum has covered a number of interesting and provocative areas of discussion, such as, tolerance, the "meeting after the meeting," carrying the message, the group conscience, complacency, and coping with criticism. The discussions have been lively, forthright, and wide-ranging. The Grapevine has continued to moderate the Forum and post new messages (twice a week) after they have been reviewed and edited by the editorial staff.

The newest version of the online catalog became operational in March, along with a redesigned index page prepared by Web site manager Maggie



Keogh. This new version has an updated look and has been designed to give better service to international customers. It also has more sophisticated features dealing with shipping and handling. During the redesign, Ken Chaya, the magazine's art director, provided positive feedback as well as some helpful suggestions. Online orders continue to grow: from January 2000 to December 2000, monthly orders for subscriptions and related items rose from 158 to 366, for a total of 3,510 in the year 2000.

Marne Hill, chairperson

Staff report: From the publication of *A.A. Around the World* and the revision of the online forum to the reorganization of our full-filment department and change of editorial staff, it has been a busy year at the A.A. Grapevine and one which has offered many opportunities for growth.

A.A. Around the World made its debut at the International Convention and has now sold almost twice as many copies as projected (budgeted sales were 6,000; actual 11,624). The magazine introduced two new departments—"The Home Group: The Hearbeat of A.A.," in response to the 199 readership survey, and "Rule 62," a two-page spread of cartoons. The magazine will complete its tour of A.A.'s eight service regions in the U.S. and Canada with articles from the Southeast in June 2001.

With the full approval of the Grapevine Board of Directors, special events coordinator and Web site manager Maggie Keoght launched a revised and fully moderated version of the bulletin board i-Say on June 1, 2000. A web version of Rule 62 invites visitors to write captions for various cartoons, and online readers can now renew subscriptions and order calendars and pocket planners from the Web site catalog. The results are promising: Maggie Keogh reports a 15% increase in Web site visitors this year and a 25% increase in orders of related items from the catalog. Between 120 and 130 subscriptions come in from the Web site each month.

The A.A. Grapevine had a lively presence at the International Convention this July in Minneapolis. Inspired by the enthusiasm of director of operations and circulation, Mary Pat Hester, loyal Grapevine Reps helped keep the Grapevine Information Area in the exhibition hall fully staffed day and night. The Grape Bunch also distributed 19,000 Grapevine gift bags plus our entire stock of La Viña and inserted subscription forms in 50,000 programs. The Grapevine also was represented at four different panels. GV directors and staff hosted two workshops on the magazine; Danny Mooney of Spanish Services, G.S.O., chaired a panel on La Viñas; and Maggie Keoth spoke at a session on A.A. in cyberspace. Throughout the year, the Grapevine staff participated in many other A.A. events around the country, including four Regional Forums.

Mary Pat Hester reports that the GvR network has remained active throughout the year, responding to our annual survey, contributing to our interactive newsletter the Grapenet, and assuming a major role in informing the public about the magazine. There has been a 3% increase in renewals, while circulation has remained stable.

This year has seen a number of changes in the editorial department. After more than seven years of service, Cynthia Keyworth retired from her post as senior editor after the International Convention, and A.A. member Robin Bromley joined the staff as senior editor at the end of June. In December 2000, executive editor Ames K. Sweet stepped down to pursue other creative opportunities after serving the Grapevine for fifteen years. Cynthia Keyworth returned as interim managing editor in January 2001, and Robin Bromley will serve as interim managing editor for La Viña while continuing as the Grapevine's senior editor.

Robin Bromley, senior editor

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE	
	APRIL 2001	APRIL 2000		
UNITED STATES*				
Alabama	1,022	1,071	—	49
Alaska	533	504		29
Arizona	1,748	1,780	—	32
Arkansas	644	667	—	23
California	12,249	12,067		182
Colorado	1,815	1,768		47
Connecticut	1,924	1,909		15
Delaware	435	446	—	11
District of Columbia	216	214		2
Florida	5,607	5,591		16
Georgia	2,727	2,593		134
Hawaii	558	542		16
Idaho	632	636	—	4
Illinois	4,346	4,406	—	60
Indiana	1,587	1,614	—	27
Iowa	1,345	1,308	—	37
Kansas	1,309	1,347	—	38
Kentucky	1,006	996		10
Louisiana	982	1,100	—	118
Maine	668	692	—	24
Maryland	1,603	1,550		53
Massachusetts	3,320	3,263		57
Michigan	3,671	3,596		75
Minnesota	2,950	2,648		302
Mississippi	636	702	—	66
Missouri	1,973	1,946		27
Montana	690	651		39
Nebraska	1,079	1,073		6
Nevada	806	814	—	8
New Hampshire	849	738		111
New Jersey	3,080	2,868		212
New Mexico	778	686		92
New York	6,512	6,615	—	103
North Carolina	2,525	2,468		57
North Dakota	412	385		27
Ohio	3,229	3,328	—	38
Oklahoma	1,150	1,155	—	5
Oregon	1,506	1,470		36
Pennsylvania	4,856	5,009	—	153
Rhode Island	447	426		21
South Carolina	1,201	1,170		31
South Dakota	424	436	—	12
Tennessee	1,443	1,431		12
Texas	4,526	4,914	—	388
Utah	631	659	—	28
Vermont	387	400	—	13
Virginia	2,360	2,275		85
Washington	3,326	3,184		142
West Virginia	413	441	—	28
Wisconsin	2,659	2,631		28
Wyoming	336	329		7
Puerto Rico	50	44		6
U.S. Possessions	18	18		0
Subtotal U.S.	101,260	100,574		686
CANADA				
Alberta/NWT	920	903		17
British Columbia/Ykn	1,047	1,044		3
Manitoba	390	366		24
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	319	321	—	2
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	373	497	—	24
Ontario	2,886	3,236	—	350
Quebec	219	221	—	2
Saskatchewan	423	433	—	10
Subtotal Canada	6,677	7,021	—	344
FOREIGN	1,747	1,755	—	8
Grand Total*	109,684	109,350		334

(*exclusive of monthly orders)

Literature Distributed - 2000

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	413,159
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	346,579
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	23,083
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	116,359
Daily Reflections	129,258
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	166,824
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	13,560
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	136,393
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	11,918
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	51,907
A.A. Comes of Age	11,182
As Bill Sees It	41,354
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	22,383
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	10,403
"Pass It On"	11,878
Total	1,506,240

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	37,978
Living Sober	142,338
Came to Believe	71,846
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	25,272
Total	277,434

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	8,534
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	24,710
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	34,044
A.A. for the Native North American	19,746
A.A. for the Woman	115,258
The A.A. Group	85,193
A.A. in Your Community	47,941
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	19,314
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	23,298
The A.A. Membership Survey	42,948
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	100,431
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	33,980
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	16,026
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	107,711
Circles of Love and Service	32,637
Bridging the Gap	21,776
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	19,884
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	17,623
Do You Think You're Different?	121,836
44 Questions	233,172
G.S.R.	42,111
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	7,851
How A.A. Members Cooperate	15,276
How It Works	57,843
If You Are a Professional	38,259
Inside A.A.	39,868
Is A.A. for You?	321,310
Is A.A. for Me?	98,968
Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	15,705
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	83,221
It Happened to Alice	47,289
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	50,693
The Jack Alexander Article	28,896
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	12,266

Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	81,659
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	54,915
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	31,578
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	10,372
A Newcomer Asks	270,021
Problems Other Than Alcohol	115,677
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	250,837
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	15,284
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	23,233
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	70,757
Twelve Tradition Flyer	8,838
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	47,557
This Is A.A.	255,010
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	19,500
Time to Start Living	58,352
Time to Start Living (large print)	7,570
Too Young?	85,682
Understanding Anonymity	57,355
What Happened to Joe	51,092
Young People and A.A.	119,605
Total	3,620,775

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	394,227
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	45,551
Wallet cards-Anonymity	31,382
Anonymity Display Card	2,385
Parchment-scrolls	2,987
Placards	486
C.P.C. Workbook	1,417
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,285
P.I. Workbook	1,600
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,763
Treatment Facility Kit	396
Big Book on computer disk	723
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk	539
A.A. Guidelines	77,648
Group Handbook	2,188
Wire Racks	2,000
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	1,548
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	4,742
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	331
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	2,328
TV Public Service Announcement	364
Radio Public Service Announcements	453
Twelve Steps Shade displays	2,096
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,933
Fact File	3,821
Table Top Display 12 & 12	576
Total	584,634
Grand Total	5,982,083

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	23,626
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	6,364
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	7,359
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	6,444
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	3,173

El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	2,516
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	4,307
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	8,148
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	13,189
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	5,406
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	21,403
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	7,733
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	6,047
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	6,271
Total	121,986

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	8,308
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	26,610
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	30,533
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	55,875
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	6,303
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	8,237
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	5,489
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	4,864
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	3,733
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	3,693
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	16,575
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	13,128
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	11,358
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	4,478
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	9,625
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	12,305
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	6,957
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	4,948
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	2,739
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	14,916
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	2,801
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	10,124
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	3,414
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	8,557
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	7,310
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	2,920
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	3,869
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	3,740
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	2,133
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	3,415

¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	9,414
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	5,340
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	47
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	8,118
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	2,307
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales (A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs)	2,886
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	12,442
Tiempo Para Empezar a Vivir (Time to Start Living)	3,981
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	7,532
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	4,767
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	2,608
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	3,184
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,373
Total	362,956

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	8,349
Parchments, Spanish	746
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	21,886
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	692
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	874
Total	32,547
GrandTotal	517,489

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	4,060
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format souple)	1,968
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	795
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,359
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format souple)	992
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format poche)	716
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	526
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	1,924
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	3,694
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	660
Total	16,694

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	2,712
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	3,409

Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,472
Total	7,593

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	10,227
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	1,825
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	12,388
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,046
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	513
Les A.A. et les programmes d'aide aux employes (A.A. & Employee Assistance Programs)	635
Le membre des A.A. face aux médicaments et la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	1,189
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	277
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	418
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	1,748
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	1,013
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	361
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	1,137
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	669
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	374
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	423
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	1,270
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,526
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	698
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,073
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	632
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	197
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	1,458
Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	387
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	594
Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	844
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	115
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	1,791
Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	761
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	1,254
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	845
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,186
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,604
Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	572
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,105
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,322

L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	241
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,621
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	1,004
Lettre a une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	851
Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	1,786
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,197
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,645
Il est encore temps de vivre (Time to Start Living)	960
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	4,046
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	932
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	586
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,878
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	326
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	178
Total	71,728
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	Total 2,996

Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	61
Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)	86
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	1,392
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	76
Cassettes	70
Notre Methode (How It Works)	12,565
Manuel de Groupe	35
Pochette de l'Information Publique	6
Pochette des Centres de Detention	4
Pochette de la CMP	1
Priere Serenite (Carte) (Serenity Prayer wallet card)	10,467
Pochette des Centres de Traitement	5
Dossier d'information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	525
Total	25,293
Grand Total	124,304



Area Service Highlights — Panel 51 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights.)

Alabama/NW Florida: Area 1 has 410 registered groups serving 23 districts; 17 districts are located in Alabama, six in NW Florida. Area assemblies meet quarterly in Montgomery, Alabama. Workshops are held using topics taken from the current Conference theme and workshops. Our assembly encourages participation by all, both new to the service structure and those who have been around awhile. We feel privileged to share and participate in the first Spanish-speaking forum, in Russellville, Alabama, December 15-17, 2001. Although we estimate eight Spanish-speaking groups exist, not all are registered with G.S.O. or our area. Progress has been made in removing the language barriers, which exist. And now the great news for all. Alabama/NW Florida will host the Southeast Regional Forum to be held December 6-8, 2002 in Huntsville, Alabama at the Huntsville Hilton. We look forward to demonstrating some true southern hospitality. — *Jon Shirley*

Arkansas: Area 4, composed of 12 districts representing 241 registered groups, utilizes a Structure and Guidelines manual for its varied functions. Two-day weekend assemblies are held quarterly at a central location. Active past delegates and trustees conduct a Tradition and Concept workshop, chair and/or sit on Archives, Convention and Group Relations committees, and share at an evening speaker meeting. Seven of the nine permanent committees utilize district representation and workshops to carry the message and stimulate interest in service work. Of note, the Convention committee will, this year, conduct the 61st Old Grandad, the oldest state convention west of the Mississippi River. C.F. members continue to coordinate meetings "behind the walls" and with on-going cooperation with state government, host "men in white" (prison group representatives) at the Saturday portion of the assembly. C.P.C., and T.F. continue their community outreach efforts. The Grapevine chair uses an extensive display to encourage interest. The area has begun testing the feasibility of a Literature committee and is holding preliminary discussions for a possible area newsletter. — *Richard Levesque*

British Columbia/Yukon: Area 79 serves 47 districts with 750 groups; six districts are in remote communities. We are presently striving to increase participation with these districts in our area functions. At quarterlies and assemblies we have DCMs and GSRs who travel up to 16 hours in order to attend. There are some districts, like the Yukon, where it is necessary to fly. We hope to hold a Special Forum in a Northern District in the future. Our area operates on the committee system and we have chairpersons for each committee doing a terrific job assisting the districts to carry the message in their communities.

Our BC/Yukon Area Convention will be held in Oliver, BC, May 4-6, 2001; this convention continues to be a yearly highlight. It is an honor and a privilege to serve Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Bob Allen*

California (Central): Area 93 has approximately 26,600 members in 870 groups, with 21 English-Spanish language districts. There are 11 central offices; 4 serve our Spanish-speaking communities. The area assembly meets 4 times a year on a rotating location; our area committee meets 5 times a year at a central location. Our districts get together on a countywide basis once a year for a "local" delegate Conference report. All our events are interpreted for our non-English-speaking members. We have a unique opportunity as a brand new area and are doing our best to take full advantage of it. Our area began organizational discussions well before the 50th General Service Conference granted Area 05 an additional delegate, and we are still fine-tuning things. We have an inventory scheduled for the end of this year. What we hope to eventually have is an area organization that has kept what works well for us from our parent, Southern California Area 05, and has created the rest as needed to best fit the needs of our recovered and nonrecovered alcoholic communities. It is truly an exciting and rewarding experience to serve as Area 93's first delegate. — *Steve Hagen*

California (Northern Coastal): Area 6 has about 1,800 geographic districts and four districts serving the Spanish groups. Communication throughout the area is helped by the subdistrict/D.C.M. chair structure. Each district is visited by one of our eight area officers each month, and many subdistricts hold monthly meetings. We have four standing committees, BTG, Finance, Archives, and P.I./C.P.C., and several Ad Hoc committees. Each month we meet for D.C.M. sharing, meetings of each standing committee, and the area committee meeting. There are four assemblies a year — Pre-Conference, Post-Conference, Summer (workshops), and Fall (inventory or elections). The area is self-supporting through group contributions. There are 22 intergroups/central offices (six are Spanish). Our monthly newsletter is translated into Spanish and committee meetings and assemblies are simultaneously translated. The delegate's Conference report is translated and signed; the delegate also visits each district to make a Conference report. We have found that good and open communication is essential to a smoothly functioning area. — *Suzanne Moore*

California (Southern): I want to thank the Conference for granting Southern California Area 5 an additional delegate area last year. Our area is still extremely dense in A.A. population with over 33,000 members in more than 1,000 groups, but geographically we are now one of the smallest areas in the Conference, and are trying some new, hopefully improved, methods of communicating with our membership. We have two new elected area offices this year: a second treasurer and an elected registrar. Our post-Conference delegate reports are going to have a new format. We are planning three local mini-assemblies, two for our English-speaking groups, and one for our Spanish-speaking. These will be an informal open house to which groups are invited to hear the report and learn a little bit about general service. In order to continue translating as much information into Spanish as possible, we made our Translation committee a permanent area standing committee. We continue to have Spanish interpreters at all area meetings, and American Sign Language when needed.



An open-mike G.S.R. sharing session has been added to the agenda of our day-long quarterly assemblies. We hope to continually improve the way we carry the message of love and service to alcoholics in Southern California. — *Mary Templeton*

Colorado: Area 10 has approximately 600 groups, 33 districts and one area-wide Spanish-speaking district. The assembly meets three times a year, and also oversees an area convention in the Fall. At our assemblies, G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s have an opportunity to network with one another, to be involved in the business of keeping the area a functioning part of the service structure, and to be involved in the world service issues of Alcoholics Anonymous. We just completed an 18-month long assembly inventory that has done much to improve our focus. The assembly maintains a full slate of active standing service committees. The decline in numbers of treatment facilities and the shared "bridging the gap" mission has led both our Treatment Facilities and Corrections committees to wonder if combining their efforts into an "H&I" plus "Bridging the Gap" format might be advisable. Our Spanish-speaking district is seeking ways to be more involved in the area as a whole. Area 10 has a history of active service involvement, and I am proud and humbled to be its human contribution to this Conference. — *Brian Rogers*

Connecticut: Area 11 is comprised of nine geographic and one Hispanic districts. We have over 1,400 groups with more than 34,000 members. Our area and district committees meet every month. We have one pre-Conference and two regular assemblies. Recently we established an area office that is centrally located and is being used by several committees and our Hispanic district for their monthly meetings. Our 13 service committees are very active; our Schedules committee distributes meeting books free of charge to members, while our Web site publishes up-to-date meeting and answering service information as well as access links for the other committees, Schedules, P.I., Alki-Line, and Corrections. P.I. is still holding its monthly A.A. meetings on public radio while Corrections and Treatment continue to expand Bridging the Gap. This year we will host our 43rd Annual Convention, 27th Service Roundup, and 11th outdoor "Soberfest." We will be hosting NERAASA 2001. I am honored to serve as delegate for an area that stays focused on recovery, unity and service in a rapidly changing Fellowship. — *John Burke*

District of Columbia: Area 13, which is comprised of Washington, DC and two neighboring Maryland counties, has always pulled together as a cohesive unit. Our Grapevine committee is probably more active than ever; and the C.P.C. committee has undergone marked revitalization. We have maintained continued cooperation with the Intergroup office in the realm of local public information, newsletter features and archival acquisitions. Our H&I committee is developing a Bridging-the-Gap contact program. We have three enthusiastic Hispanic districts that serve groups in DC, suburban Maryland and northern Virginia, and last year they hosted the First Hispanic Regional Forum. The Annual November

Gratitude Breakfast attendees provided a contribution of over \$1,000 to G.S.O. We ended the year with an engrossing presentation on the Concepts delivered by our past delegates. In 2001 the area will host the NERD Meeting. We will continue to try and stimulate interest and participation from groups, for we know that G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s are the very core of our success as a healthy and thriving area. — *Dorothy Patch*

Florida (North): Area 14 is comprised of approximately 700 groups in 31 districts, four of which have multiple D.C.M.s. We chose to stop splitting districts and began to add more D.C.M.s to ones that had a large number of groups to ensure better communications and assure that each district could remain self-supporting. Each D.C.M. can now have as few as 10 groups. We have four assemblies per year where each of our 9 standing committee chairs conducts a workshop. Each D.C.M. is assigned, for a two-year term, to either the Finance, Growth or Site and Agenda Committee. A recommendation from the Growth Committee led to appointing an Ad Hoc Committee to evaluate the benefits of having a nonrotating archivist in North Florida. The Archives committee will work out the details. Our recent Area Inventory included some very constructive ideas that we feel will improve communications throughout the area and aid North Florida in better carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are evaluating the merits of creating an Area Web site. The intent is to reach more people through this new medium, but we are approaching it carefully to protect personal anonymity and to address other sensitive issues. — *Tom Guest*

Florida (South)/Bahamas/Virgin Islands: Area 15 has 16 districts. There are 14 within the State of Florida, and then it's 1,100 miles of open Atlantic to District 14 in the U.S. Virgin Islands, which always has at least one A.A. member representing them. The Bahamas, our other island district, is inactive at the area level at present. Our Hispanic district crosses all district boundaries for its membership groups and is now into its third year of service. I consider myself fortunate in coming from a large district which has 700 regular meetings and another 220 institutions meetings each week. The area has 33,706 members with 1,554 registered groups and approximately 1,100 G.S.R.s. We are striving to find ways to get G.S.R.s more involved to increase participation at all levels. The area is active and has well established service committees. We host three quarterlies and one assembly a year in various locations with about 550 in attendance. Past delegates play a vital role in our quarterlies and assemblies in Current Practices, Service Manual Workshop, Traditions, and we have just started a Concepts Workshop. We share hosting and support of a Florida State Convention each year with Area 14. We are building our foundation through the Three Legacies to maintain a hope and path of recovery for alcoholics to come in the future. — *Norma Washburn*



Hawaii: The Hawaii Area, admittedly paradise, has some unique opportunities and challenges of carrying the message to alcoholics spread out over six islands and a lot of miles of ocean in between. Not only do we have geographical and logistical problems but also the very constant dilemma of money. The cost of carrying the message in a multi-island area is the topic of many, many, many loving discussions. We serve about 300 groups in 17 districts; about a third of these groups regularly send a G.S.R. to our four assemblies every year. To continue to Twelfth Step all the districts in Hawaii, we rotate our assemblies and committee meetings to all the islands. The result has been miraculous in some rural, remote communities whose participation in service work has skyrocketed after serving as a host for an assembly or committee meeting. The "hot" topic in Hawaii this year is our launch of our area Web site, www.hawaii-aa.org. We are now in the process of lovingly discussing the contents of our Web site and through this procedure, are discovering the true meaning of "Love and Service." — *Jeanette Foster*

Illinois (Chicago): Area 19 has close to 4,000 meetings a week. Our Chicago Area Service Office offers literature for sale to our area and beyond. Chicago hosts a State Conference every three years, with plans in the future to make this a weekend event. We host an "All Chicago Open Meeting" once a year, with attendance of 7,000-10,000 people. There are 11 active service committees. P.I. is upgrading our Web site so that each delegate, chair, and committee chair has an e-mail address and will be responsible for requests and information. Area 19 is in the process of taking our inventory; committees and groups have been doing likewise. Many workshops have been held throughout Area 19 and P.I. and C.P.C. will be hosting special Workshops in the next few months. Chicago is growing and updating, and the area is active in working with the Spanish district. We have purchased equipment to help with the translation of English to Spanish, if you have brought your own transistor radio and ear buds. The Young People's groups are growing and we are supporting them in their efforts to blend in. — *Dolores York*

Illinois (Southern): Area 21 has approximately 430 groups in 17 districts covering about 70% of the state. Area assemblies are held quarterly in varying locations. Attendance at assemblies varies from about 60 to 100, depending on location and time of year. Only about 10-15% of our groups are represented by a G.S.R. at the assemblies. We have a past delegate conduct a workshop for G.S.R.s at each assembly. Southern Illinois area has the majority of correctional facilities in the state. Finding A.A.s to conduct meetings in prisons and jails is often a challenge. The lengthy clearance process is a deterrent to some, but willingness to commit and follow through seems to be a bigger stumbling block. Volunteers for meetings in treatment facilities are also in short supply in some districts. We have a full slate of D.C.M.s for the first time in a couple of years, but some districts still struggle to find committee chairs and people willing to serve beyond the local group. The purpose of general service overall doesn't seem to be understood by many members. I'm grateful for 'service sponsors' who kept telling me I needed something to do and kept encouraging me to study the A.A. *Service Manual* and to participate in service at district and area levels. — *Richard Bruha*

Indiana (Northern): Area 22 is divided into 48 districts with 665 registered groups and 9 intergroup central offices. We hold four assemblies a year, one being a weekend assembly, and two D.C.M. conferences. At our last D.C.M. conference we gave each

D.C.M. and alternate a notebook, packed with pamphlets, guidelines and leaflets. With 10 standing committees, and our D.C.M.s pulled from the hat to sit on these committees, we are always looking for the most effective ways possible to carry the message. This year we will be hosting the 48th Annual Indiana State Convention, in French Lick; our Archives committee is joining with several areas in surrounding states to host the 6th Archives Workshop, in Clarksville. Area 22 is truly blessed to have the shared wisdom and knowledge of seven of its past delegates, still active in service work and readily available to help guide us into the future. I personally feel an overwhelming amount of gratitude to them all. They have given me the confidence to undertake any level of service to Alcoholics Anonymous, when I lacked confidence in myself. — *Bridget Vest*

Iowa: Area 24 has 620 registered groups in 21 districts and covers the entire state of Iowa. We have three area committee meetings and two assemblies a year. The committee meetings are held in the central part of the state; assemblies are hosted by various districts around the state. We have a Service Weekend in March, which gives everyone an opportunity to discuss the Conference agenda items and communicate to the delegate the informed conscience of our area. There are 10 standing committees and a permanent Archivist who serves an eight-year term. Area 24's Web site committee is in the process of going online after approval by the assembly of guidelines, content and budget. We also have a Bridging the Gap program for Treatment Facilities, a Temporary Contact program for Correctional Facilities and a Pink Can program to generate funds for literature for Correctional facilities. We are blessed with active and enthusiastic past delegates who lovingly share their experience and help to guide us in our primary purpose — to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Chuck Barta*

Louisiana: Area 27 has approximately 440 groups serving together in 30 districts. Four times each year we gather at the center of our state for area assemblies. More recently we've experienced growth through redistricting and renewed interest in inventorying ourselves, our groups, districts, area officers, and others. As we become more aware of the meaning of our Responsibility Statement, individually and collectively, we've realized we're somewhat old fashioned in our belief that the Big Book means what it says, that our Traditions don't need to be expanded and interpreted as much as they need to be followed to allow these Twelve Points to Insure Our Future, that our Conference Charter, Board By-laws and Twelve Concepts can be our spiritual antidote to self-deception and our Grapevine provides us freedom of expression. But, like ourselves, all of these must be well known and exercised with God's guidance. We have come to believe you don't get any less alcoholic the longer you serve. — *Mark Kramar*

Steve Hagen, Panel 51 delegate followed his wife, Marita, Panel 49 — except Marita was from Area 5 (Southern California) and Steve represents the newly admitted Area 93 (Central California).

Susie and Tom Ardolf also followed each other (Panels 48 and 50) from Northern Minnesota.

Another spouse story: two delegates presented their wives for trustee election: Elvis Fortner (Virginia) and Martin Gerwig (West Virginia).

Massachusetts (Eastern): Area 30 consists of over 2,000 groups, of which about 1,800 are registered (we're working on it) divided into 26 districts, with two Spanish districts. We have five assemblies a year and hold a monthly area committee meeting. We have very active conference committees. Our Corrections committee, which is joint with Boston Central Service, sponsors over 100 meetings a month in several facilities. Some of our districts also have Corrections, P.I. and Treatment committees which handle commitments in their local areas. Our Treatment Facilities committee sponsors an 800 hot-line number. Our Archives, Literature, P.I. and C.P.C. all meet on a monthly basis. Our Grapevine Committee sends annual subscriptions of the Grapevine and La Viña to Correctional and Treatment Facilities. At this time we have 4 standing committees consisting of Registrar, Service Seminars, Messenger (our area newsletter) and the Mass State Convention (which we co-host with Area 31 every November). I know we all love service, but our goal is to do our service with love. — *Marilyn McKeehan*

Michigan (Central): Michigan is a three-delegate area, with area 32 occupying the Eastern half of lower Michigan, except for the southeast corner. We have 14 districts, with 601 active groups. We have nine committees, with a new Special Needs committee. The first Sunday of each month a different district hosts an Intra-Area meeting. We have a G.S.R. Orientation for new or returning people, where we go over a handbook. The three delegate areas hold a statewide quarterly meeting on Corrections, Grapevine, and Areas. The areas also host a mock Conference in the goings-on at the General Service Conference. A state convention is held yearly, with each delegate area hosting it every three years. I would like to see more people who have done service to stay around, sit in on these standing committees, give input/guidance. We need to find ways to keep these people involved. Our area is seeing more young people coming to area assemblies and getting involved in committees. — *Ron Atkinson*

Michigan (Southeast): Area 33 is made up of five counties, divided up into 25 districts, one of them a new Spanish-speaking district. There are about 725 registered groups with over 18,000 members. Our assembly meets every third Sunday of the month, with the D.C.M.s meeting prior to the assembly. We have 13 active committees, Special Needs and Web Site being the newest. The Special Needs Committee is cooperating with deaf counseling centers to set up a hearing-impaired A.A. meeting. Our Web site has become an excellent tool to disseminate all Area information, including group registration or changes. I am especially proud of the correction committee throughout the state. We host the State Convention every third year and do a March Roundup other years. We participate with Michigan Areas 32 and 34 to put on a Mock Conference that contains agenda items, to better prepare the current and future delegates. The young people of Michigan have the honor of hosting the 2001's International Conference of Young People in Alcoholics Anonymous (ICYPAA) June 28th. I am very proud to be a servant to the recovering alcoholics in Area 33. — *Bill Thomson*

Minnesota (Southern): Area 36 serves approximately 1,000 registered groups in 26 districts. We held an annual Service Conference in January followed by a Delegate's Workshop, three one-day Assemblies, and four area committee meetings. Our January event focuses on the Conference theme and topics, and provides orientation sessions for members new to service. Area officers meet on a monthly basis, and our 12 standing committees meet on a quarterly basis. A recent addition is the Web site committee. In 1996, Area 36 implemented a two-day assembly

format which incorporated the area committee meeting; we have worked diligently for the past two years to regain momentum lost due to this change. As a result of the outstanding efforts of our standing committees, the area enjoyed a 27% increase in group contributions. The area's Pink Can Plan distributed 20,118 pieces of A.A. literature to prospects incarcerated in 22 different correctional facilities. Our members share fond memories of A.A. friends they met from across the country and around the world while hosting the 65th International Convention in Minneapolis. Area 36 hopes to pass on the message of A.A.'s Three Legacies as we serve in the 21st century. — *Christine Carvell*

Missouri (Eastern): Great interest in carrying our message is being shown in our 24 districts and approximately 575 groups. An urban St. Louis district voted to split into three separate districts, thus raising our number to 24 from 22. Our January assembly broke our past record-high attendance by both voting and nonvoting members. This is cause for much revitalized hopefulness throughout our area. All committee chairs are filled and functioning. The P.I. and C.P.C. committees hold workshops in several rural districts. Our conference structure has taken action in facing opportunities and challenges for inclusion within our sizeable African/American community. We have three thriving Spanish-speaking meetings in St. Louis. The diversity of our area is rapidly changing as 18,000-25,000 Bosnian refugees have settled here. We also have a large southeast Asian community. These issues of diversity are ongoing within our Twelfth Step work. St. Louis — 2005: A Spiritual Homecoming is the working title for a major archival event between our area and intergroup. In November 2005, it will celebrate the 50th anniversary of A.A. Coming of Age, along with the 65th anniversary of our Alano banquet. We aspire to this event having much spiritual significance and a broader scope as plans evolve. — *Ed Martin*

Missouri (Western): Area 39 has 15 districts with approximately 200 groups and holds four quarterly assemblies a year. Each year Western Missouri and Eastern Missouri co-host the state convention, which helps in promoting unity between the two areas and makes life-long friendships. Western Missouri also has an area convention each year with approximately 300 to 400 in attendance. The tenth annual Bridge the Gap workshop weekend was held September 29th to October 1st, 2000, in Kansas City. We have active committees for Archives, Corrections, C.P.C., Grapevine, Literature, P.I., Treatment and Western Area Convention; also subcommittees for Bridge The Gap, Special Needs, Missouri State Convention and Western Missouri Website. A joint venture by the Corrections and Treatment committees is the Institutions Weekend which brings professionals together with A.A.s to share information and discuss how we can better serve the suffering alcoholic. Western Missouri is very active and on the move forward to helping A.A.'s everywhere. — *Wayne Robinson*

Montana: Area 40 is comprised of 262 groups. This past year Montana suffered devastating forest fires in the western part of the state that caused a number of A.A. events to be cancelled. In July, a large contingent of Montana A.A.s "Walked the Walk" at the International convention in Minneapolis. It was a great weekend of fellowship. On a sad note, one of our past delegates passed away last year, but many of us had the good fortune to see him and listen to him share at a Roundup a few months before he died. As part of restructuring the rotation schedule of the delegates in our region, our trusted servants in Montana served only a one-year term last year, with the option of stand-

ing again for a two-year term. It was encouraging last year to see the number of groups that read all the background material for the Conference agenda items, and were prepared to discuss them at our Spring Assembly. An informed group conscience can only be reached when all the information is available, therefore I hope we can maintain open and honest communication among all members and all levels of the service structure of this wonderful Fellowship. — *Loren Buettner*

Nevada: Area 42 Nevada, which has two districts in California, elected a delegate from California for the next two years (in case you are wondering what I'm doing here). There are approximately 500 active groups in the area of which 48 are in California. Assemblies are held at Tonopah, a small mining town midway between Reno and Las Vegas. We all drive there since there are no public airports; in fact, there are hardly any distractions there at all! About 125 G.S.R.s, 22 D.C.M.s, 15 committee chairs, officers and alternate officers are present. Many past delegates and past trustees also attend, helping us to make well-informed decisions. Area 42 has also formed two Spanish districts; both are active in our assemblies. We have translation equipment for use at service functions and conferences. This has provided better participation by the Spanish-speaking G.S.R.s at our assemblies. Last year the Spanish A.A. Conference was held in Reno and the translation equipment was used to help English-speaking members participate. The area helps fund D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s to attend the Pacific Region Service Assemblies, helping them have a better understanding of the bigger picture of A.A. and increasing their groups' participation at area service functions. We are alive and well! — *Joan Murdock*

New Jersey (Northern): In the last year, Area 44 has been involved in redistricting several existing districts. The area has expanded from 36 to 41 districts serving approximately 1,200 groups and 30,000 members. Our districts are represented by 37 D.C.M.s and are divided into 6 sections, each with its own leader elected by the D.C.M.s of each respective section. Each December, our area committee, comprised of D.C.M.s, standing and special committee chairs, and area officers, participates in a "Work Weekend" during which we review the progress of committee and area goals of the previous year and develop goals for the upcoming year. At the December 2000 "Work Weekend" we commenced a comprehensive inventory through a "brainstorming" session at its opening meeting. In response to the need to identify and to serve the remote community, the area committee voted to establish a Remote Communities special committee. Area 44 is looking forward to hosting the 2001 Northeast Regional Convention, in conjunction with its annual area convention in October. Our standing and special committees are actively involved in serving the area and in carrying the message. Area 44 is committed to the theme of this year's General Service Conference: Love and Service. — *Robert Conway*

New York (Central): We have area assemblies every month except for May, when one of our districts hosts the Central N.Y. Area Convention to hear the delegate report back on the Conference. The location of the assembly rotates between the eight districts of Area 47 from month to month so that no one district has the burden of long-distance travel. Currently we have close to 800 registered groups, and each month less than 10% of those groups send a G.S.R. to the assembly. For this reason, many members bemoan the lack of A.A. members interested in service. However, the members — old and new — who show up from month to month, year to year, have been terrific exemplars of the spirit of "Love and Service." No matter what the job is that

needs to be done, we seem to always have just the right amount of willing members to get it accomplished. This year we will be hosting the 33rd Annual New York State Convention and the Northeast Regional Forum, in addition to our own Area Convention. Our service committees are doing great things, too. The Bridging the Gap program has processed over 1,000 requests from inmates since June of '99. And our attitude about self-support was well in evidence when our assembly treasury bottomed out last year and groups responded immediately and generously. Area 47 lives and breathes Love and Service, and it is a privilege to represent them. — *Gayle Solheim Riese*

New York (Southeast): Area 49 consists of almost 2,000 groups in the five boroughs of New York City plus Long Island's Nassau and Suffolk counties, and the counties of Westchester, Rockland, Orange, Putnam and Sullivan. Southeast New York (SENY) also recognizes a nongeographical Spanish district. In such an incredibly diverse area with a densely populated city, as well as suburban and rural regions the DCM chairs are an important link in our communication. The D.C.M.C.s of all 12 counties and the Spanish district at our assemblies. The D.C.M.s also hold county general service meetings. These are mini-assemblies providing all the information received at our area assemblies and committee meetings. We publish a SENY Service Handbook and Articles of Association and By-Laws, in English and Spanish. Our area newsletter, The Link, has an extensive calendar of events. We use simultaneous translation equipment for Spanish and provide ASL at as many functions as possible. SENY has recently formed an ad hoc committee to explore the feasibility of forming a new delegate area. Meanwhile, we are men and women who share, as we develop our conscience through our structure with spiritual cooperation. — *Allan Ward*

North Carolina: Area 51 consists of the state of North Carolina, with 12,000 members in nearly 950 registered groups, about 50 of which meet in correctional facilities. Approximately 15 of our groups are Spanish-speaking. Area 51 is divided into 35 districts, the largest of which includes 66 groups, the smallest, eight. Our Area Committee meets four times a year and our assembly twice. Whenever possible area agenda items are considered first by one of five standing committees staffed primarily by D.C.M.s. Assignments to these committees are made by lot, ensuring all regions of equal representation. We are particularly proud of the work of our Correctional Facilities and C.P.C./P.I. committees. We have a vigilant Budget and Finance Committee, a thorough Site Investigation Committee, an enthusiastic Grapevine Literature chairperson, and a knowledgeable Archivist. Over the next two years, we face several challenges, including better integration of our Spanish-speaking groups into the area service structure, increased attention to special needs," and greater conformance of Web sites within our area to our Traditions. Perhaps our biggest challenge is to understand and address the absence of 75% of our groups at our area assemblies. With your help I am sure that Area 51 will make progress in all these efforts. — *Donna Byrd*

North Dakota: Area 52 has 147 active groups in 12 districts covering the entire 69,299 square miles of North Dakota. Three assemblies are held each year. In March we gather in one of our smaller communities to discuss the agenda of the upcoming Conference. This gives the area and the delegate time to become informed on current concerns of both the area and A.A. as a whole. It also provides each of the six standing committees a direction for their individual meetings. In June we meet for two days, and in September a one day assembly is held during the State Roundup. Every other year our area elections are held at

the September assembly. All of the G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s are assigned to a committee. The alternate delegate/area chair and other area officers head up the committees. The delegate helps all the committees with information when asked and sits in on the same committee that has been assigned by the General Service Conference. This system has worked well for the past seven years. Experience has shown us the more we involve groups and members in our area, the smoother the road to a happy destiny becomes. — *Mike Bennett*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Area 82 has 16 districts — 10 in Nova Scotia and six in Nfld./Labrador. There are 252 groups in the area and travel between the two provinces is very difficult as N.S. is separated from Nfld. by a 90-mile body of water, the Cabot Strait, and Nfld. is separated from Labrador by the Strait of Belle Isle. Service meetings are held in May of each year in each province. Our assemblies are held once a year in one of four strategic locations. Our assemblies also have a social so we are able to make a family. Area officers meet the previous night and go over the agenda and add any pertinent information. Service workshops are held at both the assembly and the service weekend and at the districts. Most districts have P.I., C.P.C., and Institutional committees and the area is setting up a Remote Communities committee. We have a good working arrangement with the treatment facilities in the different districts. If there is one thing I could pass on effectively to my area during my term it would be a true understanding of commitment to service. — *Walter Henwood*

Ohio (Central/Southeast): Area 53 has approximately 520 registered groups, served by 42 districts. We currently have five intergroup offices. We also have nine standing committees active in carrying the A.A. message to all who suffer from alcoholism as well as our professional friends in the court, clergy, corrections, and medical fields, who make many alcoholics aware of our Fellowship. This year we are celebrating our second Annual Weekend Mini-Conference in conjunction with our quarterly assembly. This has provided our delegate with an Area Group Conscience, as well as inform our G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and standing committees of actual agenda items. We invite past delegates and G.S.O. staff to have an active role which is greatly appreciated. Our Correctional Facilities Committee is making plans for their 4th Annual Weekend Convention this fall. We are grateful to all who participate in their own recovery by contributing to Area 53 General Service and pray we are utilized as long as God sees fit. — *Herbie Humphreys*

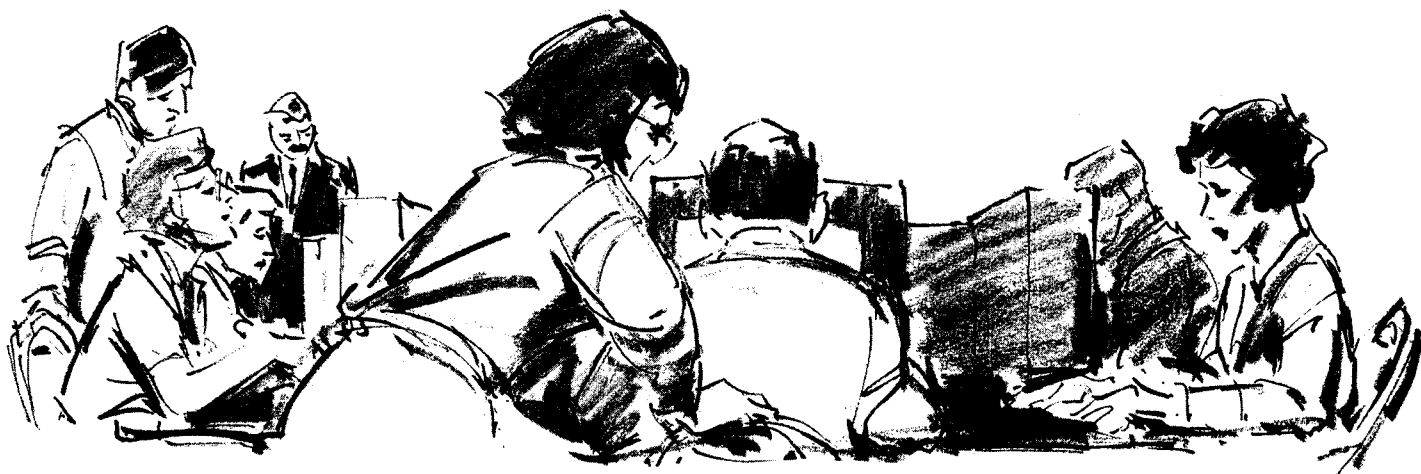
Ohio (Northeast): Area 54 consists of 64 districts, including one Spanish district, which encompasses the whole Spanish-speaking population of the area. We have approximately 1,200 registered groups and 6 intergroup/central/district offices. We have 12 past delegates, of which 9 remain faithful and active in area activities. We have 6 assemblies, 2 D.C.M. workshops, a G.S.R. workshop, a picnic-style Open House and a well-attended Gratitude celebration each year, as well as a mini-conference based on the General Service Conference. Past delegates have found this mock Conference helpful in giving them the area's conscience on agenda items. We have 10 standing committees. The Correctional Facilities committee sponsors a workshop yearly, and the Grapevine committee is provided a table at Founder's Day to spark subscriptions. One of the duties of the P.I. committee is to provide the upkeep of our Web site. Panel 51's goals are to spark activity in districts that right now lack motivation and to continue carrying the message of recovery through A.A. to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Tina Hobson*

Oklahoma: We A.A.s of Area 57 are energetic and innovative in our service opportunities to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. We are blessed with past delegates who lovingly serve as elder statesmen. Area 57 includes 8 districts with 48 D.C.M.s that serve over 358 groups and 5,900 members. Our districts schedule quarterly meetings, prior to the area's meetings. We have four workshops yearly, which have been customized to meet the district's, particular needs, and one area assembly. Our groups fund an Area Office and Archives with a paid secretary that is included in our budget. We have eleven committees with Oklahoma's own Bridge the Gap, Gratitude Plan and Language Services. We have a Media Services Committee, which is responsible for our web page. Our State Convention is the chief vehicle for our delegate's Conference report. Oklahoma City hosts S.W.R.A.A.D.A. annually with excellent participation by the southwest region. Area 57 is one of the leading contributors per capita to G.S.O. Oklahoma hosted S.W.R.A.A.S.A. in 2000 with the largest attendance yet for that service assembly. Our future challenges are: setting a prudent reserve for our area as well as a contingency fund for our State Convention; continuing to develop avenues to educate and carry our message; and to always be attractive through living the example. With our Higher Power's grace's and the miracle of A.A., Area 57 (Oklahoma) is indeed "Love and Service" in action. — *Sherry Leech*

Ontario (Eastern): Area 83 spans from the Quebec border, west to Toronto, north to Algonquin Park and south to New York State. We have 28 districts, two of which lie completely in the United States and one which lies half in the U.S. and half in Canada. There are over 600 groups with about 15,000 members. A good portion of these groups and members are in metropolitan Toronto — the site of the 2005 International Convention. We are a mix of rural and urban members which makes for exciting debates and exchanges at our three area committee meetings and two assemblies annually. Our membership is concerned over declining Grapevine subscriptions in Ontario and has enhanced our efforts to make the Grapevine affordable to our smaller groups and districts by purchasing bulk subscriptions and distributing them monthly. Eastern Ontario is very concerned with the dilution of the initiative to provide meaningful service to the still-suffering alcoholic in the far north. Although honorable in intent, the trend of trying to be inclusive to all people in remote situations will, in my area's opinion, only produce a one-size solution that fits no one. — *Joe Downey*

Ontario (Northeast): Area 84 is geographically very large. Except for the bigger towns and cities, some members have to do a lot of traveling just to get to a regular A.A. meeting. My 'pet project' for the past two years as alternate delegate has been working with the Remote Communities in our area — especially those along the north part of Hwy #11 and the areas north along the Hudson Bay coast. I didn't see as much get done as I would have liked to, because of a lack of funds. So part of my mandate over the next two years will be to travel around our 8 districts and encourage some of the larger A.A. groups to "adopt" the A.A. groups in our Remote Communities and to give them help and encouragement and whatever financial support is possible. Our newly elected area committee will have had its first meeting when I'm at the Conference in New York; and I'm really looking forward with enthusiasm to being a part of our new group, and facing whatever challenges come our way. — *Helaine Bertrand*

Ontario (Northwest): Area 85 exceeds 250,000 square miles. There are 89 groups, eight districts and approximately 1,600



members. With many new people on our area committee, we first need to re-establish open communication with the groups in our area. Travel can be costly, so effective participation is encouraged in our groups and districts to the Area, then back to the groups. We have two assemblies a year, one area round-up in Thunder Bay in May. At that round-up, along with workshops and guest speakers, we also have a workshop directed to the professional community. Carrying the message to alcoholics in Remote Communities will always be a challenge to our area. Literature translation into Native languages is slow, but positive. We presently have a member translating the Big Book into Ojibway; we have some literature translated into Oji-Cree, another dialect of Native North Americans in our area. As an area delegate I learned the meaning very early of "trusting the committee system," as I live 250 miles from our nearest urban area, Thunder Bay, and a lot of our work is centered in that city by A.A. members. I also realize that I don't have to do this program on my own and I am very grateful to the Fellowship and members of Area 85. — *Donald Anderson*

Quebec (Southeast): Area 88 has over 4,300 members in 18 districts, with 218 meetings. Four English groups hold six different meetings. As for the districts, a few functions are presently vacant, due to a lack of servants, but hopefully these should soon be filled. Every year we hold four regional assemblies and one general assembly, which is held by the end of October. The regional executive consists of five elected members and three assigned members to the following committees: P.I., La Vigne and Bulletin. The committees meet six times during the year. Also, two Gratitude Lunches are held in May and June, in two different areas of the region, where the delegate gives the Conference report. When invited by the districts for workshops on Structures and Traditions, the delegate again gives details of the Conference. Our responsibility as servants is to preserve the Unity which constitutes our personal recovery. Geographically, our region covers the east of Quebec right to the Magdalenian Islands (Iles-de-la-Madeleine) along the south shore of St. Lawrence River. — *Guy Raymond*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): Area 59 consists of 1,400 groups, 47 districts, and 10 intergroups. We hold four area meetings a year; districts hold meetings monthly. We have eight standing subcommittees. Our Ad-hoc Committee on Special Needs and Remote Communities, in the last 18 months, has opened doors with the hearing impaired, blind, Spanish and Korean-speaking communities in our area. We hold Share-A-Days with our inter-

groups, to discuss how we can help each other carry the message. We are also creating a Bridging The Gap and a First Contact program that can be tied in to the districts. We held our Convention and Assembly on the same weekend with attendance of 1,000 or more members. This is the second year we have held a Pre-Conference Workshop. Eastern Pennsylvania is following the theme of this year's Conference, Love and Service. We are dedicated to carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Martin Sullivan*

Pennsylvania (Western): Area 60 has 880 groups in 46 districts covering 27 counties in Western Pennsylvania. We have quarterly committee meetings, two assemblies a year, and three assembly meetings on our election year. We have nine standing committees, and our registrar keeps the database updated. The Archives, Grapevine and Literature committees have traveling displays for group, district and area events. Each March we have our Getaway Weekend, followed by a pre-Conference assembly, where we discuss and have presentations on Conference agenda items. Our C.F. and T.F. committees have incorporated the Bridging the Gap program into their guidelines. Area 60 is looking forward to hosting next year's Northeast Regional Service Assembly in February in Pittsburgh. We in Western Pennsylvania are constantly trying to improve our lines of communications, so that we can continue to focus on our responsibility of carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, through our service structure, the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts. I am humbled and very grateful to be a member of Area 60 of Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Vaughn Horton*

Quebec (Northeast): Area 89 includes 22 districts, 360 groups and about 6,500 members. Most of our members are French-speaking. The six members of our executive committee meet once a month at our office in Quebec City, where there is a part-time employee. We hold two assemblies and four area committee meetings per year. Our service committees lend information and support to the district service committees. Seminars on various subjects, such as Money and Spirituality, Sponsorship, the Twelve Traditions, the G.S.R., etc., have been held in each district. Members show a lot of interest and the results are positive. This year, the action will be on improving communication, as well as service to remote communities, our area covers a wide territory, and great distances separate these communities. Visiting them is sometimes difficult. It causes high expenses, and it is very demanding and time-consuming for our trusted servants. Our D.C.M.s are well aware of the seriousness of this

challenge. Concrete actions will be taken throughout the year. Each day is an opportunity to grow in simplicity, in a spirit of love and Unity. We share our Fellowship's common goal of carrying our message of hope. I am grateful to be able to serve as delegate, in joy, respect and love. — *Raymonde Latulippe*

Texas (Northeast): There are approximately 430 groups in Area 65, with 29 districts, four of which are Spanish-speaking. The area committee, with a lot of cooperation from the Hispanic Intergroup and the members of our area, have come a long way in bringing down the language barrier. We hold four assemblies a year at different locations. We recently held area elections at our Fall Assembly so we are all new to our respective service jobs. At our Winter Assembly in January we had 24 of our 29 D.C.M.s along with many alternates. If our recent assembly is any sign of things to come we have reason to be excited about our area's service structure. The area officers are elected by third legacy procedure. The various committee chair people are appointed by the incoming area chair person and the out-going area chair person. All of us in the Northeast Texas Area are very pleased to be part of A.A. service. — *Larry Johnson*

Texas (Southeast): Area 67 serves approximately one quarter of the state of Texas. Houston is the area's largest city, with Beaumont, Galveston and Bryan/College Station among the other large cities. In Houston alone there are over 2,000 A.A. meetings a week. Area 67 includes 15 districts serving approximately 550 registered groups. Two linguistic districts within our area are dedicated to serving approximately 50 Spanish-speaking groups and members. Assemblies are held on a quarterly basis for two days. We support standing committees that mirror those of the Conference, and are especially pleased about the success of the 2nd Annual Correctional Facilities Conference. In 2000 we conducted a successful area inventory that resolved or reconciled a number of internal issues, conflicts and disagreements. My concerns are probably typical among delegates but the two most present in my mind are the lack of participation in service at the area level and what appears to be the weakening of our "Singleness of Purpose," mostly in our metropolitan locations. I am very grateful to represent all the members of Area 67 in this 51st Conference and I bring you the friendliest greetings of Southeast Texas. — *Marvin Wicher*

Utah: Area 69 covers the entire state of Utah, 82,000 square miles. Over 75% of our population lives on less than 5% of the land, making the majority of our area very sparsely populated, with the majority in the northern part of the state. The same is true of our A.A. population. We are made up of both rural and urban districts. We have 11 districts with just over 280 registered groups with an estimate of over 5,000 members. Most of the districts hold monthly meetings. Area meetings are hosted by the districts and move around the state. For some, that may mean travel up to 400 miles to attend. We hold three assemblies and five area committee meetings a year. Our Pre-Conference Assembly is held a month prior to the General Service Conference to inform the area about upcoming Conference agenda items. Our Post-Conference Assembly provides a forum for the delegate to report back on the Conference. Over the past two years, we have discussed one of the Concepts at each of our Area meetings. By the way, before anyone asks, yes you can get a drink in Utah. You just have to be more creative and more determined than in some other parts of the country. Remember "Love and Service keep us dry." — *Shirley Ohlson*

Virginia: Area 71 has 46 districts, 1,420 groups and 14 inter-group central offices. Along with our G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s our Virginia Area Committee also includes six Officers, six Special Assignments and eleven Standing Committees. We have two assemblies a year (spring and fall) and two meetings (winter and summer). There is also a statewide convention that is voluntarily hosted by districts across the state. We do not have a fixed site for our assemblies, meetings or conventions. The Virginia Area has a Web site, with information on events around the state, including our meeting schedule. Our Archives Committee is preparing an Area History book, to be presented at our spring assembly. We have 12 past delegates, nine of whom are still active in service work. I am grateful for their experience. I am deeply honored to a part of this wonderful Fellowship, and to be present here today. — *Elvis Fortner*

Washington (Western): Area 72 has approximately 1,100 groups in 40 districts. At our last election assembly, October 2000, we had just short of 800 registered and about 400 voting members present. A committee is looking at developing a third history book for the area. In 1999, we purchased a Tour Guide System, for translation purposes regarding our non-English-speaking district. We have formed an ad hoc committee to look at improving our area business meetings and improving our participation levels. At our January area business meeting we saw another motion to have an area split, which failed. Other than our non-English, non-geographic district, we have a couple of districts that are considered remote, and they have groups that are on islands and can only be reached by boat, small plane or state ferries. — *Andy Arvidson*

West Virginia: Area 73 serves 16 districts which include 298 active groups and approximately 3,400 members. We hold two assemblies a year, with approximately 70% group participation. We continue to rely on our special standing committees to provide information and recommendations to our assemblies regarding: Finance & Budget, 800#, and Assemblies and Conventions. Our annual state convention is held during one of the summer months. We have previously alternated cities, but are now considering one site in the future. Our area has budgeted approximately 38% of the treasury annually in order to meet the cost of the statewide 800#. A new service company must be hired, which could escalate costs by 200%. We have been pursuing other answering services throughout the state. A new Web site for Area 73 is now on line, www.aawv.org, which contains meeting information for any locality in the state. West Virginia continues to grow in our fellowship, ever reminding us of our primary purpose — to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Martin Gerwig*

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 has more than 930 groups in 32 districts; we hold six assemblies a year. We hold a "delegate workshop" to give the Fellowship a chance to review and give input to the delegate on the upcoming Conference agenda. The fall conference assembly each odd year is dedicated to the area taking its inventory. This year we are holding our first Unity conference, a statewide conference in partnership with Area 74. Area 75 is actively carrying the message through our standing committees. We have a traveling Third Legacy Workshop that has been gaining in popularity. It explains the service structure using that best-kept secret in A.A., the *A.A. Service Manual*. My personal hope is that we hold our decisions to a litmus test that I have been told comes from Bill W.: "Concerning any given services, we therefore pose but one question: 'Is this service really needed?' If it is, then maintain it we must, or fail in our mission to those who need and seek A.A." — *Leo Mutchler*

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- At the joint meeting the trustees' Committee on the Conference and the Conference Agenda Committee discussed the idea of having a more flexible agenda for 2002 in case additional topics of concern come up during the year. The Conference Agenda Committee decided to submit two presentation/discussion topics and one workshop topic in order to allow room for additional presentations or reports, if necessary.
- The committee discussed the format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner of the General Service Conference and made no changes.
- The committee discussed the Conference Evaluation Form and suggested changing the heading of Section #4 to Conference Committee Reports and copying the form onto a brighter color in 2002. It was further suggested that the Conference Evaluation Form be kept in the front of the Conference Manual and that announcements be made throughout the Conference week to fill out the form.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and added the following Procedure: "To review the available archives literature."
- The committee reviewed the newly developed Archives Workbook and expressed their appreciation for the work done by the trustees' Archives Committee. Members of the committees also expressed their appreciation to the General Service Office Publications Department for their help to make the item available by this year's Conference.
- The committee considered a request to produce a pamphlet about how archives carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous and encouraged the trustees' Archives Committee to develop a service piece about how archives carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous.

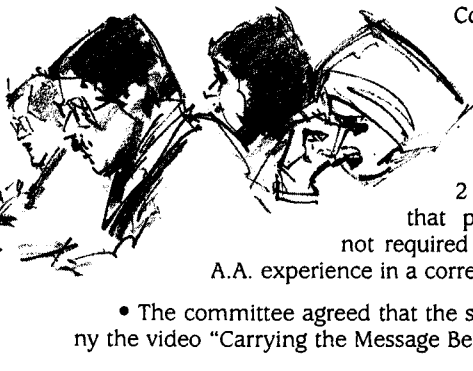


COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee suggested that the word "dental" appear only once in the third sentence of paragraph three (3) in the service piece, "Working with Students Attending Professional Schools" (F-106).
- The committee suggested that the paragraph on page 31 of the C.P.C. Workbook beginning with, "These publications are all listed..." be changed to read, "there are also catalogs for Special Needs and Grapevine materials."
- The committee suggested that the sentence following the heading "Basic Guidelines for C.P.C. Presentations," at the bottom of page 16 in the C.P.C. Workbook, be changed to read: "Here are two *suggested* formats for presentations..." which reflects a suggestion by the 2000 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community.
- The committee suggested that Item F-64, the postal subscription card for *About A.A.*, be added to the contents of the C.P.C. Kit and that item numbers appear with all items listed on the C.P.C. Kit Contents (M-41) sheet.
- The committee forwarded to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities a suggestion that the "Singleness of Purpose" statement outlined in the 1997 Advisory Action be moved to a more prominent place in the C.P.C. pamphlets: "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community," "Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?," "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional," "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Professionals," "If You Are a Professional," and "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous." The committee asked that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities forward ideas and suggestions to the 2002 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community. (Note: The "Singleness of Purpose" statement reads: "Alcoholism and drug addiction are often referred to as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Alcoholics and nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings. But only those with a *drinking* problem may attend closed meetings or become A.A. members. People with problems other than alcoholism are eligible for A.A. membership *only* if they have a drinking problem.")

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the service piece to accompany the video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" and suggested that the following information be included in the section "Take a Meeting into or Share at a Correctional Facility":
 - 1 Sharing that may help to alleviate fears regarding security in a correctional facility.
 - 2 A reference to the fact that previous incarceration is not required to share practical, sober A.A. experience in a correctional facility.
- The committee agreed that the service piece to accompany the video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" should



¹ Secondary committee



be added to the Correctional Facilities Kit and placed in the service files at the General Service Office.

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook. Since the Workbook reflects the practical experiences of A.A. members in various service areas, the committee agreed that any future sharing or experience should be forwarded to the Correctional Facilities staff secretary in order for the information in the Workbook to be current.
- The committee discussed various ways to carry the message into youth detention centers and short-term facilities and emphasized the importance of working closely with C.P.C. and P.I. committees to provide information to those professionals who specialize in this type of work. The committee noted there is a need for younger A.A.s to share their experience, strength and hope at these facilities and suggested that increased efforts should be made to communicate this need through young people's groups in Alcoholics Anonymous.
- The committee agreed that communication between local A.A. committees is the key to more effective Bridging the Gap, Prerelease and Temporary Contact efforts.
- The committee shared experience on the value of participating in activities, such as Funshops, area luncheons and service symposiums that facilitate better communication between local service committees that carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic, wherever he or she may be.

FINANCE

- In expectation of continuing discussions of using literature price reductions as the primary mechanism in adjusting the relationship of the Reserve Fund, the committee invites areas to share their views.
- The committee discussed how areas separate and account for local convention activities, including ongoing convention funds. As the input did not create a clear group conscience, we request additional sharing from the Fellowship concerning their convention accounting and reporting practices as they may apply to the International Convention. The committee offered the following points for discussion:

Essentially, the General Service Board has held Convention funds "in trust." They have been held in the Reserve Fund. These funds, deposited with or withdrawn from the Reserve Fund, have impacted the balance of the Fund for the Ample Prudent Reserve calculation.

It has been suggested that if we were to establish an ongoing Convention Fund (which would be essentially the monetary results of the International Conventions held to date), it would be more in keeping with the practices of many parts of the Fellowship.

Balances left in the Fund after a Convention would then be used to help fund the next Convention, instead of having the operating corporation (A.A.W.S.) do so. Currently we are expending funds for two future Conventions and it is conceivable that we may be working three Conventions out at some point.

A suggested minimum "fund balance" could be determined and then the remainder might be used to help defray the registration fee of the next event.

- The committee discussed an area's suggestion "that the 2001 Conference appoint an ad hoc Ways and Means committee to discuss and present to the 2002 Conference their ideas and suggestions on how our General Service Office may become fully self-supporting through A.A. member and group contributions" and felt it was not necessary at this time.
- The committee discussed self-support using tools such as workshops, visual aids, reporting on where the money goes when passing the basket, there is no contribution too small, and the need to communicate and educate.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in the year 2003 or later, and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board its suggestion that the Grapevine produce a softcover anthology of articles that would be helpful to newcomers and which have been previously published in the magazine.



- The committee discussed the need for an announcement card about the A.A. Grapevine that could be distributed to A.A. groups and read at meetings and concluded that there was no need to produce such a card at this time. Understanding the importance of raising awareness of the Grapevine in A.A. groups, the committee suggested that information about subscribing to the magazine be included in some of G.S.O.'s regularly scheduled mailings to listed groups and area committees and in some of the Kits and Workbooks offered by G.S.O.

- The committee discussed the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., refrain from sponsoring or hosting online meetings, including but not limited to real-time meetings, e-mail meetings, bulletin boards, and forums and, after careful consideration, decided that no action was necessary.

- The committee encouraged the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to approach the use of any real-time online format with caution.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee reviewed the trustees' report on the general International Conventions Inventory and agreed there was a good response from the Fellowship, and that, as indicated in the trustees' report, there was an overall positive feeling about A.A. International Conventions; that these events fulfill their purpose; should be self-supporting and should continue. The committee agreed that if a "general International Conventions Inventory" is done in future, a single inventory questionnaire be sent out mid-way between Conventions.

Note: *Introductory Text:* Trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums Report on the General International Convention Inventory dated January 27, 2001:

The 1999 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums implement a general inventory on International Conventions. The trustees' committee presented an interim report to the 2000 Conference Committee and is responsible for presenting a final report to the 2001 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

On June 9, 2000, the International Conventions Coordinator mailed to all Conference members a request for sharing on the general subject of International Conventions with responses due January 1, 2001. Delegates were asked for only one response per area. Two sample questionnaires were enclosed with the mailing.

Of the ninety-three delegate areas, forty areas returned completed questionnaires yielding a 43 % response rate.

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and agreed that thorough communication to the Fellowship by areas, districts and the General Service Office was key to generating interest in Forums. Ideas shared on helping to encourage interest in Forums included:

Early organization of a host committee.

Development of flyers that clearly describe what a Forum is in addition to where and when.

Pre-Forum informational sessions with D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s so they are better able to describe what a Forum is to members.

Early gathering of suggested presentation/workshop topics from area members.

Early mailing by the General Service Office of Preliminary Forum Agenda.

- The committee gratefully expressed their thanks and appreciation to the 2000 Minneapolis International Convention Host Committee for their extraordinary enthusiasm, and hard work in helping to make the Convention a successful and joyous celebration of Alcoholics Anonymous.

LITERATURE

- The committee discussed four different proposals to change the Fourth Edition of the Big Book Conference distribution process and took no action. The committee based this decision on the 1999 Conference Advisory Action which reads, "Based on precedent in regard to previous editions of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the A.A. history book, and *Daily Reflections*, any draft copy of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be considered a work-in-progress, and as such, is confidential; the operating principle being that any story material brought forward to the Conference Literature Committee will be done on a 'for-their-eyes-only' basis adhering to the principle of the 'right of decision,' and not brought forward for any other general distribution until publication."

- In order for the Fellowship to have equal access to information about the 24 new stories and the 16 stories brought forward from the Third Edition of the Big Book and also to give the General Service Office Publications Department adequate time to collect releases from the authors of the new stories, the committee agreed that the personal story section of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book remain confidential until publication. The General Service Office will contact all current and previous subcommittee, trustees' and Conference Literature Committee members after this Conference to request that any material in their possession

¹ Secondary committee

pertaining to the Fourth Edition of the Big Book be returned to the General Service Office. The draft manuscripts of the 1,222 stories originally submitted for consideration for the Fourth Edition Big Book have been held in trust by all involved. This is a customary request to protect the confidentiality of all stories submitted by A.A. members.

- In order to give the General Service Office Publications Department adequate time to collect releases from the authors of the stories in the pamphlets "Can A.A. Help Me Too? — Black/African Americans Share Their Stories" and "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic — Never Too Late," the committee agreed that these pamphlets remain confidential until publication.

- The committee discussed the trustees' Literature Committee's proposal for a new pamphlet that includes a variety of spiritual experience and took no action. The committee suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee consider adding to or clarifying existing pamphlets such as "This Is A.A." and "A Newcomer Asks" to address a variety of individual interpretations and individual experience of spirituality in Alcoholics Anonymous.

The committee suggested that the trustees' P.I. and C.P.C. Committees consider addressing in their literature that A.A. is not allied with any religion.

- The committee discussed the request "that in the future no draft copy of any literature be submitted for approval by the General Service Conference without all Conference members having the opportunity to review that literature" and saw no need for any action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed their Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed to correct paragraph 2 of the "Scope" describing the Admissions function to read, "Is responsible for reviewing all requests for admission to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference."

- The "Application for Additional Delegate Area" was reviewed and the committee agreed on a number of changes to be included in a draft that will be distributed to committee members after the Conference for additional suggestions. A final draft of the "Application for Additional Delegate Area" will be forwarded to the 2002 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee for consideration and implementation.

- The committee agreed on some basic guidelines for the use of Conference members' portable computers during the General Service Conference, if or when a Conference agrees that use of portable computers is appropriate. The basic guidelines will be passed on to the trustees' Committee on the Conference with the request that consideration be given to a trial use of portable computers during the 2002 General Service Conference, if the Conference agrees. The committee also requests that the trustees' Committee on the Conference gather information on costs related to use of portable computers during a General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Nominating Committee's recommendation on Bill W.'s "Memorandum on New Delegates" regarding future growth of the General Service Conference. The committee strongly suggested that the General Service Board gather input from all trustees and delegate areas on current problems within the General Service Conference structure, as well as possible solutions. The General Service Board is

asked to share a progress report and background with the 2002 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee by February 15, 2002.

- The committee discussed a request to consider the use of electronic voting systems during the General Service Conference, and agreed to request that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference explore the spiritual, practical and financial implications of using electronic voting systems during a General Service Conference. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference report their findings by February 15, 2002 to the 2002 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee for further consideration.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee considered a request that a television Public Service Announcement specific to the Holiday Season be produced. Based on a report that indicated that there is less available air-time and increased competition for broadcasting P.S.A.s during this period of the year, the committee felt that it might be more cost effective to look at radio and print vehicles for this Holiday Season concept. The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee examine these options and report back to the 2002 Conference Public Information Committee.

- The committee discussed the concept of utilizing centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of future P.S.A.s, in addition to the work of local committees and found that the concept was worth pursuing. The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee present a complete proposal, including detailed cost estimates and a more precise explanation of the potential benefits to the 2002 Conference Public Information Committee for their consideration.

- The committee discussed the trustees' Public Information Committee's idea of formulating a long range development plan for future P.S.A.s and requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee develop a detailed plan including cost estimates to be forwarded to the 2002 Conference Public Information Committee for their consideration.

- The committee discussed the draft of the proposed trustees' Public Information Committee's policy on the co-founders' posthumous anonymity and expressed appreciation for the sensitivity which the committee demonstrated and the practical manner in which this policy can guide the General Service Office in dealing with the media concerning our co-founders' anonymity.

- The committee reviewed the 2000 and current reports on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site activity and were encouraged by the growing effectiveness of this most valuable P.I. vehicle. Members of the committee emphasized the increasing use of area web sites in communicating local A.A. information to the general public and the Fellowship.

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and noted that changes approved by the 2000 General Service Conference concerning Anonymity at the Level of the Internet had been implemented in several pamphlets and that the remainder of the changes are on schedule to be implemented.

- The committee expressed appreciation for the presence of the two observers from the German General Service Office during their deliberations.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed the suggestion to clarify the procedures for redistricting by adding wording to the effect that "When redistricting, approval of the groups within each district involved is essential and the proposed redistricting plan should be approved by the area assembly" on Pages S30-S31 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, in section titled Redistricting, and took no action. The committee agreed that the current wording on Page S31 reflects the spirit of the Twelve Traditions and is not in conflict with areas that have guidelines.

- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the group structure chart in *The A.A. Service Manual*, Chapter Two: The Group and Its G.S.R. and concluded that because the chapter includes the following sentence, "The pamphlet 'The A.A. Group' provides extensive information on group organization and opportunities for service," and "The A.A. Group" pamphlet includes the group structure chart, it is not necessary to reinstate the group chart in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

- The committee considered the suggestion to restore Appendix A "Original Conference Charter - 1955," Appendix B "1955 Resolution" and Appendix C "Current Conference Charter" to the front of the manual to reflect its placement as it was in the 1999 *A.A. Service Manual*, and reinstate the section titled "What is the Conference Plan" to its original placement as in the 1999 *Service Manual* and took no action.

- The committee discussed the suggestion to change the sentence on Page S63, under #3 "A resume of the candidate, covering professional, business, and A.A. service qualifications...." to read "A resume of the candidate, covering A.A. service, business and professional qualifications...." and unanimously agreed to take no action as all aspects are considered important regardless of the order placed in the text, and changing the order might indicate a priority of qualifications.

- The committee suggested deleting the first sentence in Paragraph #3 on Page S63 under the title "Trustees-at-Large" and replace with "Each trustee-at-large is requested to attend Regional Forums in both the U.S. and Canada. If schedules permit, each trustee-at-large could attend one Regional Forum in each of the eight North American regions over the course of their four-year term."

- The committee considered the suggestion to add a footnote to Page 61 of the *A.A. Service Manual* or to expand the scope of the existing footnote #9, under Concept XI, to reflect current practices and concluded that given the complexity of laws affecting the workplace today, this item be referred to the A.A.W.S. Board for consultation with legal counsel.

- The committee considered the suggestion that a column be added to the group listings in A.A. Directories showing the date group information was last updated and took no action. The committee agreed that adding the last update would not provide better information to the Fellowship.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed collected sharing on formats used for institutional meetings, and considered the two-paragraph state-



ment "Why We Are Here" proposed for inclusion in the Treatment Facilities Kit. After thorough discussion, the sense of the meeting was that there is no need to include this statement as this information is included in the A.A. Preamble and other materials. Many local committees have already developed their own method of presenting this information.

- The committee shared about the activities of local Treatment Facilities Committees, and stressed the importance of ongoing cooperation and communication with the staff of each facility.

The committee also focused on using A.A. literature in carrying the message into short-term and outpatient facilities, where it may not be practical to bring in meetings, with particular emphasis on providing local meeting directories and subscriptions for the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña.

- The committee discussed Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts in their areas, and stressed its importance for alcoholics in making the successful transition from a treatment facility to sobriety in A.A. Many areas have developed effective procedures for implementing Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact programs. Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact workshops have explained this service to local members and helped them become involved. Often working together, area and district service committees and intergroup/central offices have extended the hand of A.A. through Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts.

- The committee considered ways treatment facilities committees can help when it comes to individuals referred to A.A. who focus on problems other than alcohol at A.A. meetings. Committee members shared the experience with this topic in their areas. Some solutions discussed included: continual sharing about our A.A. Traditions with treatment facilities staff, workshops on what A.A. does and does not do, and use of A.A. literature, especially the pamphlet, "Problems Other Than Alcohol." The committee shared that at meetings, individual A.A. members can provide loving but firm one-on-one sharing and sponsorship to newcomers.

- The committee forwarded numerous suggestions for additions and changes to the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook to the trustees' committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities for consideration.

TRUSTEES

- The committee suggested that the trustees' Nominating Committee's *Composition, Scope and Procedure* be included as background material for the members of the Conference Committee on Trustees.

FLOOR ACTION WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- That the proposed draft of the posthumous anonymity policy be made available to this Conference to review and vote on as a general policy of this Fellowship.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
 December 31, 2000 (with comparative totals for 1999)

	General Service Board of A.A.							
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Convention Fund	A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2000	Consolidated 1999
ASSETS								
Cash	\$ 1,175,925	\$ 1,263,077		\$ 3,301	\$ 1,888,907	\$ 232,604	\$ 4,563,814	\$ 3,833,957
Accounts and interest receivable		161,875			236,236	50,359	448,470	366,212
Intercompany balances	(1,184,839)	(1,642,663)		(3,301)	1,218,244	1,612,559	-	-
Inventories								
Books, pamphlets, etc.					1,443,672	122,298	1,565,970	1,656,654
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.					155,165	18,900	174,065	223,296
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)								
U.S. Treasury Notes, due 2001/2006 (Cost: 2000 - \$8,499,142; 1999 - \$8,244,047)		8,722,109					8,722,109	8,205,390
Property and Equipment								
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software, (net of accumulated depreciation - 2000 - \$2,711,098; 1999 - \$2,837,396)			\$758,141				758,141	731,798
Deferred charges and deposits	124,327				75,342	74,343	274,012	930,117
Prepaid pension cost (Note 3)		1,343,421					1,343,421	924,974
Total Assets	115,413	9,847,819	758,141	-	5,017,566	2,111,063	17,850,002	16,872,398
LIABILITIES								
Accounts payable	\$ 58,400				\$ 708,420	\$ 72,020	\$ 838,840	\$ 608,310
Accrued royalties					39,761		39,761	40,090
Deferred income								
Orders and subscriptions, etc					41,971	1,506,535	1,548,506	1,490,587
Advance registration fees							-	2,101,325
Accrued postretirement health benefit obligation (Note 5)		\$ 2,957,841					2,957,841	2,453,519
Total Liabilities	58,400	2,957,841	\$ -	\$ -	790,152	1,578,555	5,384,948	6,693,831
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	57,013	6,889,978	758,141	-	4,227,414	532,508	12,465,054	10,178,567
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	115,413	9,847,819	758,141	-	5,017,566	2,111,063	17,850,002	16,872,398

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2000 (with comparative totals for 1999)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		Consolidated 2000	Consolidated 1999
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund		English	Spanish Magazine		
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE								
Gross Sales				\$ 9,751,749	\$ 2,311,411	\$ 62,249	\$12,125,409	\$11,765,658
Less: Discounts				290,317	37,456		327,773	304,011
Net Sales				9,461,432	2,273,955	62,249	11,797,636	11,461,647
Cost of Literature Distributed								
Printing				(3,116,847)	(391,408)	(31,202)	(3,539,457)	(3,337,925)
Royalties on books				(167,917)	-	-	(167,917)	(164,542)
Direct shipping and warehousing				(956,491)	(490,130)	(18,480)	(1,465,101)	(1,486,564)
Gross Profit from Literature				5,220,177	1,392,417	12,567	6,625,161	6,472,616
CONTRIBUTIONS - A.A. Groups and Members	\$ 4,511,206						4,511,206	4,242,052
2000 International Convention								
(Net of direct expenses of \$3,110,804) (Schedule 1)	997,584						997,584	-
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	13,143	\$ 737,750		28,001	95,274	-	874,168	215,912
Total Income	5,521,933	737,750		5,248,178	1,487,691	12,567	13,008,119	10,930,580
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)								
Program	3,927,492			1,373,338	933,598	62,137	6,296,565	6,124,191
Supporting services	2,215,807	85,875	\$ 280,513	1,272,679	570,193	-	4,425,067	3,797,591
Total Expenses	6,143,299	85,875	280,513	2,646,017	1,503,791	62,137	10,721,632	9,921,782
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(621,366)	651,875	(280,513)	2,602,161	(16,100)	(49,570)	2,286,487	1,008,798
Receipt of net assets of Canadian non-profit corporation (Note 7)							-	197,706
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS	621,366	433,786	306,856	(1,428,222)	16,644	49,570	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	1,085,661	26,343	1,173,939	544	-	2,286,487	1,206,504
NET ASSETS								
Beginning of year	57,013	5,804,317	731,798	3,053,475	531,964	-	10,178,567	8,972,063
NET ASSETS								
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	6,889,978	758,141	4,227,414	532,508	-	12,465,054	10,178,567

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2000 (with comparative totals for 1999)

OPERATING EXPENSES	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	Spanish Grapevine	Supporting Services	2000 Total	1999 Total
Salaries	\$ 600,967	\$ 790,023	\$ 132,868	\$ 1,560	\$ 80,446	\$ 859,133	\$ 463,698	\$ 40,286	\$1,826,267	\$ 4,795,248	\$ 4,733,768
Payroll taxes	40,675	58,381	8,766		5,236	62,546	36,490	2,192	138,637	352,923	350,458
Health and group insurance	108,569	108,614	13,183		9,852	118,566	92,995	4,455	403,240	859,474	831,285
Retirement expense - funding	31,307	44,589	6,747		4,030	48,141	21,965		102,520	259,299	301,264
Other program printing	213,343	43,326	48,639	9,234	5,760	2,100			7,112	329,514	279,008
Mailing labor	124,353	4,833	777		7,892	-			913	138,768	154,049
Postage and express	235,654	90,736	29,246	1,926	21,181	9,532	18,008		29,643	435,926	451,105
Writers fees	19,151	5,402	7,895	6,039	6,109	13,603			-	58,199	54,414
Foreign literature assistance		132,134							-	132,134	113,645
Selling expenses						75,327	145,159	12,367	-	232,853	228,716
Professional fees								595	337,253	337,848	289,659
Contracted services	4,165	66,767	2,448	16,598	4,499	8,491	18,004		66,635	187,607	144,568
Occupancy	64,068	98,467	6,864		4,776	110,507	74,620		245,180	604,482	594,681
Telephone	25,581	24,518	3,511	218	2,192	26,488	18,709		60,737	161,954	146,077
Equipment maintenance	2,836	-				7,843			54,559	65,238	61,939
Furniture and equipment	33,129	1,358			5,049	9,009		1,050	30,292	79,887	84,822
Stationery and office supplies	50,184	6,804	11,154	1,817	2,770	4,191	21,975	15	87,496	186,406	199,782
Office service and expense	5,992	20,696	17,153	8,668	4,176	9,076	21,975	176	231,771	319,683	278,871
Travel, meals and accommodations	401	24,542	376,047	122,868	63,123	8,785			405,235	1,001,001	814,120
Bad debts								1,001	31,189	32,190	26,056
Delegate fees			(108,096)	(107,294)						(215,390)	(109,218)
Total Operating Expenses	1,560,375	1,521,190	557,202	61,634	227,091	1,373,338	933,598	62,137	4,058,679	10,355,244	10,029,069
Postretirement health benefits									504,322	504,322	(53,249)
Depreciation									280,513	280,513	302,455
Retirement expense adjustment (Note 3)									(418,447)	(418,447)	(356,493)
Total Expenses	1,560,375	1,521,190	557,202	61,634	227,091	1,373,338	933,598	62,137	4,425,067	10,721,632	9,921,782
Allocation of supporting services to activities	1,025,894	1,000,132	366,342	40,522	149,305	1,272,679	570,193	-	(4,425,067)	-	-
Total Allocated Expenses	2,586,269	2,521,322	923,544	102,156	376,396	2,646,017	1,503,791	62,137	-	10,721,632	9,921,782
Services	\$2,586,269	\$2,521,322	\$923,544	102,156	\$376,396					\$6,509,687	\$5,769,217
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	\$2,646,017	-	-	-	\$ 2,646,017	2,639,184
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,503,791	\$62,137	-	1,565,928	1,513,381
										10,721,632	9,921,782
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 1999	\$2,421,970	\$2,214,610	\$783,942	\$ -	\$348,695	\$2,639,184	\$1,448,932	\$64,449		\$9,921,782	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
 Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
 Year Ended December 31, 2000
 (with comparative totals for 1999)**

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2000</u>	<u>1999</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ 2,286,487	\$ 1,206,504
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	(263,197)	302,893
Amortization of bond premiums	10,173	12,237
Depreciation	280,513	302,455
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	(82,258)	164,073
Inventories	139,915	(178,018)
Deferred charges and other assets	656,105	(571,316)
Accounts and accruals payable	230,201	(535,642)
Deferred income	(2,043,406)	2,028,284
Prepaid pension cost	(418,447)	(356,493)
Postretirement health benefits obligation	504,322	(53,249)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used) By Operating Activities</u>	<u>1,300,408</u>	<u>2,321,728</u>
FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Computer networking project	(306,856)	-
Proceeds from sales of investments	2,000,000	3,000,000
Purchases of investments	(2,263,695)	(3,013,186)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used) By Investing Activities</u>	<u>(570,551)</u>	<u>(13,186)</u>
Net Increase in cash	729,857	2,308,542
Cash, beginning of year	3,833,957	1,525,415
Cash, end of year	<u>4,563,814</u>	<u>3,833,957</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

March 2, 2001

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2000 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 1999 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated March 3, 2000, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2000 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles.

Our audit was conducted for the purpose of forming an opinion on the basic financial statements taken as a whole. The schedule of Direct Income and Expenses of 65th Anniversary Convention (Schedule 1) is presented for purposes of additional analysis and is not a required part of the basic financial statements. Such information has been subjected to the auditing procedures applied in the audit of the basic financial statements and, in our opinion, is fairly stated in all material respects in relation to the basic financial statements taken as a whole.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants

**THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
DECEMBER 31, 2000**

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of

assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in four separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND — This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND — This fund accounts for the costs of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and to record annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND — A separate fund established to record the income and expenses of the International A.A. Convention held in Minneapolis, Minnesota in July 2000. This event, which is held every five years, is separate from the regular operations and structure of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

At December 31, 1999, cumulative outside costs incurred of \$695,434 and advance registration fees recorded of \$2,101,325 were deferred and were shown on the balance sheet of the Convention Fund on Exhibit A. Salaries, benefits and other internal costs related to General Service Office staff assigned to the Convention have been expensed as a program activity of the General Fund.

The GENERAL FUND — This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Intercompany balances and transfers have been eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements. Amounts reported by A.A. World Services include Services Mondiaux Des Alcooliques Anonymes, Inc., "S.M.A.A.", a controlled non-profit Canadian corporation formed during 1999.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to

the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short-term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are considered to be immaterial and are charged to expense in the year of purchase.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2000 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements				
475 Riverside Drive	Terms of Leases	\$2,105,871	\$219,142	\$1,593,214
Furniture	8 Years	689,598	61,371	689,598
Computer - hardware	5 Years	402,099		156,615
- software	5 Years	271,671		271,671
		<u>3,469,239</u>	<u>280,513</u>	<u>2,711,098</u>

All depreciation is provided on the straight line basis.

Investments: As described above, all of the investing activity of the operating entities is consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes normally held to maturity. The investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

Investment income for 2000 and 1999 is comprised of the following:

	2000	1999
Interest	\$615,545	\$522,870
Realized gains on redemptions	1,573	5,117
Change in unrealized appreciation	261,624	(308,010)
Investment expenses	(4,574)	(4,065)
	<u>874,168</u>	<u>215,912</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services." Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the Box 4-5-9 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French-speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives, loners and overseas services and the International Convention staff assignment.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which cannot be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and other miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates cannot be determined.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65 % of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset cannot reduce the gross benefit by more than 50 %.

Pension expense is recorded in accordance with SFAS 87, in which pension costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, SFAS 87 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are record-

ed by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under SFAS 87 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense since it is a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2000:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 14,467,859
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>12,119,394</u>
Funded status	<u>2,348,465</u>
Prepaid pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 1,343,421</u>

The difference between the Plan's funded status and recognized prepaid pension cost asset is attributable to deferral and amortization of Plan assets and obligations as prescribed under SFAS 87.

Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	7.5%
Expected return on plan assets	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	5.5%
Benefit cost	\$ (183,196)
Employers' contributions	\$ 235,231
Benefits paid	\$ 560,672
Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 235,251
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	(418,447)
	<u>(183,196)</u>

Plan assets at December 31, 2000 were comprised as follows:

Short term cash and receivables	\$ 367,758
Common and preferred stocks	9,215,689
Government bonds	2,795,349
Corporate and other bonds	2,089,063
	<u>14,467,859</u>

Employees of S.M.A.A. in Canada participate in a separate retirement plan under which 5% of their annual salaries are contributed by that Organization.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2000, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

In addition to the above lease commitments, S.M.A.A. was subject to a lease for office space in Montreal, Canada. The lease is effective through December 31, 2004. The current rent for 2000 is \$24,407, with annual escalations of 3%.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2000 is \$4,658,000.

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided

through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

The plan is unfunded. The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 5%. A discount rate of 7.5% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B. The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2000:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>\$2,957,841</u>
Benefit cost	\$ 639,587
Benefits paid	\$ 135,265

The excess of the cost of benefits over the payments for benefits of \$504,322 has been reported on Exhibit C as a non-operating expense since it does not affect the current outlay of cash.

Note 6 Tax Status: The Organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

Note 7 Canadian Non-Profit Corporation: In January 1999, A.A. World Services formed S.M.A.A., a controlled Canadian non-profit corporation, for the purpose of acquiring the assets, liabilities and operations of Publications Francaises A.A. for \$1 effective February 1, 1999. The acquisition was made to insure the continuation of the publishing and distribution of French A.A. literature in Canada.

At the date of the purchase, Publications Francaises A.A. had net assets of approximately \$197,706. This amount has been shown on Exhibit B as an increase to net assets in 1999.

Note 8 Subsequent Event: In January 2001, the Grapevine Board made commitments for costs of \$340,000 in connection with the restructuring of the Grapevine office and the outsourcing of certain fulfillment functions. It is expected that substantially all of these funds will be expended by December 31, 2001.



**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Direct Income and Expenses of 65th Anniversary Convention
Minneapolis, Minnesota, June 29 to July 2, 2000**

INCOME

Registrations		\$4,141,102
Literature sales	\$ 87,476	
Less: Purchases and costs	<u>129,178</u>	(41,702)
Literature donations - 1995 Convention book	12,060	
Less: Shipping costs	<u>3,072</u>	8,988
Total Income		<u>4,108,388</u>

EXPENSES

Convention consultants' fees and expenses		268,201
Public relations, legal and accounting fees		32,941
Stadium production		661,097
Entertainment		53,370
Printing, signs, supplies		281,261
Busing costs	840,393	
Less: received from Minneapolis Convention Bureau	<u>100,000</u>	740,393
Host committee expense		47,201
Registration expense		169,676
Simultaneous translation expense		50,678
Rentals (convention center, equipment, booths, etc.)		472,116
Al-Anon expense		49,837
Pre-convention travel		26,625
Transportation, subsistence, hotels		90,731
Meals, insurance, telephone and sundry		<u>166,677</u>
Total Expenses		<u>3,110,804</u>
Excess of Income (Exhibit B)		<u>997,584</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Budget Highlights

2001 G.S.O. Budget

This budget describes the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office. It includes expenses of A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities). It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund or the Capital Projects Fund. The Grapevine operations are described below in a separate report.

Income: The 2001 sales budget of \$9,671,300 is slightly less than (.8%) the 2000 actual results. The budget reflects approximate even unit sales. Net sales after discounts allowed are projected at \$9,409,000, approximately \$52,000 less than 2000.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted just slightly (\$23,500) higher than the year 2000 actual results, primarily a result of slightly higher costs. Royalties, budgeted at \$167,700, are on a par with 2000 and 1999 as well.

Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted \$41,000 higher than 2000. We anticipate an increase in postage and freight rates, and some higher warehousing costs as well. Thus the line increases approximately 4%.

Gross profit from literature is budgeted at \$5,103,000, approximately \$117,000 less than 2000, a result of the decline in sales and increases in warehousing and shipping costs.

Contributions for 2001 have been budgeted at \$4,595,000, approximately a 2% increase over 2000. The year 2000 saw the fourth year in a row that contributions received have exceeded the prior year.

Total Operating Revenue for the period is anticipated at \$9,701,700, about 1% less than 2000.

Total Operating Expenses for 2001 have been budgeted at \$9,564,870, approximately 9% higher than 2000. Included in that larger than usual increase are additional expenditures to help carry the message worldwide as well as at home. For example, we are now mailing new G.S.R. Kits first class in an effort to deliver them in a more timely manner. There is also a significant increase (\$90,000) in the funds allocated to "Other Literature Assistance" efforts to help translate and provide recovery material to other countries (and in other languages) that can't do it alone. In addition, for 2001 we expect to be at full staff.

An excess of revenue over expenses of \$136,872 is budgeted. This compares with a \$983,211 net income for 2000, \$877,700 in 1999, \$139,600 in 1998, a \$245,000 loss for 1997, \$1,264,000 loss for 1996, a \$1,147,000 loss for 1995. The three years of losses, followed by succeeding profits, have resulted in a Reserve Fund balance of 9.9 months at 12/31/2000. After anticipated transfers, (in 2001), the balance will be approximately 11.6 months of combined operating expenses.

2001 Grapevine Budget

The 2001 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation for 2001 of 117,000, approximately 1,300 copies higher than the 115,734 achieved in 2000.

Income: Magazine income of \$1,768,100 is expected, just \$4,000 more than 2000. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$518,000, approximately \$9,000 higher than 2000.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, the gross profit of \$1,356,900 is budgeted, compared to \$1,392,400 achieved for 2000.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses (excluding one-time outsourcing and reorganization charges of \$338,000) for 2001 are budgeted at \$1,451,151, approximately \$52,600 less than the 2000 actual of \$1,503,791.

Net Income: For 2001 the Grapevine just about breaks even (before one-time costs and a small amount for French Canadian items). This compares with a loss of \$16,100 for 2000. After interest and one-time costs, a loss of \$338,056 is anticipated.

2001 Spanish Grapevine Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards will review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture.

For 2001 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$8,530, compared with a \$12,567 gross profit for 2000. Circulation for 2001 is estimated at 8,500, approximately equal with the 2000 average of 8,460. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$71,646 for 2001, compared with \$62,137 in 2000. The 2001 budget projects a net loss of \$63,116 compared with a \$49,570 loss in 2000.

To date the La Viña project has incurred start-up costs/operating losses of \$29,500 in 1995, \$138,290 in 1996, \$102,140 in 1997, \$66,182 in 1998, \$59,224 in 1999 and \$49,570 in 2000. The General Service Board has recommended that La Viña continue to be published at the General Service Board's expense.

The General Service Office 2001 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2000 Actual	2001 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$9,751,749	\$9,671,302
Discounts allowed	290,317	262,330
<u>Net Sales</u>	9,461,432	9,408,972
 Cost of Literature Distributed		
Manufacturing	3,116,847	3,140,378
Royalties	167,917	167,725
<u>Gross Margin</u>	6,176,668	6,100,869
 DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	956,491	997,627
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	5,220,177	5,103,242
Contributions Received	4,511,206	4,595,000
Interest Income	41,144	3,500
<u>Total Revenue</u>	9,772,527	9,701,742
 OPERATING EXPENSES		
Salaries	3,989,160	4,337,000
Payroll taxes	289,298	310,000
Insurance	695,304	760,600
Retirement expense	222,671	226,300
Other program printing	329,515	390,350
Mailing, labor, etc	138,789	142,360
Postage & express	417,900	474,900
Writers' fees	58,198	127,000
Other literature assistance	132,134	212,500
Selling expenses	75,327	95,600
Professional fees	304,729	225,000
Contracted services	169,603	199,600
Occupancy	504,116	531,250
Telephone	136,956	139,350
Equipment maintenance	65,237	76,100
Furniture & equipment	71,642	74,300
Stationery & office expense	171,467	187,635
Office service & expense	277,777	300,025
Travel, meals, & accommodations	725,820	745,000
Bad debts	13,673	10,000
<u>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</u>	8,789,316	9,564,870
 Income for period	983,211	136,872

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2001 BUDGET

			LA VIÑA	
	2000 Actual	2001 Budget	2000 Actual	2001 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION—AVERAGE # OF COPIES	115,734	117,000	8,460	8,500
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE				
Subscription income	\$1,709,406	\$1,732,128	\$62,249	\$62,227
Single copies and back issues	55,228	36,000	0	0
<u>Total magazine income</u>	1,764,634	1,768,128	62,249	62,227
<u>Total direct costs</u>	657,236	682,755	49,682	53,697
GROSS PROFIT ON MAGAZINE	1,107,398	1,085,373	12,567	8,530
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	509,321	518,064		
<u>Total direct costs</u>	224,302	246,549		
GROSS PROFIT ON SPECIAL ITEMS	285,019	271,515		
<u>TOTAL GROSS PROFIT</u>	1,392,417	1,356,888		
COSTS AND EXPENSES				
EDITORIAL COSTS				
Salaries, including temporary help	177,281	174,051	14,187	35,000
Payroll taxes and benefits	50,511	58,745	0	13,678
Occupancy costs	62,919	64,944	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	18,004	16,597	15	0
Product development	9,332	9,000	0	0
<u>Total Editorial</u>	318,047	323,337	14,202	48,678
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS				
Salaries, including temporary help	588,520	474,539	26,099	7,361
Payroll taxes and benefits	207,266	178,756	6,647	2,259
Kable fulfillment	0	89,113	0	4,988
Occupancy costs	62,444	64,944	0	0
Office supplies and expense	34,618	33,607	0	0
Subscriber services	13,980	14,500	0	0
Selling expense — regular	102,587	122,930	12,367	6,000
— GvR program	28,592	27,957	0	0
Postage	18,008	18,000	0	0
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	1,056,015	1,024,346	45,113	20,608
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE				
One-time charges	0	337,773	0	0
Insurance	5,042	5,042	176	360
Professional fees	32,524	24,100	595	600
Meetings and conferences	59,790	49,106	0	0
Furniture and equipment	7,195	3,500	1,050	0
Canadian exchange and other	6,291	6,000	0	0
Bank service charges	1,365	720	0	0
Bad debts	17,522	15,000	1,001	1,400
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	129,729	441,241	2,822	2,360
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	1,503,791	1,788,924	62,137	71,646
Interest earned	95,274	93,980		
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	(16,100)	(338,056)	(49,570)	(63,116)

() denotes red figures

2000 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area (in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIBUTIONS	% OF GPS. CONTRIBUTIONS	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS	SPECIAL MEETINGS	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	408	227	55.6%	\$ 31,857.85	8,751	\$3.63	\$ 864.47		\$ 238.05	\$ 30.00	\$ 32,990.37	\$3.77
2.	Alaska	204	87	42.6	9,239.79	3,610	2.56	184.03	\$ 365.00	897.00	150.00	10,835.82	3.00
3.	Arizona	754	381	50.4	84,024.38	17,055	4.93	4,401.10	2,650.00	1,136.90	106.00	92,318.38	5.41
4.	Arkansas	231	124	53.6	14,852.88	4,238	3.49	152.00	2,008.00	946.19		17,959.07	4.24
	California												
5.	Southern	1,131	387	34.1	96,944.87	38,985	2.48	6,332.82	2,170.00	8,677.36	2,060.51	116,185.56	2.98
6.	N. Coastal	1,772	1,059	59.7	224,382.08	51,795	4.33	17,290.55	100.00	10,811.16	2,037.35	254,621.14	4.92
7.	N. Interior	714	345	48.2	58,588.11	20,134	2.91	3,069.78		1,994.87	561.11	64,230.87	3.19
8.	San Diego/Imp.	834	363	43.4	66,556.70	25,078	2.65	5,397.51		1,456.87	312.67	73,723.75	2.94
9.	Mid-South.	1,865	714	38.3	117,333.05	60,575	1.94	5,709.59	1,030.00	3,332.91	603.20	128,008.75	2.11
10.	Colorado	628	359	57.2	71,609.65	14,531	4.92	5,743.01		3,016.44	4,035.66	84,574.76	5.82
11.	Connecticut	1,452	576	39.6	80,073.53	35,007	2.29	4,018.13	880.00	10,631.90	983.00	96,586.56	2.76
12.	Delaware	200	123	61.4	24,668.95	3,166	7.79	470.00		1,500.00		26,638.95	8.41
13.	D.C.	456	203	44.4	45,880.02	14,892	3.08	2,768.15		1,470.32		50,118.49	3.37
	Florida												
14.	North	645	362	56.0	72,080.22	14,454	4.98	9,064.89	1,194.52	16,859.66	25.00	99,224.29	6.86
15.	South/Bahamas/V.I.	1,574	814	51.7	154,577.61	34,407	4.49	9,809.94	1,285.00	30,476.33	435.00	196,583.88	5.71
16.	Georgia	692	436	63.0	73,636.49	15,798	4.66	1,621.52	25.00	509.01		75,792.02	4.80
17.	Hawaii	301	151	50.1	25,493.99	5,634	4.52	1,239.45		719.77	30.00	27,483.21	4.88
18.	Idaho	205	87	42.4	13,360.72	3,480	3.83	248.27		398.63		14,007.62	4.03
	Illinois												
19.	Chicago	1,195	311	26.0	56,967.71	29,050	1.95	3,069.31	270.00	3,894.08	65.00	64,266.10	2.21
20.	North	1,060	374	35.3	42,010.98	22,079	1.89	3,239.11		3,892.50	44.35	49,186.94	2.23
21.	South	438	170	38.7	23,878.18	7,218	3.30	944.80		1,164.11		25,987.09	3.60
	Indiana												
22.	North	652	266	40.8	34,610.52	9,584	3.61	990.00		513.84	150.00	36,264.36	3.78
23.	South	555	250	45.0	34,265.51	10,789	3.18	744.00	25.00	2,278.22	59.40	37,372.13	3.46
24.	Iowa	625	312	49.9	36,416.05	12,768	2.84	585.27		931.53	30.00	37,962.85	2.97
25.	Kansas	378	161	42.6	25,775.14	9,321	2.76	156.50	1,465.00	4,502.17	30.00	31,928.81	3.43
26.	Kentucky	641	297	46.2	61,441.92	10,236	6.00	3,148.93		5,269.46	17.00	69,877.31	6.83
27.	Louisiana	527	187	35.4	29,753.74	10,887	2.72	553.14	10.00	1,634.51	195.00	32,146.39	2.95
28.	Maine	453	141	31.0	16,140.23	7,610	2.11	344.00		955.00	25.00	17,464.23	2.29
29.	Maryland	929	378	40.6	65,699.85	14,989	4.37	2,003.00	10.00	4,824.96		72,537.81	4.84
	Massachusetts												
30.	East	1,487	509	34.1	98,556.00	51,078	1.92	4,953.96	2,020.00	2,277.40	440.00	108,247.36	2.12
31.	West	239	146	61.0	23,783.14	4,999	4.75	1,845.40			210.10	25,838.64	5.17
	Michigan												
32.	Central	549	224	40.7	31,161.66	12,714	2.45	1,497.50	170.00	1,189.61	90.00	34,108.77	2.68
33.	Southeast	715	289	40.3	61,754.07	17,953	3.44	1,838.62	40.00	760.55		64,393.24	3.59
34.	West	476	210	44.0	36,348.76	9,148	3.96	1,119.63	500.00	271.68	60.00	38,300.07	4.19
	Minnesota												
35.	North	547	234	42.8	23,037.45	8,226	2.79	469.00		882.79	152.24	24,541.48	2.98
36.	South	986	367	37.2	56,173.94	22,441	2.50	1,257.97	100.00	1,000.00	43.16	58,575.07	2.61
37.	Mississippi	246	94	38.2	11,439.32	4,533	2.52	1,059.00	135.00	425.54	12.09	13,070.95	2.88
	Missouri												
38.	East	527	262	49.6	46,180.99	8,816	5.24	2,888.73	58.00	2,311.45	82.00	51,521.17	5.84
39.	West	213	113	53.0	15,336.34	6,464	2.37	604.70		85.00	141.84	16,167.88	2.50
40.	Montana	263	119	45.1	16,998.73	4,173	4.07	173.00		326.59	12.50	17,510.82	4.20
41.	Nebraska	661	303	45.7	46,270.66	14,667	3.14	1,130.60		100.00	245.00	47,746.26	3.26
42.	Nevada	455	175	38.5	26,898.86	10,000	2.68	821.41		5,236.17		32,956.44	3.30
43.	New Hampshire	535	195	36.4	23,028.03	8,934	2.58	3,844.80		257.16		27,129.99	3.04
	New Jersey												
44.	North	1,313	491	37.4	71,696.15	33,310	2.14	5,879.09	20.00	990.50	216.00	78,801.74	2.37
45.	South	513	259	50.5	49,861.29	9,541	5.23	1,454.00	25.00	697.33	45.00	52,082.62	5.46
46.	New Mexico	312	168	53.7	24,359.27	5,647	4.30	616.13		1,894.92	170.50	27,040.82	4.79
	New York												
47.	Central	694	238	34.2	31,106.70	11,353	2.73	2,046.00	1,715.00	1,529.00	2,145.00	38,541.70	3.39
48.	H./M./B.	753	258	34.3	25,625.43	12,025	2.13	1,946.00		560.00	38.00	28,169.43	2.34
49.	Southeast	1,783	759	42.5	184,726.04	57,466	3.21	10,076.57	4,650.00	17,027.73	200.00	216,680.34	3.77
50.	West	305	100	32.7	11,169.54	5,819	1.91	203.57				11,373.11	1.95
51.	N. Carolina	919	465	50.5	87,010.11	15,007	5.79	1,970.60	180.00	1,227.15	70.51	90,458.37	6.03
52.	North Dakota	149	67	44.9	8,314.00	2,631	3.15	88.00	20.00	915.74		9,337.74	3.55
	Ohio												
53.	Cent. & S.E.	664	188	28.3	26,241.05	9,641	2.72	160.76		127.00		26,528.81	2.75
54.	Northeast	1,307	275	21.0	34,780.29	22,271	1.55	1,293.25	50.00	7,095.20		43,218.74	1.94
55.	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	284	101	35.5	11,886.45	4,069	2.91	473.65				12,360.10	3.04
56.	S.W. Ohio	543	216	39.7	36,147.83	11,033	3.27	2,331.26		807.54		39,286.63	3.56
57.	Oklahoma	379	209	55.0	30,767.55	6,469	4.75	1,927.30	50.00	240.00	52.00	33,036.85	5.11
58.	Oregon	806	372	46.2	55,896.18	15,048	3.70	2,404.61	1287.48	2,006.38	495.36	62,090.01	4.13

59.	Pennsylvania												
60.	East	1,388	706	50.9	126,435.22	32,465	3.88	4,170.60	100.00	5,114.98	252.57	136,073.37	4.19
61.	West	773	374	48.4	47,703.41	10,968	4.34	1,893.52		1,062.04	159.00	50,817.97	4.63
62.	Rhode Island	235	111	47.1	21,030.43	5,090	4.12	126.00	250.00	1,635.28	63.00	23,104.71	4.54
63.	South Carolina	300	191	63.6	36,517.17	6,582	5.54	897.85	125.00	2,650.00	100.00	40,290.02	6.12
64.	South Dakota	155	64	41.3	6,014.03	3,882	1.54	66.00		275.65		6,355.68	1.64
	Tennessee	484	232	47.8	40,052.57	11,180	3.58	4,010.87	200.00	92.80	50.00	44,406.24	3.97
	Texas												
65.	Northeast	402	191	47.4	53,968.06	16,811	3.21	1,766.65	700.00	2,321.31		58,756.02	3.50
66.	Northwest	232	83	35.7	14,377.96	4,960	2.89	440.60		1,418.32		16,236.88	3.27
67.	Southeast	497	224	45.1	44,240.64	15,799	2.79	6,179.93		367.47	60.00	50,848.04	3.22
68.	Southwest	485	225	46.3	47,866.13	11,557	4.13	4,084.50		567.09	4.22	52,521.94	4.54
69.	Utah	254	144	56.6	26,440.22	5,087	5.20	588.93		128.80	79.68	27,237.63	5.35
70.	Vermont	234	106	45.2	14,588.76	4,408	3.31	584.66		150.00	95.00	15,418.42	3.50
71.	Virginia	1,220	634	51.9	99,340.71	23,753	4.17	2,781.05	367.00	3,536.68	400.72	106,426.16	4.48
72.	Western Washington	1,110	522	47.0	100,003.69	24,264	4.11	4,635.61	63.00	18,199.81	69.64	122,971.75	5.07
73.	West Virginia	296	123	41.5	10,867.73	3,424	3.17	113.65	25.00	100.00		11,106.38	3.24
	Wisconsin												
74.	N. Wis./Upper/Pen. Mich.	628	234	37.3	24,722.45	10,343	2.38	1,634.17		1,775.79		28,132.41	2.72
75.	South	946	424	44.8	42,531.46	18,361	2.32	1,533.65	75.00	339.00	10.00	44,489.11	2.42
76.	Wyoming	111	54	48.6	8,271.45	2,043	4.04	121.70		1,298.93		9,692.08	4.74
77.	Puerto Rico	131	70	53.4	6,305.08	1,572	4.01	57.00		334.75		6,696.83	4.26
78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	549	222	40.4	29,530.29	8,317	3.55	1,586.18		2,679.58	133.76	33,929.81	4.08
79.	B.C./Yukon	719	369	51.3	49,530.66	13,725	3.60	277.84		6,134.38	121.97	56,064.85	4.08
80.	Manitoba	146	58	39.7	4,282.66	3,693	1.16	58.19		187.76		4,528.61	1.23
81.	N.B./P.E.I.	201	75	37.2	7,212.82	3,457	2.09	2.06	20.18	315.97		7,551.03	2.18
82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	254	94	37.0	8,092.92	3,609	2.24	292.86		306.89		8,692.67	2.41
	Ontario												
83.	East	599	234	39.0	34,806.93	15,076	2.30	42.03	90.07	10,788.64	423.61	46,151.28	3.06
84.	Northwest	174	50	28.6	6,917.53	2,439	2.84	48.84		239.14		7,205.51	2.95
85.	Northwest	85	16	18.8	1,277.22	1,433	0.88	13.45	60.53	946.30		2,297.50	1.60
86.	West	522	208	39.8	33,758.70	10,158	3.32	607.24	29.97	6,253.70	227.49	40,877.10	4.02
	Quebec ¹												
87.	Southwest	568	364	64.0	6,878.09	15,103	0.45	164.61		24,650.53		31,693.23	2.10
88.	Southeast	224	168	75.0	638.32	3,498	0.17	210.05	69.47	4,085.53		5,003.37	1.43
89.	Northwest	356	287	80.5	1,422.68	6,977	0.19	203.94		8,523.39	4.02	10,154.03	1.46
90.	Northwest	395	332	84.0	3,166.68	7,584	0.41	75.33		28,892.03	1,350.00	33,484.04	4.42
91.	Saskatchewan	312	94	30.1	6,907.53	3,747	1.84			864.52		7,772.05	2.07
92.	Washington East	450	162	36.0	14,867.02	6,448	2.30	20.00		12.50		14,899.52	2.31
93.	Central Calif	812	346	42.6	50,665.48	21,518	2.34	1,020.70		849.45	10.81	52,546.44	2.44
	Total U.S./Canada	56,389	24,842	44.1	3,929,906.25	1,260,928	3.12	190,868.64	26,853.22	312,275.19	20,522.04	4,480,425.34	3.55
	Canada												
Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings					238,243.90								
Specials					312,275.19								
Total for U.S. & Canada					4,480,425.34								
FOREIGN AND OTHER													
On Line Meetings					3,303.76							3,303.76	
ICYPAA					1,000.00							1,000.00	
Correctional facility groups					154.00							154.00	
Foreign					25,665.94							25,665.94	
Internationalists					30.00							30.00	
Loners					547.00							547.00	
International Doctors in A.A.					50.00							50.00	
International Lawyers in A.A.					30.00							30.00	
Grand Total					4,511,206.04							4,511,206.04	

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2000-1999 (in U.S. dollars)

	#GROUPS REPORTED	#GROUPS CONTRIBUTIONS	% OF GROUPS CONTRIBUTIONS	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC.
U.S. & Canada 2000	56,389	24,842	44.10%	\$3,929,906.25	1,260,928	\$3.12	\$3.55
U.S. & Canada 1999	56,266	24,889	44.20%	3,694,637.81	1,261,691	2.93	3.33
Increase (Decrease)	123	-47	-0.20%	235,268.44	-763	0.19	0.22

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas).

2001 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda	Finance	Policy/Admissions	Treatment Facilities	³ International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums
Andy Arvidson Ron Atkinson ¹ Darwin Haines ² Jim Hall Walter Henwood Stella Jenison Mark Koons Dottie Patch <i>Secretary:</i> Susan Ulseth	¹ Brookins Beck Jim Cotta Vincent Cousineau ² Maria Emery Sherry Leech Suzanne Moore Leo Mutchler Gayle Riese <i>Secretary:</i> Donald Meurer	Don Anderson ² Tom Ardolf Herbie Humphreys Brian Rogers Eric Rossner Mark Sawyer ¹ Marcia Stiff Mary Templeton <i>Secretary:</i> Joanie Moncrief	² John Karch Richard Bruha Jeanette Foster Larry Johnson ¹ Guido MacGuffie Marilyn McKeehan Mike Maes Betty Scherer <i>Secretary:</i> Rick Walker	Joe Downey Elvis Fortner Jim Hall ² Paul Jacob ¹ Bob Mayer Carol Readman Gayle Soldheim Riese Mary Templeton <i>Secretary:</i> Doug Richardson
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Grapevine	Public Information	Trustees	
Lainie Bertrand ¹ Tracy Flematti Elvis Fortner Moose Messerly ² David Parrish Harold Peterson Bill Thomson Allan Ward <i>Secretary:</i> Warren Stafford	Shirley Bair Mike Bennett Martin Gerwig Rusty Kidder ² Morgan Jopling Raymonde Latulippe Ed Martin Bridget Vest ¹ Rhonda Worobey <i>Secretary:</i> Robin Bromley	Bob Conway Ivan Gilbert ¹ Quay Houchen Paul Jacob Mark Kramar Joan Murdock ² Al Perez Bernie Rienks Marvin Wicher <i>Secretary:</i> Bill Archer	¹ Mike Barnes Chuck Barta Carolyn Chamberlain ² Linda Counts Barrett Francis Steve Hagen Vaughn Horton Maureen Maguire Jon Shirley <i>Secretary:</i> Doug Richardson	
Correctional Facilities	Literature	Report and Charter	³ Archives	
¹ Vicki Bigelow Christine Carvell Tom Guest Tina Hobson Richard Levesque David Lozano ² Jesse Mase Guy Raymond <i>Secretary:</i> Adrienne Brown	Loren Buettner John Burke Joe Downey ¹ Yoli Flores Bob Mayer ² Carol Readman Al Rieken Woody Roderick Norma Washburn <i>Secretary:</i> Valerie O'Neil	Donna Byrd ² Jean Dudley Gaetan Mongeau Shirley Ohlson ¹ Mike Perry Wayne Robinson John Sigerson Marty Sullivan Dolores York <i>Secretary:</i> Eva Sanchez	John Burke ² Ivan Gilbert Steve Hagen Larry Johnson John Karch Raymonde Latulippe Leo Mutchler Betty Scherer ¹ John Sigerson <i>Secretary:</i> Judit Santon	

2002 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Andy Arvidson, Western Washington	Dorothy Patch, District of Columbia
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Allan Ward, Southeast New York	Elvis Fortner, Virginia
Correctional Facilities	Richard Levesque, Arkansas	Christine Carvell, Southern Minnesota
Finance	Gayle Solheim Riese, Central New York	Sherry Leech, Oklahoma
Grapevine	Ed Martin, Eastern Missouri	Michael Bennett, North Dakota
Literature	Joe Downey, Eastern Ontario	Loren Buettner, Montana
Policy/Admissions	Brian Rogers, Colorado	Mary Templeton, S. California
Public Information	Robert Conway, N. New Jersey	Mark Kramar, Louisiana
Report and Charter	Donna Byrd, North Carolina	Marty Sullivan, Eastern Pennsylvania
Treatment Facilities	Marilyn McKeehan, E. Massachusetts	Jeanette Foster, Hawaii
Committee on Trustees	Steve Hagen, Central California	Jon Shirley, Alabama/NW Florida
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	Mary Templeton, S. California	Elvis Fortner, Virginia
³ Archives	Larry Johnson, NE Texas	Leo Mutchler, Southern Wisconsin

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment and not a primary committee assignment.

⁴The 2001 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 51st General Service Conference.

2001 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Greg Tobin, *chairperson*
Linda Chezem
Ric Downey
Jack Ostrem
Jan Polek
Tony Taschner
Judith Santon, *secretary*

Conference

Beth Rabren, *chairperson*
Ric Downey
Dean Rinehart
Arnold Ross
Betty Stevens
Ted Stoa
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities

Tony Taschner, *chairperson*
Leonard Blumenthal
Susan Campbell
*Calvin James
*Robert McCoy
Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.
Robert Miller, D.D.
Betty Stevens
Warren Stafford, *secretary*
—C.P.C.
Rick Walker, *secretary*
—Treatment Facilities

Correctional Facilities

Linda Chezem, *chairperson*
Leonard Blumenthal
Jim Clough
*William Herold
*Jane Starke Lobdell
Betty Stevens
George E. Vaillant, M.D.
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Art Knight, *chairperson*
Ron Gauthier
Marne Hill
Jackie Johnston
Tom Maguire
Ted Stoa
Greg Tobin
Dennis Manders, *senior advisor*
Robert Slotterback, *GV controller*
Kevin Sunkel, C.P.A., *consultant/independent auditor*
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Dean Rinehart, *chairperson*
Susan Campbell
Alex Palmer
Richard Roughton
Ted Stoa
George E. Vaillant, M.D.
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Alex Palmer, *chairperson*
Leonard Blumenthal
Ron Gauthier
Art Knight
Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.
Jack Ostrem
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

Literature

Jim Clough, *chairperson*
David Every
Marne Hill
Jackie Johnston
John Koster
Jan Polek
Beth Rabren
*David Sahatdjan
George E. Vaillant, M.D.
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

Nominating

Richard Roughton, *chairperson*
Linda Chezem
Art Knight
Tom Maguire
Jack Ostrem
Alex Palmer
Dean Rinehart
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

Public Information

Robert Miller, D.D., *chairperson*
Ric Downey
*Burke Dykes
David Every
John Koster
Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.
Arnold Ross
Bill Archer, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Jack Ostrem, *chairperson*
Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairman
Gary Glynn

First vice-chairperson
Elaine McDowell, Ph.D.

Second vice-chairperson
Linda Chezem

Secretary
Betty Stevens

Treasurer
Art Knight

Assistant secretary
Joanie Moncrief

Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers
is given on page 45

**Denotes appointed committee members

**Gary Glynn and Greg Muth are ex officio members of all committees.

2001 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Gary A. Glynn (1112 Park Ave., New York, NY 10128) was elected chairman of the board at the meeting following the 1997 Conference. He has been a member of the board since 1993 and has served as treasurer of the General Service Board, as well as chair of the Finance & Budgetary Committee. A graduate of the University of Vermont and the Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, he has been an investment analyst and portfolio manager for over 30 years, and is active in various professional organizations and committees.

Leonard M. Blumenthal (Rolly View, Alberta T0C 2K0, Canada), was elected a Class A trustee in 2000. In 1998 Len retired as chief executive officer of the Alberta Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission, where he had worked for 30 years. He remains active in the alcoholism field as speaker, consultant and a resource person. Leonard serves on the Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, Correctional Facilities, and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Linda L. Chezern, J.D. (530 Denny Dr., Mooresville, IN 46158) was elected to the board in April 1997. A graduate of Indiana University School of Law, Linda is a former judge, Court of Appeals of Indiana. She started the first certified court alcohol and drug program in Indiana, and has conducted seminars and written articles on such subjects as DWI, family and addiction. Linda chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and also serves on the Nominating and Archives Committees.

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Baltimore, MD 21228) was elected to the board in May 1992. Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to national and international government and professional organizations and published many articles in professional journals. She is a former professor of social work at Morgan State University. For eight years she served as the director of the Center for Substance Abuse Prevention, and was the former acting administrator of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration under U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services. Elaine serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums and Public Information Committees.

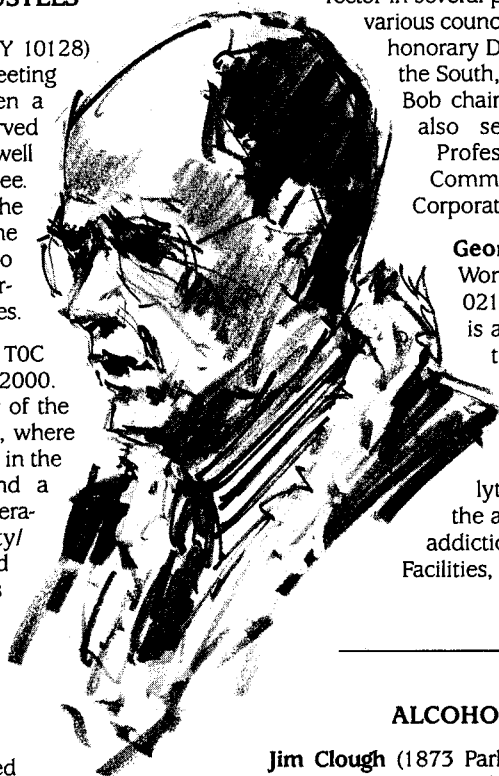
Arthur L. Knight, Jr. (560 Stockbridge Court, Lake Forest, IL 60045-2680) was elected to the board in 1995. Art's professional background is in the field of business, where he has held positions as president, director, and chief executive officer of manufacturing, distribution and financial services companies. He is a graduate of Dartmouth College and holds an M.B.A. from the University of New York, Buffalo. While Art is no longer involved in day-to-day business operations, he serves on a variety of business, professional and civic boards. He is treasurer of the General Service Board, chairs the Finance & Budgetary Committee and also serves on the International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

Robert Oran Miller, D.D. (2104 Vestavia Lake Dr., Birmingham, AL 35216) was elected to the board in 1995. Elected ninth Bishop of the Diocese of Alabama in 1988, Bob has served as deacon and

rector in several parishes in Alabama and held positions on various councils of the Episcopal Church. He received an honorary Doctorate of Divinity from the University of the South, where he serves on the board of trustees. Bob chairs the Public Information Committee and also serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

George E. Vaillant, M.D. (Brigham and Women's Hospital, 75 Francis St., Boston, MA 02115) was elected to the board in 1998. He is a graduate of Harvard Medical School and the Boston Psychoanalytic Institute.

George is professor, Dept. of Psychiatry, Harvard Medical School; senior physician, Brigham and Women's Hospital; and on the faculty of Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. He has lectured widely and is the author of many articles on alcoholism and addiction. George serves on the Correctional Facilities, Literature and International Committees.



ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Jim Clough (1873 Parkview Circle, Costa Mesa, CA 92627) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 1998. A Panel 42 delegate, Jim has been active in his area and has served as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Literature Committee. A retired naval architect and marine engineer he is currently co-owner of a company involved in the publishing, wholesaling, and retailing of art. Jim chairs the Literature Committee and also serves on the Correctional Facilities Committee. He is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

R.J.M. (Ric) Downey (PH4-9541 Erickson Dr., Burnaby, BC V3J 7N8, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 2000. A Panel 47 delegate, where he chaired the Policy Admissions Committee, Ric has remained active in his area. He recently retired after 35 years with the same firm. Ric serves on the Archives, Conference and Public Information Committees.

Marne Hill (270 Harrington Ave., Thunder Bay, Ontario P7A 3T3) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1998. A Panel 41 delegate she has held many service positions at the local and area level, including Area 85 archivist. Marne, whose background is in banking, is currently a financial planner. She serves on the Finance and Budgetary and Literature Committees and chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jacqueline Johnston (78213 Sunrise Mountain View, Palm Desert, CA 92211) was elected general service trustee in April 1998, after serving as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Jackie has been active for many years in area and district service work and was Panel 41 delegate from Southern California. Now retired, she worked as a C.P.A. for a national accounting firm in both New York and California, and as a teacher in Los Angeles. Jackie chairs the A.A.W.S. Board, and serves on the Literature and Finance and Budgetary Committees.

Tom Maguire (941 Pineview Circle, Live Oak, FL 32060) was elected general service trustee in April 1997. Tom served four

¹ Rotating at the close of the 2001 Conference meeting.

years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board. He is general manager for a national radio network, and has had a long career in television station management. He serves on the Nominating and Finance & Budgetary Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jack L. Ostrem (913 Grand Blvd., Joliet, IL 60436) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1997. A Panel 34 delegate, Jack has long been active in his area, especially in corrections service work. Now retired, his major occupation for many years was in warehouse management. Jack chairs the General Sharing Session and serves on the Archives, Nominating, and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Alex D. J. Palmer (33439 Huggins Ave., Abbotsford, BC, V2S 2R8, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada, April 1999. A Panel 45 delegate from BC/Yukon, Alex has held many service positions in his area. He has been a CGA (certified general accountant) and controller for different organizations and small businesses, and is currently executive director of a recovery house and business director of an alcohol and drug program for youth. Alex chairs the International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Nominating and International Committees.

Beth Rabren (224 First St., Brazoria, TX 77422) was elected Southwest regional trustee in April 1999. As a Panel 39 delegate she chaired the Conference Committee on Trustees. Beth continues to be active in her home group, area and region. Her professional background is in education, as teacher and administrator, and in treatment as a licensed counselor and administrator. Beth chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the Literature Committee and A.A.W.S. Board.

Dean Rinehart (613 Matthews, El Reno, OK 73036) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1997. As a Panel 37 delegate, he chaired the Grapevine Conference Committee, and has continued to be active in service work in the area and region. A practicing attorney, Dean is also engaged in cattle and farming activities. He chairs the International Committee, as well as serving on the Conference and Nominating Committees.

Richard Roughton (70 W. Huron, Apt. 806, Chicago, IL 60610) was elected general service trustee in April 1997. A Panel 34 delegate from Rhode Island, Richard served as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board, 1993-1997. He has a Ph.D. in history and is dean of the College of Arts and Science at a university in Chicago. Richard chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the International Committee and the A.A.W.S. Board.

Betty Stevens (1420 Nunamaker Dr., Columbia, SC 29210) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1997. A Panel 31 delegate, Betty has held various service positions in her area and was active in committee work for her local district. Now retired, she has worked in EAP and as an alcoholism counselor. Betty serves on the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and Correctional Facilities Committees.

Ted Stoa (402 S. Kline St., Aberdeen, SD 57401) was elected West Central regional trustee in May 2000. Ted was a Panel 42 delegate. His background is in restaurant management and he has owned and operated several restaurants, as well as the family farm. Ted serves on the Finance and Budgetary, Conference, and International Committees.

Tony Taschner (16 Cindy Lane, Berlin, CT 06037) was elected Northeast regional trustee in April 1999. Tony served as a Panel

45 delegate, where he chaired the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee, and has held many service positions in his district and area. He recently retired as an assistant vice president in Data Management of a large financial service company. Tony chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Archives Committee and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Greg Tobin (64 Duffield Dr., South Orange, NJ 07079) was elected general service trustee in April 1999, after serving for three years as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He has been active in various service committees in his home area and district. Greg has had a long career in the book-publishing industry, was the editor-in-chief of a large publishing house, and is currently a full-time writer. Greg chairs the Archives Committee, serves on the Finance and Budgetary Committee and is a director of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2000 Conference

Allen L. Ault (10909 Chatham Ridge Way, Spotsylvania, VA 22553) was elected a Class A trustee in 2001. Allen currently serves as Chief for the National Institute of Corrections in Washington, D.C. Prior to this appointment, he served as a Director of corrections for five governors, most recently serving in that capacity in Georgia. Now in an adjunct professor position, he was Chairman and Full Professor in the Criminal Justice Department at Georgia State University. During his career, Allen has been a Rehabilitation Counselor, Director of State Programs for the Mentally Retarded, Warden of a maximum security prison and President of a national criminal justice consulting firm. He received a Doctorate in Counseling Psychology from the University of Georgia.

Charles Bartell (3935 Lennox Boulevard, New Orleans, LA 70131) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2001. A Panel 45 delegate he continues to participate in treatment and correctional service in his area. Charles, whose background is in psychology, is a retired university professor.

David Every (150 Hauolia Street, #203, Wailuku, HI 96793) was elected general service trustee in April 2001. A Panel 41 delegate David served four years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He is the publisher of a local magazine and a partner in an advertising and public relations firm.

Richard Gallagher (410 Spring Valley Lane, Altamonte Springs, FL 32714) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2001. A Panel 47 delegate, Dick remains active in his home group and in area activities. A.C.P.A. in private practice he is also involved with various professional organizations.

John Koster (19 East 65th Street, New York, NY 10021-6587) was elected general service trustee in April 2001. John has been an A.A.W.S. director since 1997. He is an attorney in New York specializing in the area of maritime and international commercial law. John serves as an editor or contributing author to a number of professional publications.

Dorothy May (9046 Pine Cone Way, Indianapolis, IN 46268) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2001. Dorothy was a Panel 40 delegate. Her professional background is in education, as teacher, administrator and writer. Now retired, she is in charge of the educational program at a recovery house.

A.A. World Services Directors

Jacqueline Johnston, *chairperson, general service trustee*
 Jim Clough, *regional trustee*
 Ron Gauthier, *director*

John Koster, *director*
 Greg Muth, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Jan Polek, *director*
 Beth Rabren, *G.S.O. regional trustee*
 Joanie Moncrief, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Marnie Hill, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 Susan Campbell, *director*
 David Every, *director*
 Thomas Maguire, *general service trustee*

Robert Miller, D.D., *Class A trustee*
 Arnold Ross, *director*
 Tony Taschner, *regional trustee*
 Greg Tobin, *general service trustee*

General Service Office Staff

Greg Muth, *general manager*
 Tom Jasper, *services director*
 Bill Archer
 Adrienne Brown
 Joanie Moncrief
 Daniel Mooney

Valerie O'Neill
 Doug Richardson
 Eva Sanchez
 Warren Stafford
 Susan Ulseth
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Cynthia Keyworth, *acting managing editor*
 Mary Pat Hester, *circulation director*
 Robin Bromley, *senior editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Caryl Bertolino, *staff assistant*
 Ellie Biscuti, *staff assistant*
 Daniel Brown, *desktop/web designer*
 Shawn Bunkley, *general office clerk*
 Ramona Cabrera, *staff assistant*
 Angel Calvillo, *translator*
 Sheila Copin-Thomas, *staff assistant*
 Joseph Dennon, *staff assistant*
 John DeStefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 Maggie Keogh, *GV Website Manager/Special Projects*
 Cynthia Keyworth, *GV acting managing editor*
 John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller/business administration*
 Marsha Levine, *GV editorial staff assistant*
 Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
 Dennis Manders, *senior advisor, finance committee*
 Ayleen Martinez, *staff assistant*
 Don Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*
 Iris Morales, *staff assistant*
 Lillianna Murphy, *information services manager*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
 Miguel Rodriguez, *general office clerk*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Judit Santon, *archivist*
 Frank Segui, *financial secretary*
 Robert Slotterback, *accounting department manager*
 Elaine Soroka, *special projects manager*
 Linda Thaler, *GV financial director*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *staff assistant*
 Stephen Turchyn, *data processing supervisor*
 Andre Washington, *purchasing agent*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeritus

Michael Alexander
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 51st Conference includes Panel 50 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 51 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	51	Jon Shirley 107 Julia Way Gulf Breeze, FL 32561
Alaska	2	50	Harold Peterson, Jr. 2921 W. 29th Ave., #5B Anchorage, AK 99517
Arizona	3	50	Vicki Jo Bigelow 2602 W. Hayward Phoenix, AZ 85051
Arkansas	4	51	Richard Levesque 105 Sonnet Hot Springs, AR 71913
California Southern	5	51	Mary Templeton 13904 Fiji Way, Apt. 231 Marina del Rey, CA 90292
Central	93	51	Steve Hagen 514 E. Elmwood Ave, #F Burbank, CA 91501-2589
Northern Coastal	6	51	Suzanne Moore 1624 Proctor Dr. Santa Rosa, CA 95404-3612
Northern Interior	7	50	Woody Roderick 615 DuPont Dr. Stockton, CA 95210-2013
San Diego/Imperial	8	50	Mark Koons Box 33026 San Diego, CA 92163-2026
Mid-Southern	9	50	Alvaro (Al) Perez 1379 San Bernardino Rd., #E Upland, CA 91786
Colorado	10	51	Brian Rogers 2920 Holly Ave., #104 Durango, CO 81301-4446
Connecticut	11	51	John Burke 34 Morris St. West Haven, CT 06516
Delaware	12	50	Allen (Al) Rieken RR1, Box 146j Laurel, DE 19956
District of Columbia	13	51	Dorothy (Dottie) Patch 12711 Weiss St. Rockville, MD 20853
Florida North	14	51	Thomas (Tom) Guest 721 Garden Lane Ormond Beach, FL 32174
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I.	15	51	Norma Washburn 1743 N.W. 56 Lauderhill, FL 33313-4843
Georgia	16	50	C. Brookins Beck 287 W. Lakeview Dr. Milledgeville, GA 31061
Hawaii	17	51	Jeanette Foster 73-1062 Ahikawa St. Kailua-Kona, HI 96740
Idaho	18	50	Gerald (Guido) MacGuffie 832 N. Damask Pl. Boise, ID 83712

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois <i>Chicago</i>	19	51	Dolores York Box 25618 Chicago, IL 60625	Montana	40	51	Loren Buettner 409 N. Wilson, #31 Bozeman, MT 59715
<i>Northern</i>	20	50	Marcia Stiff 9913 Forest Lane Union, IL 60180	Nebraska	41	50	John Sigerson 3725 S. 116th Ave. Omaha, NE 68144
<i>Southern</i>	21	51	Richard Bruha 608 Deppe Ln. Fairview Heights, IL 62208-2449	Nevada	42	51	Joan Murdock 705 Mill St. Susanville, CA 96130-4354
Indiana <i>Northern</i>	22	51	Bridget Vest 1004 D Indian Mound Blvd. Anderson, IN 46013	New Hampshire	43	50	Mark Sawyer 2 Lincoln Dr. Bow, NH 03304-3209
<i>Southern</i>	23	50	Carolyn Chamberlain 241 S. Fourth St. Clinton, IN 47842	New Jersey <i>Northern</i>	44	51	Robert (Bob) Conway 1 Lauri Lane Middlesex, NJ 08846
Iowa	24	51	Charles (Chuck) Barta 1320 43rd St. SE Cedar Rapids, IA 52403	<i>Southern</i>	45	50	Stella Jenison 237 Pomona Ave. Glassboro, NJ 08028
Kansas	25	50	Jim Hall 2512 Century Lawrence, KS 66049	New Mexico	46	50	David Lozano Box 2453 Carlsbad, NM 88221
Kentucky	26	50	Betty Scherer 644 Halifax Dr. Lexington, KY 40503	New York <i>Central</i>	47	51	Gayle Solheim Riese 14 Broadway Cortland, NY 13045
Louisiana	27	51	Mark Kramar Box 208 Leesville, LA 71496-0208	<i>Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire</i>	48	50	Quay Houchen 80 Lincoln Ave. Albany, NY 12206-1404
Maine	28	50	Jesse Mase 51 Myrtle Ave. South Portland, ME 04106	<i>Southeast</i>	49	51	Allan Ward 452 Jefferson St. Westbury, NY 11590
Maryland	29	50	Morgan Jopling 1668 Wilkshire Dr. Crofton, MD 21114	<i>Western</i>	50	51	Michael (Mike) Barnes 5923 Java Lake Rd. Arcade, NY 14009-9623
Massachusetts <i>Eastern</i>	30	51	Marilyn McKeenan 1 Pleasant St. Westminster, MA 01473-1537	North Carolina	51	51	Donna Byrd 3912 Sunningdale Way Durham, NC 27707
<i>Western</i>	31	50	Tracy Flernatti 3201 Main St. Box 668 Bondsville, MA 01009	North Dakota	52	51	Michael (Mike) Bennett Box 137 Kenmare, ND 58746-0137
Michigan <i>Central</i>	32	51	Ron Atkinson 2413 W. Taft Dr. St. Johns, MI 48879	Ohio <i>Central Southeast</i>	53	51	Herbie Humphreys 3405 Wicklow Rd. Columbus, OH 43204
<i>Southeast</i>	33	51	William (Bill) Thomson 20533 Woodside Harper Woods, MI 48225-2261	<i>Northeast</i>	54	51	Tina Hobson 7830 Harvard Ave. Cleveland, OH 44105-3939
<i>Western</i>	34	50	Bernard (Bernie) Rienks 1509 North St. NE Grand Rapids, MI 49505	<i>NW Ohio/SE Mich.</i>	55	50	Shirley Bair 4615 N. Holland Sylvania Rd., Condo 7 Toledo, OH 43623
Minnesota <i>Northern</i>	35	50	Thomas (Tom) Ardolf 2992 County Rd., 137 Waite Park, MN 56387	<i>Southwest</i>	56	50	John Karch 3449 Frahm Pike Celina, OH 45822
<i>Southern</i>	36	51	Christine Carvell 3481 Pilgrim Lane North Plymouth, MN 55441	Oklahoma	57	51	Sherry Leech 2416 Chimney Hill Court Edmond, OK 73034
Mississippi	37	50	Barrett Francis Box 307 Amory, MS 38821-0307	Oregon	58	50	Maria Emery Box 69 White Salmon, WA 98672
Missouri <i>Eastern</i>	38	51	Ed Martin 4063 Utah St. Louis, MO 63116	Pennsylvania <i>Eastern</i>	59	51	Martin (Marty) Sullivan 1 Mistletoe Lane Levittown, PA 19054
<i>Western</i>	39	51	Charles (Wayne) Robinson 2421 E. Cherry St. Springfield, MO 65802	<i>Western</i>	60	51	Vaughn Horton 2919 Grove St. McKeesport, PA 15132-5358

State	Area no.	Panel	
Rhode Island	61	50	Jim Cotta 156 Thatcher St. East Providence, RI 02916
South Carolina	62	50	Darwin Haines 503 9th Ave. Conway, SC 29526-4028
South Dakota	63	50	Paul Jacob 8816 Valley View Dr. Sturgis, SD 57785
Tennessee	64	50	David Parrish 709 Pair Rd. Martin, TN 38237
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	51	Larry Johnson 13104 Nile Dr. Dallas, TX 75253
<i>Northwest</i>	66	50	Linda Counts 140 Fairview Borger, TX 79007-8300
<i>Southeast</i>	67	51	Marvin Wicher 4063 Pirates Beach Galveston, TX 77554
<i>Southwest</i>	68	50	Yolanda (Yoli) Flores 815 Rayburn, #303 San Antonio, TX 78224
Utah	69	51	Shirley Ohlson 3997 S. Starwood St. West Valley, UT 84120
Vermont	70	50	Mike Perry 11 Mechanic St. Fair Haven, VT 05743
Virginia	71	51	Elvis Fortner 8654 Poplar Springs Dr. Gloucester, VA 23061
Washington <i>State East</i>	92	50	Rusty Kidder 4203 N. Normandie Spokane, WA 99205
<i>Western</i>	72	51	Andrew (Andy) Arvidson Box 966 La Connor, WA 98257-0966
West Virginia	73	51	Martin Gerwig 50 Pine Dr. Cottageville, WV 25239
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up. Penn. MI</i>	74	50	Robert (Bob) Mayer 413 Wisconsin Ave. Ontonagon, MI 49953
<i>Southern</i>	75	51	Leo Mutchler 635-C McNally Ln. Brookfield, WI 53045
Wyoming	76	50	R. E. (Moose) Messerly 570 Logan Green River, WY 82935
Puerto Rico	77	50	Eric Rossner Urb. Mansion Del Sol MS-53 Via Arco Iris Toa Baja, PR 00952-4044

CANADA

Province	Area no.	Panel	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	50	Carol Readman Box 551 Consort, AB T0C 1B0
B.C./Yukon	79	51	*Maureen Maguire 6139 Everest Way Duncan, BC V9L 5N5
Manitoba	80	50	Rhonda Worobey #600—1310 Archibald St. Winnipeg, MB R2J 0Z4
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	50	Connie (Mike) Maes 21 Great George St., #207 Charlottetown, PEI C1A 4J7
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Lab.	82	51	Walter Henwood Box 194 Mulgrave, NS B0E 2G0
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	51	Joe Downey 43 Lennox St. Kingston, ON K7M 4S3
<i>Northeast</i>	84	51	Helaine (Lainie) Bertrand 1770 Paris St., Apt. 304 Sudbury, ON P3E 3C3
<i>Northwest</i>	85	51	Donald (Don) Anderson 11-6th Ave. Sioux Lookout, ON P8T 1E5
<i>Western</i>	86	50	Ivan Gilbert 943 #6 Hwy. Box 196 Millgrove, ON L0R 1V0
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	50	Vincent Cousineau 281 Francois-Seguin Boucherville, PQ J4B 1L6
<i>Southeast</i>	88	51	Guy Raymond 443, La France Asbestos, PQ J1T 2L4
<i>Northeast</i>	89	51	Raymonde Latulippe 5233 des Mélomanes Charny, PQ G6X 2K4
<i>Northwest</i>	90	50	Gaetan Mongeau 310 A Cercle Lacas Rosemere, PQ J7A 1W6
Saskatchewan	91	50	Jean Dudley 2319 St. Patrick Ave. Saskatoon, SK S7M 0L4



* Alternate delegate was seated.
Robert Allen, delegate, was unable to attend.